

Cassino (Casino): A Literature Review for Game Development

Prepared 2 October 2026. Scope: history, rules and variants, terminology, table talk, scorekeeping tools and digital implementations, statistics, strategy, regional traditions and cultural history of the card game Cassino/Casino and its fishing-game relatives. Written for a team building a video game version, with emphasis on (a) what people say during play, (b) scorekeepers and tools with unique affordances, (c) statistics, and (d) distinct strategies.

How to read this document

- **Citation rule.** Every factual statement carries a citation in square brackets.
 - [NN-S#] means source S# in research note NN. The notes are in the `research/` folder of this repository. Their full source lists are reproduced in **Appendix B**.
 - [11-V-S#] refers to primary sources re-checked by the coordinator in note 11.
 - [NN §x] points to a section of a research note where an argument or tabulation is developed.
- **Original computation.** Numbers labelled *original computation* come from simulations and enumerations written for this review. They are not published results. Code and outputs are in `research/sim/` and are cited as [07-S40]–[07-S43] and [SIM-ST] (the strategy tests in §9.4).
- **Quotations** are verbatim. Non-English quotations are followed by an English translation. Eighteenth-century long-s (l) is normalised to “s”.
- **Reliability flags** used in the underlying notes: [UGC] = user-generated (forums, reviews), [promo] = commercial or marketing page, [UNVERIFIED] = could not be confirmed in a fetched source. Wikipedia is treated as a secondary or tertiary source. Wherever possible its claims were followed back to primary sources (note 01).

Method

1. Ten parallel research strands, each producing a fully cited note [research/01–10]:

- 01: Wikipedia in every language
- 02: Pagat and modern rules sites
- 03: historical rulebooks, 1792–1952
- 04: cultural and literary history
- 05: glossary and table talk
- 06: scorekeepers, apps and digital implementations
- 07: statistics and academic work, plus a Monte Carlo simulation
- 08: strategy
- 09: variants and the fishing family
- 10: non-English sources beyond Wikipedia

2. Sources searched:

- Project Gutenberg, Internet Archive (full text and page images), Wikisource

- Chronicling America; the Finnish and Norwegian national library collections; the Swedish SAOB and Danish ODS dictionaries
 - Wikipedia in 15+ languages
 - Pagat, BoardGameGeek and Reddit (via archives)
 - App stores, GitHub, Google Patents
 - arXiv, OpenAlex and CrossRef
3. **Coordinator synthesis pass (note 11).** Contradictions between the notes were resolved by reading primary sources directly from page images: Long 1792, the 1793 mock-heroic poem, Dick’s *American Hoyle* (4th ed.), the German translation of 1797 and the *Sporting Magazine* of 1793. This pass produced several new findings (§12).
4. **New simulation experiments** tested historical strategy maxims, singly and in combination, against a greedy baseline (32,000 duplicate deals per variant) and against a card-counting player (8,000 per variant) (§9.4).

Executive summary

What the game is.

- Cassino is a “fishing” card game. A card played from the hand captures table cards of equal rank, or sets of table cards that sum to its value [09-S1][02-S1].
- It is “the only fishing game to have become popular in English speaking countries” [02-S1].
- Its distinctive mechanics are **building** and **calling**. These are American additions of 1866–67 [11 §V4][03-S15]. Pratesi notes they are “absent from other games of the family” [02-S30].

History in brief.

- **First records: London, 1792.** Two rival texts appeared: Robert Long’s *Short Rules* (“Cassino”) and an anonymous mock-heroic poem (“Casino”; 1792, reissued with laws in 1793). They disagreed on spelling, the lurch and capture etiquette [11 §V1–V3].
- **The poem’s tradition went to Germany, Poland and Denmark.** The German 1797 laws translate it closely [11 §V3].
- **The poem’s “General Rules” became the strategy canon.** They were merged with Long’s laws by the *Sporting Magazine* in 1793, and a condensed version became the Hoyle maxims, reprinted until 1929 [11 §V9][08 §0].
- **America reinvented the game:**
 - building and spoken calls in 1866–67 [03-S14][03-S15];
 - Royal, Spade and Draw Cassino in 1894–1909 [03-S22][03-S23][03-S29];
 - a national-game status that faded with Gin Rummy [03-S31][04-S7].
- **The “Italian origin” story is unsupported.** Its earliest printed form is the poem’s dictionary-based Florentine etymology [04-S21][09-S70].

Where the game lives now [01-S63][10-S1][02-S4][06-S22][02-S57]:

- Nordic summer cottages (Kasino; Wikipedia pageviews peak in July);
- South African townships (40-card Khasino);

- the Dominican Republic and Haiti [02-S3][05-S95];
- American family memory.

What people say.

- From 1867 the spoken announcement *was* the rule. A build was named in the singular (“Nine”), a call or lock in the plural (“Fives”), “audibly and distinctly”, or the opponent “may separate the cards” [11-V-S3][03-S15].
- Calls with the same function exist in Danish (“mere syv”), Swedish (“två åttor”, “ligger”, “storan privat”), Finnish (“rakennan ässälle”) and Russian (“Строю 7”) [10-S37][10-S25][10-S1][10-S57].
- The dealer warns “Last” / “sistan” / “båten går” / “sidsten” [02-S1][10-S24][10-S37].
- Players claim out (“I have three points, and am out”; Hungarian “Ausz!”) and challenge (“Fals!”) [04-S130][01-S20].
- **No traditional English sweep shout was found.** The shouted sweep belongs to Scopa, Escoba and Pişti [05 §3].

Scorekeeping tools [04-S36][11-V-S2][03-S23][03-S31][10-S24][02-S13][06 §1.7]:

- Tortoiseshell “Cassino Markers” (1804); counters (1793).
- A cribbage board (Spade Cassino to 61).
- The near-universal face-up sweep card; Swedish offset tallies.
- Cuarenta’s spare cards as score markers.
- **No dedicated Cassino score pad or device was found.**
- Shipped apps show that players want:
 - visible build labels;
 - explicit capture/build choices;
 - pace control;
 - score breakdowns;
 - fairness transparency, because “the computer cheats” is the top complaint [06 §8][06 §12].

Statistics.

- No published quantitative study of Cassino exists [07 §1]. Original simulation for this review finds [07-S40][07-S43][07-S42]:
 - a game to 21 lasts about 3.5 hands;
 - 26–26 card ties occur about 7% of the time;
 - sweeps range from about 0.05 per hand (random play) to 0.86, and from 0.16 to 0.86 for non-random styles;
 - the dealer takes the end-of-hand residue in 60–77% of hands;
 - a one-ply card-counting bot beats greedy play in 91% of games;
 - there are about 10^{50} distinct deals.
- The best analogue research, on Scopone, measured a dealer-side edge and found that search AI (ISMCTS) is much harder for humans than rule-based bots [07-S2].

Strategy.

- Classical advice: memory first; cards > spades > cash points; take the opponent's trailed card; never feed the Cassinos; the dealer keeps a court card for the last capture [08 §1–8].
- The main disputes are trailing small vs high cards (Foster vs Psellos), when to cash Big Cassino, and whether Royal Cassino is more skilful [08 §14].
- Simulation tests of these maxims (§9.4) support trailing court cards first and then low cards, and holding a court card for the end of the hand, in either seat. They find that taking the card your opponent just trailed helps only as a tie-break [SIM-ST].
- No maxim comes close to the combined value of the card-counting bot's look-ahead, counting and building. The best bundle of maxims recovers about an eighth of a greedy player's deficit against the card-counting bot [SIM-ST].

Recommendations for the game are in §14.

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2.1 Before Cassino: the fishing family

- In “fishing” games a player plays a card from hand and captures matching table cards. McLeod defines the family as one where “Each player in turn plays a card. If it matches a card or cards in the layout, the played card and the matched cards are captured” [09-S1]. The family name was first used by Michael Dummett [09-S70].
- McLeod divides the family into three branches [09-S1]:
 - **Western layout games**, which capture by sum (Cassino, Scopa, Escoba, Basra, Pasur, Tablić).
 - **Single-pile games** (Pishti, Xeri).

- **Oriental flip-from-stock games** (hanafuda, Go-Stop, Chinese Ten).
- The earliest European fishing game on record is English **Laugh and Lie Down**, named in 1522 and described by Francis Willughby c. 1665 [09-S69][09-S42].
 - Parlett calls it “the earliest known example of a European game of the Fishing family (Cassino, Scopa, etc), which may be of Chinese origin” [02-S34].
 - Its name comes from the rule that a player who can no longer capture lays down the hand, “whereupon the other players are supposed to laugh at you” [09-S69].
- Other early French and English fishing games:
 - French **Culbas** (1658) [09-S43] and **Papillon**, which appears in the *Académie des jeux* by 1730 [09-S41]. Papillon already had sum-capture: an ace, a four and a five “vous pouvez prendre ... avec un seul dix” [you can take with a single ten] [09-S79].
 - The Yorkshire game **Snitch’ems**, printed in 1773 and 1797, captured by “making eights and tens” [02-S18][09-S73].
- Pratesi notes that the ancient members of the family typically scored only “the player having the greatest number of cards”. Cassino’s many special scoring cards mark it as a “more evolved member” [09-S70].

2.2 First records: London, 1792 — two rival rulebooks

- **Robert Long**, *Short Rules for Playing the Game of Cassino* (London, 1792) is the earliest known rulebook. Its title page spells the game “CASSINO” [11-V-S1].
- **Long’s game:**
 - Deal: four cards each, plus four face up “upon the Board (the first Deal only)” [03-S1][11-V-S1].
 - Captures are made by “pairing or equalling any number of Pips” [03-S1].
 - Court cards can only pair [03-S1]. There is no building and no calling [03-S1].
 - Scoring: an 11-point game, “The Ten of Diamonds, which is Great Cassino, marks two Points: The Deuce of Spades, which is Little Cassino, marks one Point: The Majority of the Cards — three Points. The Majority of the Spades — one Point: and The Four Aces — one Point each”, with “Six Points gained save the Lurch” [03-S1][11-V-S1].
- Clearing the board already scored in 1792. A player who takes all the table cards “clears the Board, and marks one Point in the Game as often as repeated” [11-V-S1]. This contradicts Pratesi’s claim that the earliest rules gave no points for sweeps [11 §V2].
- Long describes a forerunner of the later “call”. With a pair in hand and a third card of that rank on the board, a player “may (if he pleases) lay down one of them and wait his Turn”. The cards are not protected: “the Adversary being at Liberty to take them if he can” [03-S1].
- A second 1792 text, *Casino; a mock-heroic poem*, reprinted with an appendix of laws in 1793, spells the game “Casino”. It attacks Long directly: “Mr. R. L. speaks of Three-handed Casino, (or CASSINO as he erroneously spells it,)” [11-V-S2].
 - The poem disputes Long’s lurch: “Mr. R. L. declares the Lurch to be Six, whereas the Custom of the first Clubs and the first Circles in London will decide against him” [11-V-S2].
 - It also disputes Long’s optional capture, saying opponents “may compel you (if they please) to take up the Pair” [11-V-S2].
 - It sets its own rules: “The Lurch is Five” [11-V-S2]. Three-handed play goes to fifteen with “Six Counters ... necessary to score with” [11-V-S2].

- It gives the earliest count-out (“seniority”) order: “Great Casino ... 1st ... Little Casino 2d. The Cards 3d. Majority of Spades 4th. Ace of Spades 5th. Ace of Clubs 6th. Ace of Hearts 7th. Ace of Diamonds the last” [11-V-S2].
- So the spelling dispute is as old as the game itself. Long (1792) wrote “Cassino” and the poem (1792/93) wrote “Casino”, calling Long’s form an error [11 §V1].
 - Pagat’s claim that “the earliest sources use the spelling Casino” [02-S1] is wrong about Long’s own title [11 §V1].
 - Wikipedia’s statement that “Cassino” is used in the earliest rules [01-S1] is correct [11 §V1].
- Pratesi documents a third early text, *Rules for Cassino*, dedicated to the Duchess of Marlborough (1795) [09-S70].
 - From these sources he concludes that “a craze for the game occurred in London in the early years of the 1790s” [09-S70].
 - The poem says that “the Knowledge of the Game is at this Time almost confined to the Circles of Fashion” [04-S21].
- The poem treats the counting cards as characters: “The Diamond-ten, the Great Casino nam’d, / Two Points demands, and chief in Rank is fam’d; / The Deuce of Spades, Casino’s younger Brother” [04-S21]. It also makes a revolutionary-era pun on court cards that can only pair: “Casino is a Democate; / And, like Tom Paine, exhorts all Subject Slaves, / ‘First Kings and Queens dismiss, and then the Knaves” [04-S21].

2.3 Hoyle and the Regency drawing room (1795–1840)

- Cassino first appears in a Hoyle-type compendium as an “ADDENDA” to *Pigott’s New Hoyle* (1795) [03-S2]. It enters Charles Jones’s *Hoyle’s Games Improved* in 1796; the 1790 and 1791 Hoyles contain none [03-S5][03-S39].
- Jones’s 1796 table lists “The Sweep or last Trick”. In this period “sweep” still meant taking the left-over cards at the end [03-S5]. By 1800 the text reads “Besides a sweep before the end of the game, when a player can match all on the board, reckons 1” [03-S6].
- Two lines of text then dominated British and early American Hoyles for about eighty years. **Neither added building** [03 §0]:
 - Jones’s Hoyle, continued through Bohn 1850/67 [03-S12].
 - Pigott’s text, reprinted in New York (1823, 1830), Philadelphia (1857, 1869), Boston (1875) and London (1876) [03-S8][03-S9][03-S13][03-S17][03-S18].
- Cassino was a fixture of genteel evenings:
 - Austen’s letter of 20 November 1800 describes “a whist and a casino table” [04-S19].
 - In *Sense and Sensibility* (1811) “Lady Middleton proposed a rubber of Casino” [04-S17].
 - In *Pride and Prejudice* (1813) Miss De Bourgh plays cassino at Rosings, where “Scarcely a syllable was uttered that did not relate to the game” [04-S16].
- Diaries and letters show the game spreading and how much was staked:
 - Canning “played cassino” (1793–95) [04-S47].
 - The Francis family played for “3d cassino” (1804) [04-S45].
 - T. B. Adams played it at the Prussian court in 1798 [04-S44].
 - Lady Nugent “played cassino till 12” in Jamaica (1801–05) [04-S46].

- Martha Wilmot in Russia bought “a little box of Cassino Markers of tortoiseshell” in 1804 [04-S36].
- From 1806 to 1840 novels and magazines refer to “the cassino table” as a drawing-room institution, including “the insipid gravities of the cassino table” (1826) [04-S49].
- Dickens’s young David Copperfield would “play casino with Mrs. Micawber” (1850) [04-S22].
- By the later nineteenth century, Pratesi finds English handbooks treating the game as “an old traditional game on the way to dying out” [04-S7].
 - Captain Crawley (1876) admits, “Of this game I, personally, know nothing” [02-S30].
 - Professor Hoffmann’s *Hoyle’s Games Modernized* (London, 1909) omits Cassino entirely [03-S30].

2.4 The Continent: a separate “Casino” lineage (1795–1829)

- Rules for “Casino” were printed in Vienna and Prague in 1795 [09-S70]. Pratesi reads the title order *Gesetzbuch der modernen Spiele Casino, Whist, Boston...* as “indicative of an actual fashion for the game” [04-S7].
- The German book of 1797 translates the 1793 poem’s laws almost word for word. Examples [11 §V3]:
 - “Derjenige, der ... den Tisch räumt, zähle für jedesmal unwiderruflich ein Point” (whoever clears the table scores one point, irrevocably, each time).
 - “dieses nennet man den Sweep, oder den Kehraus” (this is called the sweep, or the *Kehraus*).
 - “Der Lurch (Bredouille) oder doppelt gewonnenes Spiel ist Fünf” (the lurch, or doubly won game, is five).
- The same text, with the poem’s Florentine etymology, the lurch of five and the count-out order for three players, reappears in Polish (Wrocław 1821) and Danish (1829) [10-S46][10-S36]. Note 11 infers from the textual match [11 §V3]:
 - Continental Casino descends from the poem’s “Casino” tradition rather than from Long.
 - This may explain why German sources “invariably use the spelling ‘Casino’” [01-S1].
- The German and Polish books even teach pronunciation: Sweep “wie Swiep”, Lurch “wie Lordsch” [10-S41]; Polish “Świp”, “Lordź” [10-S46].
- The 1810 Berlin *Spielalmanach* adds the high card values that define Nordic Kasino today [01-S83]:
 - a Queen “welche 12 gilt” (which counts 12);
 - an Ace taken “nach dem Werthe von 14” (at the value of 14);
 - Great Casino “nach ihrem Casino-Werthe von 16” (at its casino value of 16).

An English writer reported in 1846 that “in some parts of Germany:— Great Cassino takes sixteen. Little Cassino—fifteen. Every Ace—fourteen. King—thirteen. Queen—twelve. Knave—eleven” [03-S11].

- In Sweden, *cassino* is attested as a card game from 1817 [10-S16]. The sweep word *tablerace* (“table rase”) is attested from 1838 [10-S19].
- In Danish, *svippe* (“clear the table at kasino”) is attested by 1852 [10-S35].
- Icelandic dictionaries of 1920–24 record *kasína* and *svippa* [10-S39].

2.5 America reinvents the game (1866–1950)

- Dick (“Trumps”) first printed **building** in *The American Card Player* (entered 1866): “the dealer puts an ace upon it and says ‘seven,’ ... This is called building up” [11-V-S4][03-S14].

- The 1864 date sometimes given for this is wrong [11 §V4]:
 - the preface to the fourth edition of the *American Hoyle* lists Cassino among games “added to the fourth edition” [11-V-S3];
 - that edition’s preface is dated February 1867 [03-S15].
- The 1867 *American Hoyle* adds **calling** with spoken grammar. A build is announced in the singular (“‘Nine’ or ‘Ten’ — not ‘Nines’ or ‘Tens’”), and a call in the plural (“‘Fours,’ not ‘Four’”) [03-S15].
- Pratesi reads the same book as showing how rare the old English game had become in America [04-S7]. The passage itself, though, says “The European game is the favorite with those who play merely for recreation, and is known as Set-back or Rounce Cassino” [11-V-S3][11 §V5]. Several OCR transcriptions misread this as “Bounce” [11 §V5].
- Variants multiplied in print:
 - **21-point play** with mid-hand claims (Townsend 1891; Dick 1894) [03-S20][03-S22].
 - **Court cards valued 11/12/13** as “An Interesting Variation... now very generally played” (1894) [03-S22]. Foster named this **Royal Cassino** in 1897 [03-S23].
 - **Spade Cassino**, pegged to 61 on a cribbage board (1897) [03-S23].
 - **Royal Draw Cassino** (1898) [03-S24].
 - **Diamond Casino** (Ostrow, 1945/49) [03-S35].
- Foster (1897) called Cassino the national game “typical” of America, alongside Skat for Germany and Piquet for France [03-S31]. He also said it was “one of the few games of cards that are unhesitatingly admitted to the domestic circle” [03-S31].
- American newspapers trace the game’s social life:
 - Local crazes: “Cassino is all the rage in Mineral Point” (1878) [04-S102].
 - **Progressive cassino** parties with head and foot prizes (1889–1921) [04-S103][04-S106][04-S111].
 - Afternoon casino parties for older women in the 1930s [04-S157].
 - By 1951 “casino party” usually meant a mock gambling night instead [04-S157].
- The game’s decline in America is attributed to the rise of rummy games. Scarne writes that it “was greatest in popularity prior to the advent of Gin Rummy” [04-S7]. Morehead (1944) says “In the average home Casino is known as a children’s game, but among gamblers it is known as the finest two-handed game of skill” [02-S30].

2.6 The game today: where Cassino lives

- **Nordic countries.** Kasino is a living family and summer-cottage game.
 - Wikipedia pageviews from September 2025 to August 2026 were 79/day for Norwegian, 66/day for Finnish and 40/day for Danish. English, with a far larger readership, had 106/day [01-S63].
 - Every Nordic edition peaks in July [01-S63].
 - Finnish sources describe Kasino as “hyvin suosittu” (very popular) and suitable for children and adults alike [10-S1].
 - In 2024, 78.1% of Finns played card games at least sometimes [10-S3].
- **Southern Africa.** A 40-card “Khasino” with stealable capture piles is played in townships and has its own association (KASA) and online apps [02-S4][05-S81][06-S22]. A since-removed Wikipedia edit adds taverns, shebeens and prisons [01-S8].
 - The biggest growth among Cassino apps found is South African: “the most beloved card game from South African townships” [06-S58][06 §12.18].

- **Caribbean.** A Reddit user calls Royal Casino “the national card game of the dominican republic” [05-S95]. Pagat documents a “popular card game in Haiti” pronounced *cásino* [02-S3].
- **United States.** The game survives mainly through family memory: “My mom taught me this game almost 60 years ago, when I was learning arithmetic” [02-S57]. Several players also report learning it in prison [05-S100][06-S20].
- **Brazil.** The brief’s premise does not hold. A 1996 Brazilian magazine introduced casino as “radicalmente diferente dos carteados mais populares no Brasil” (radically different from the card games most popular in Brazil) [10-S49]. Brazilians play the sum-to-15 **Escopa** instead, brought by Italian immigrants [09-S82].
- **Market signal.** Cassino’s largest Android app has about 166,000 installs. WhatWapp’s *Scopa* has about 12.3 million [06-S19][06-S40]. Board Game Arena added Cassino only in April 2025 [06-S31].

2.7 Origin claims by Wikipedia edition (from note 01)

Edition	Claim	Sourcing
en (now)	English, first recorded 1792; Italian origin “often said, without substantiation”; “casino” then meant a summer house or villa	Parlett 2008; Pratesi 1995; Thompson 2015 [01-S1]
en (2006)	“probably descended from the Italian game Scopa”	unsourced [01-S10]
en (pre-2007)	“‘Casino’ is the official name ... ‘Cassino’ is a common mis-spelling. Source: Official Hoyle Rulebook”	removed [01-S10]
de (2006–2022)	roots in 17th-century France	removed 2022 [01-S16]
de (now)	England, end of the 18th century	Bermicourt citing Pratesi [01-S16]
ja (2007–2013)	15th-century France , as gambling; named after casinos; French pronunciation “kashino”	removed 2013 [01-S25]
ja (now)	resembles Scopa, but no positive evidence; oldest text late-18th-century London; casino (gambling house) is a 19th-century word	pagat [01-S24]
nb (now)	“stammer fra Italia” [comes from Italy], variant of Scopa	unsourced [01-S26]
hu (now)	origin in a medieval Italian game, scopa; popular in Hungary in the early 20th century	unsourced [01-S20]
fi (now)	first records in 18th-century England; believed related to Scopa	unsourced [01-S17]
sv (now)	“ av kinesiskt ursprung ” [of Chinese origin]; in Sweden since the early 1800s	general refs; likely derived from Torgny’s claim about the <i>fishing mechanism</i> [01-S29, 01-S34]
sv (2016–21)	the word <i>kasino</i> is an Italian diminutive of <i>casa</i>	[01-S30]
it (now)	“gioco di carte inglese” [English card game]	Britannica, pagat [01-S23]
1868 American Hoyle	“a card game of Italian origin”	primary source [01-S79]
cs Pasúr	“italská hra Cassino” [the Italian game Cassino]	unsourced [01-S62]
CardRules+ (cited by it)	Cassino is the “progenitore” [progenitor] of Scopa and Escoba	web page, unsupported [01-S70]

- **Spelling** (the Long-vs-poem dispute is in §2.2 above; further details):
 - The archive.org scan of Long’s title page reads “SHORT RULES FOR PLAYING THE GAME OF CASSINO”, and the archive metadata gives “cassino” [01-S81]. Hoyle 1796 uses both: the running head “The Game of CASINO” and the text “GAME of CASSINO” [01-S82].
 - Bermicourt’s 2022 talk comment (“Both spellings were used early on, but ‘Casino’ was first”) conflicts with his own later article text [01-S2].
 - The nb title moved to “Kasino” as the Språkrådet spelling [01-S28].

3. The rules: a standard core and a large set of contested options

3.1 The modern Anglo-American core (Pagat's standard)

- **Players and deal:**

- Casino is played by 2–4 players; four play as partners sitting opposite each other [02-S1].
- It is “one of the few games which will deal out evenly to two, three, or four players” [02-S1].
- Each player gets four cards and four go face up to the table. “Traditionally, the deal is in twos” [02-S1].
- Later deals give four cards each and none to the table: “6 deals for 2 players, 4 deals for three players, 3 deals for 4 players” [02-S1].
- “The dealer must announce”last” when dealing the last cards” [02-S1].

- **Capturing:**

- A court card captures only a matching court card. “If the table contains more than one matching card only one may be captured” [02-S1].
- A numeral card captures same-rank cards and any separate sets that sum to its rank. For example, an eight with A 2 3 5 6 8 on the table “could capture 8 6 2 5 3 or 8 5 2 A, but not all six cards” [02-S1].

- **Building:**

- A build “must announce the capturing number (saying, for example,”building 5”)“, and the builder”must hold a numeral card which can later make the capture” [02-S1].
- Builds are either **single** (e.g. $2+3 = 5$) or **multiple** (e.g. $6-3 + 5-4 + 9 = 9$) [02-S1].
- A build must include the card just played [02-S1].
- Builds can be “stolen” by anyone holding the announced rank [02-S1].
- A single build can be raised with a hand card. “The capturing number of a multiple build can never be changed” [02-S1].
- “you are never allowed to break up or rearrange the cards that are already in the build” [02-S1].

- **Trailing:**

- “You are allowed to trail a card even if that card could have made a capture” [02-S1].
- The one exception: a player who was the last to add to a build on the table may not trail [02-S1].

- **End of the deal:** at the end, the last capturer takes the remaining table cards, which “are sometimes known as the residue” [02-S1].

- **Scoring:**

- Eleven points per hand: Most Cards 3, Most Spades 1, each Ace 1, ♦10 (“Big Casino or the Good Ten”) 2, ♠2 (“Little Casino or the Good Two”) 1 [02-S1].
- Ties on cards or spades score nothing, and the game is played to 21 [02-S1].
- Sweep points are listed as a common variant: “Many people play that a Sweep is worth one point... Some players call this a clear” [02-S1].

- **The 11-point checksum.** Foster notes that “the total number of points to be made in each hand, exclusive of sweeps, is eleven, and the total of the claims made must agree with that number” [03-S31].

This is a built-in error check that one shipped app's scoring bug would have failed: "Sometimes the final total is greater than 11 (combined) per round" [06-S20][06 S5].

3.2 Options matrix (for the game's rules menu)

The table below is reproduced from research note 02 (33 rows, each alternative attested), followed by additional rows found by the other notes and the verification pass.

#	Rule / option	Default (classic)	Attested alternatives (source)
1	Players / partnerships	2; 3–4 solo; 4 as 2v2 [02-S1]	5 players: remove 2♥2♦2♣, 5 cards last deal [02-S37][02-S39]; up to 6 (Dick 1867) [02-S36]; California 2,3,4,6 [02-S37]
2	Direction	Clockwise [02-S1]	Counter-clockwise: Dominican, Swazi, Diloti 4p [02-S3][02-S4][02-S9]
3	Deal pattern	4 each + 4 table, in twos [02-S1][02-S31]	Singly (Dick 1867; "some players") [02-S36][02-S1]; 3-card deals (Diamond, Hungarian) [02-S30][02-S3]; Draw Cassino refill after each play [02-S31][02-S32]; Suipi 8-card hands [02-S39]; Swazi: all cards dealt, 4 cut to table [02-S4]
4	"Last" announcement	Dealer says "last" [02-S1]	"cards" [02-S37]; "sistan"/"bât" [02-S5]; sound cue in software [02-S47]
5	Court-card values	No numeric value; pair only [02-S1]	Royal: J11 Q12 K13 [02-S3][02-S31][02-S32]; USPC 11/12-spot packs: J13 Q14 K15 [02-S32]; Zwicker dual values [02-S8]
6	Ace value	1 [02-S1]	1 or 14 (Royal) [02-S3][02-S32]; 14 in hand/1 on table (Finnish, Kryp Kasino) [02-S5][02-S6]; "sometimes... 14 each" [02-S31]
7	Cassino dual values	none	2♣ = 2/15, 10♦ = 10/16 (Finnish; German 1810; Mulle; BGG house rule; Reddit "kasino krypt") [02-S5][02-S36][02-S54][02-S56][02-S63]; Buckeye: 10♦ = 10/11 [02-S37]
8	Pairing court cards	Take only one matching court card [02-S1][02-S47][02-S41]	Take all matching (Britannica/Parlett; Foster; Denexa; California) [02-S33][02-S31][02-S40][02-S37]; take one or three (never two) [02-S39]; Royal: any number [02-S39]
9	Pairing numerals	Take all same-rank cards + any disjoint sums [02-S1][02-S32]	Scopa-style "single match beats sum" (Scopa/Escoba family) [02-S10][02-S12]; BGG reviewer: capture card ≥ each captured card [02-S57]
10	Forced capture	Not compulsory; may trail a capturing card [02-S1][02-S47]	Must capture with a capturing card if played (Scopa/Escoba/Basra) [02-S10][02-S12][02-S15]; may not trail a card that could capture (Denexa) [02-S40]; must take matching loose cards (Dominican) [02-S3]; misère forms force full capture [02-S6][02-S53]
11	Build must include a hand card	Yes [02-S1]	Table-only builds allowed: pagat variant, Swazi [02-S1][02-S4]; BGG "What's on the table is always fair game" [02-S59]
12	Must hold capturing card	Yes [02-S1][02-S31][02-S32]	Penalty –5 if violated (Finnish) [02-S53]; build broken & opponents retract [02-S31][02-S32]; Michigan –2 [02-S37]; old Zwicker: not required [02-S8]
13	Announce build value aloud	Required ("building 5") [02-S1]	Required with penalty: unnamed builds may be separated by others [02-S32]; optional (Diloti, Seres) [02-S9][02-S53]
14	Single build raise by hand card	Yes, any player [02-S1][02-S31]	Only opponent's build (Dominican, Swazi, Diloti) [02-S3][02-S4][02-S9]; not in succession, alternately (Dick 1867) [02-S36]; own raise OK only holding both cards [02-S32]
15	Table cards in raising a single build	No [02-S1][02-S31][02-S32][02-S63]	Yes if hand card also contributes (pagat variant) [02-S1]; Cats at Cards allows [02-S39]
16	Multiple (double/"natural") builds	Allowed; value fixed [02-S1][02-S31]	Called "calling" in USPC/Dick/playingcarddecks [02-S32][02-S36][02-S43]; group/"family"/"soy" (Diloti) [02-S9]; "protected" if topped with same rank [02-S61]
17	Build counts as a card for combos/extension	No [02-S1][02-S59]	Yes (pagat variant; Dick 1867; Wikipedia 2019) [02-S1][02-S36][02-S37]; Diloti variant [02-S9]
18	Multiple builds of same value at once	Not addressed by pagat; BGG players say legal [02-S58]	Forbidden: Swazi, <i>Cassino!</i> iOS, Wikipedia Variant 3; BGA enforces [02-S4][02-S58][02-S37]
19	Several builds by one player	Allowed (second build) [02-S1][02-S31][02-S32]	Swazi 2p first half: max one build [02-S4]
20	Owner may trail	No [02-S1][02-S31][02-S47]	Yes (pagat variant; Swazi; South Africa 2nd phase) [02-S1][02-S4]; Variant 2 must take/add next turn [02-S37]
21	Build for partner	Not part of pagat core rules (listed only as a variant) [02-S1]; explicitly forbidden by Cats at Cards [02-S39]	Allowed: Foster, USPC, pagat variant ("building 9 for partner"), Zwicker [02-S31][02-S32][02-S1][02-S8]; only when provable (Dominican var., Swazi) [02-S3][02-S4]
22	Building with court cards	Never [02-S59][02-S61]	Royal yes [02-S3]; "Trailing-royals" natural building [02-S37]

#	Rule / option	Default (classic)	Attested alternatives (source)
23	Sweeps	Variant in pagat; standard in Foster/USPCC/Britannica (1 pt) [02-S1][02-S31][02-S32][02-S33]	None (Royal per many; California; Swazi) [02-S3][02-S37][02-S4]; cancel between sides [02-S31][02-S3][02-S5]; not when $\geq 18/\geq 10$ pts [02-S3][02-S5]; not in last deal [02-S5]; 2 pts (Michigan) [02-S37]; first-turn sweep 2 pts (Hungarian) [02-S3]
24	Last-card sweep	Counts only if a genuine full capture [02-S1][02-S31]	Never (Scopa) [02-S10]; never after last deal (Finnish) [02-S5]
25	Residue (cards left)	To last capturer; not a sweep [02-S1][02-S31]	+1 point “sistan” (Swedish) [02-S5]; 2 for cards + 1 last capture [02-S1]; keep a court card back to win them (Long 1792 advice, not a rule) [03-S1]; nobody (Haitian, Cuarenta) [02-S39][02-S13]; dealer’s team (Tablić) [02-S17]
26	Points: cards / spades	3 / 1 [02-S1][02-S31]	2 / 2 (Wippen; Swazi split ties; family) [02-S1][02-S4][02-S61]; 1 / 2 (Swedish/Finnish) [02-S5]; 1 (CT/NY) [02-S1]; ≥ 5 spades = 1 (S. Africa) [02-S4]; Överspader (1 per spade over 6) [02-S5]; thresholds 27+/7+ [02-S45][02-S60]; bonus per card >35 / spade >10 [02-S61]
27	Points: 10♦ / 2♠ / aces	2 / 1 / 1 each [02-S1]	3 / 2 (CT/NY) [02-S1]; Spade Cassino every spade 1, J♠ +1 (24 total, to 61) [02-S1][02-S31][02-S32]
28	Ties for cards/spades	Nobody scores [02-S1]	Split 1–1 (Swazi) [02-S4]; postponed to next round (Finnish) [02-S53]; most spades breaks a 26–26 (Portuguese) [02-S37]
29	Target	21 [02-S1][02-S32][02-S33]	11 (difference scoring; lurch <6 doubles) [02-S1][02-S31][02-S36]; each deal a game [02-S31][02-S32]; 16 (Nordic) [02-S5]; 50 [02-S1]; 61 (Spade) [02-S31]; 6 (Royal, wiki) [02-S37]; best-of-7 [02-S61]
30	Near-target restrictions	None [02-S3]	Dominican 18/19/20 (or Soto from 16) [02-S3]
31	Count-out / claim	Optional [02-S1]	Claim mid-hand, wrong claim loses (Foster; Dick 1880; Cats) [02-S31][02-S36][02-S39]; order cards, spades, big, little, aces ♠♣♥♦, sweeps [02-S31][02-S32][02-S1]
32	Skunk / all 11	—	+1 point, or instant win [02-S37]
33	Extra play modes	—	Draw, Royal Draw (fail to draw → draw two) [02-S32]; Pluck [02-S37][02-S39]; misère (Krypkasino, Misäärikasino, Lazy/Laisto, Give-away) [02-S6][02-S53][02-S61][02-S30]; capture-pile stealing (Swazi, Steal Pile) [02-S4][02-S61]; solo vs automaton [02-S61]
34	Lurch (double game)	— (modern)	1792 Long: “Six Points gained save the Lurch” [11-V-S1]; 1793 poem/German 1797/Danish 1829: lurch is five [11-V-S2][11-V-S6][10-S36]; 3-handed lurch 7 (poem) [11-V-S2]; 1952 USPCC: 11 in two deals doubled, in one deal $\times 4$ [03-S36]
35	Compulsory capture (historical)	Optional (Long 1792) [03-S1]	Opponents “may compel you” to take up a pair (1793 poem) [11-V-S2]
36	Count-out precedence	Cards, spades, Big, Little, aces ♠♣♥♦, sweeps (Foster) [03-S31]	Great Casino, Little Casino, Cards, Spades, aces ♠♣♥♦ (1793) [11-V-S2]; points first, then cards, then spades (Finnish) [10-S1]; “no one point has precedence” (<i>NY Clipper</i> , 1883/1890) [04-S131][04-S167]; “Cards and spades go out first, of course” (Jack London, 1912) [04-S28]
37	Dual hand/table values	None	Nordic: A 14/1, ♠2 15/2, ♦10 16/10 from hand vs. table [10-S1][10-S32]; Swedish: player’s <i>choice</i> each time [10-S24]; first in print 1810 (Berlin) [01-S83]
38	Special clearing card	None	Danish: “Spar 5 rydder bordet” (♠5 clears the table) [10-S37][01-S11]
39	Multi-card hand plays	One hand card per turn	Hungarian Kaszinó: several hand cards vs. several table cards, equal sums ≤ 13 [01-S20][01-S73]
40	After a sweep	Next player plays normally (must trail onto an empty table)	Hungarian: opponent trails, then moves again [01-S20]; German: “eine Karte für den Tisch bringen” [01-S14]
41	Sweep cancellation and freezes	No cancellation [02-S3]	Opposing sweeps cancel (Dick 1894; Foster; Dominican; Finnish <i>mökki kaatuu</i> ; Danish) [03-S22][03-S31][02-S3][10-S1][10-S37]; no sweep in the last deal [10-S1]; none once anyone has ≥ 10 [02-S5]; only the first <i>mökki</i> per hand counts (house rule) [10-S1]; sweeps under “Sweep freeze” in software [06-S60]
42	Tied majorities	Nobody scores [02-S1]	Finnish carry-over (“jää pakkaan”): cards tie → next deal’s cards point worth 2, 3...; spades 4, 6... [01-S17][10-S1]; Russian <i>Ckona</i> 26–26 → 1 each [01-S58]
43	Exceeding the target	Highest score wins [02-S1]	Danish: “den der er tættere på 21 der vinder” (whoever is closer to 21 wins) [01-S11]; Finnish exact-16 variant (17 → 15, 18 → 14) [01-S17]
44	Claiming / challenge calls	Claim 21; wrong claim loses [03-S31]	Hungarian “Ausz!” / “Kint vagyok!”; challenge “Fals!” (wrong capture → challenger +2; correct → capturer +1) [01-S20]; Pasur “per shodam” [02-S14]; Scopa “chiamarsi fuori” [02-S10]
45	Point weights (regional)	3/1/2/1/1 [02-S1]	Icelandic family: ♦10 5, ♠2 2, last trick 1 [10-S40]; Swazi cards 2, spades 2 [02-S4]; Finnish 1/2 for cards/spades [10-S1]; Russian <i>Ckona</i> : cards 2, clubs 1, 2♣ 1, ♦10 1, no aces [01-S58]
46	Last round played open	Hidden	Hungarian: eighth draw played “nyitott lapokkal” (with open cards) [01-S20]

#	Rule / option	Default (classic)	Attested alternatives (source)
47	Opening layout restrictions	Any	Norwegian: point cards on the table replaced [01-S26]; Swazi: re-cut if ≥ 3 points or ≥ 3 pictures [02-S4]; Scopa: redeal if 3+ kings [02-S10]

3.3 The contested questions, ranked by how much players fight about them

- **Can you raise your own build?** Sources contradict each other:
 - **No:** Dick 1866; USPCC 1898; Standard Hoyle 1904 [03-S14][03-S24][03-S25].
 - **Yes,** if you hold cards for both builds: Foster, who calls the opposite view “a common error ... manifestly unfair” [03-S31]; also 1907, 1929, 1949, 1952 [03-S28][03-S33][03-S35][03-S36].
 - Today Dominican and Swazi rules forbid it, while Pagat allows it [02-S3][02-S4][02-S1].
- **Can two builds of the same value coexist?** Board Game Arena blocks one such move. A veteran BGG poster objects: “I’ve played for more than 60 years with dozens of other players, and never encountered anyone who thought it should not be allowed” [02-S58]. The iOS *Cassino!* forbids it [02-S58]. An unsourced Norwegian edit makes the same point more heatedly: “Det er lov til å bygge flere bygg samtidig. Sier man noe annet er man en DUST og dårlig taper!!!” (It’s allowed to have several builds at once; anyone who says otherwise is an IDIOT and a sore loser!!!) [01-S28].
- **Does a face card take one or all matching face cards?**
 - One: Pagat and USPCC 1952 [02-S1][03-S36].
 - All: Foster, Britannica/Parlett, Denexa [02-S31][02-S33][02-S40].
 - One or three, never two: Cats at Cards; Ostrow 1949 [02-S39][03-S35].
 - Foster’s rationale for restraint: “It is considered bad policy to take in three court cards, as it stops all sweeps when the fourth appears” [03-S31].
- **Are sweeps scored?**
 - “Sweeps are not part of the regular rules. They are a variant and we play with them every single time. Why wouldn’t you??” vs. “there is virtually no skill in getting a sweep” (BGG, 2017) [05-S74-BGG1893693].
 - “It is not general to-day to count sweeps; but sweeps should be scored, as there is fine play made in the scoring of them” (1904) [03-S25].
 - Jack London’s characters settle the question before the deal: “Do you count sweeps?” / “Certainly not ... That’s a sissy game” [04-S28].
- **Must you capture if you can?** Pagat: no [02-S1]. Denexa: “A player may not simply trail if they are able to capture something with that card” [02-S40]. Scopa, Escoba and Basra make it compulsory [02-S10][02-S12][02-S15].
- **Design implication:** reviews of shipped Cassino apps show that players want their household rules available:
 - “never heard of sweep so that gets turned off” [06-S19]
 - “Real casino players don’t play identical card building” [06-S19]
 - “We want the kasi cassino where the ace is a 14” [06-S22]

Successful apps therefore ship a “variation builder” or regional presets [06-S27][06-S25]. ## 4. Variants and the wider fishing family

4.1 Named Cassino variants

- **Classic English (1792):** no building; court cards pair only; 11-point difference scoring with a lurch [11-V-S1][03-S1]. The Americans later called it “Set-back or Rounce Cassino” [11 §V5].
- **American (1866–67):** adds building, calling and spoken announcements; each deal counts as a game. Building is printed from 1866 [03-S14], the deal-as-game scoring from 1867 [03-S15].
- **Twenty-one-point:**
 - Points are scored as made, and a correct claim wins “even if his adversary has 21 or more” [03-S31].
 - “If he is mistaken, and cannot show out, he loses the game” [03-S31].
 - If neither player claims and both are out, play continues to 32, then 43, “eleven points more each time” [09-S76].
- **Royal Cassino:**
 - J/Q/K = 11/12/13 [03-S31]. The ace is “14 or 1 at the option of the holder; but if it is one of the cards lying on the table, it is always 1” [03-S28].
 - In 1898 the USPC suggested using 60-card poker packs with 11- and 12-spot cards, making “the jacks thirteens, the queens fourteens, the kings fifteens, and the aces ones or sixteens” [03-S24].
 - In 1905 the joker was valued at 15 [03-S27].
- **Spade Cassino:** “every spade counts one point ... The spade Jack counts one in addition” [09-S76]. That makes 24 points per hand, pegged on a cribbage board to 61 [03-S23][11 §V7].
- **Draw / Royal Draw Cassino:**
 - Players refill their hand to four from a stock “left on the table, face down, slightly spread” [03-S29].
 - “If a player fails to draw in proper turn ... he must draw two cards” [03-S33].
 - Swedish *dragkasino* and Finnish *pakkakasino* are the same idea [10-S24][10-S1].
- **Diamond Casino (Ostrow 1945/49):**
 - 40 cards, three each, four to the table [03-S35].
 - Scoring: most cards, most diamonds and the 7♦ score 1 each; all four 7s, 6s or aces score 2 [03-S35].
- **Give-away Casino and Nordic misère forms** (*Krypkasino*, *Laistokasino*, *Smyg*) [02-S30][02-S6][10-S1][01-S26]:
 - Krypkasino counts a forced sweep “+5 to taker, –5 to the player who set it up” [02-S6].
 - Players customarily warn about a sweep they are leaving open: “tabbe på 9” (sweep for a nine) [02-S6].
- **Nordic Kasino (SE/FI/NO/DK/IS):** Royal values; ♦10, ♠2 and aces worth more from the hand; usually no building; sweeps (*tabbe*, *mökki*, *svupper*) that often cancel; game to 16 or 21 [10 §1][10 §17]. Byggkasino is the Swedish building version, scoring cards 3 and spades 1, to 21 [10-S25].
- **Mulle (two decks):**
 - Capturing a card’s identical twin (same rank and suit) scores a *mulle* [10-S26].
 - It is associated with prison: Glimne calls it “kåkfarrarvarianten av kasino” (the jailbird variant of kasino) [01-S72].

- A Kumla informant says: “Vet man inte vad mulle är efter en vistelse på t.ex. Kumla – har man inte ‘suttit inne’!” (If you don’t know what mulle is after a stay at Kumla, you haven’t ‘done time’!) [10-S27].
- **Hungarian Kaszinó:** three-card deals; multi-card hand combinations up to 13; a double move after a sweep; open last round; “Ausz!” to go out at 11 [01-S20][01-S73].
- **African Casino (Swazi, Sotho, South African):**
 - Capture piles are face up, and their top cards can be used in builds [02-S4].
 - Builds have owners [02-S4].
 - Playing a card that could have captured into a build instead is “drifting” [02-S4].
 - The South African form uses 40 cards [02-S4].
- **Dominican Royal Casino:** counter-clockwise play; compulsory capture of equal loose cards; sweep cancellation; and endgame restrictions. “at 18 can only win by most cards; at 19 only by 10♦; at 20 only by most spades” [02-S3].
- **Belgian/Dutch Wippen:**
 - Scoring: cards 2, spades 2, sweep (“wip”) 1 [02-S1].
 - The Dutch article teaches it as a ladder: pairing, then summing, then building, then raising, then double builds [09-S61].
 - “In manchen Gegenden Belgiens ‘wippt’ der Spieler bei einer Wippe wirklich auf seinem Platz (steht kurz auf und setzt sich wieder)” (In some parts of Belgium the player literally “wips” in their seat at a Wippe, standing up briefly and sitting down again) [01-S60].
- **Zwicker (Schleswig-Holstein):**
 - Jokers worth 15/20/25 [02-S8].
 - Builds can go by subtraction as well as addition [02-S8].
 - The sweep is the “Zwick” (“equivalent to the English ‘tweak’”) [02-S8].
- **Stealing Bundles (children’s game):** “you can steal your opponent’s bundle if you can match its top card” [03-S36]. The 1952 USPCC recommends it as a first step, then “full-fledged Royal Cassino—no happier introduction to arithmetic was ever devised!” [03-S36].
- **Folk variants found only in Wikipedia history** (unverified elsewhere) [01-S5][01-S6][01-S7][01-S9][02-S37]:
 - Pluck, California, Portuguese, Buckeye, Michigan and Florida Cassino;
 - “orphan” face cards;
 - the “skunk”.

4.2 Comparison matrix across the family

Abbreviations: Σ^+ = sum to the played card; “+15/+11/+10/+8,10” = played card plus captured set = N; B = building; $\Sigma\Sigma$ = multiple sets per capture; P = pairing; 1-of = capture a single card or set; Flip = turn up from stock; Seq = sequence; Pile = single-pile.

Game	Region	Deck	Pl.	Deal (hand/table; re-deal)	Capture	B	Special-power cards	Sweep	Main scoring items	Target	Src
English Cassino (1790s)	England	52	2–4	4/4; 4s	P, Σ + (courts P only)	no	—	1 (Pigott)	cards 3, $\spadesuit$ 10 2, $\heartsuit$ 2 1, spades 1, A $\times$ 4	11 (diff.), lurch <6	[09-S72] [09-S40]
American Cassino	USA	52	2–6	4/4; 4s	P, $\Sigma\Sigma$, call	yes	—	1	as above	per deal	[09-S75]
Modern Casino	Anglo-Am.	52	2–4	4/4; 4s	P (courts), $\Sigma\Sigma$	yes	—	opt. 1	11 pts	21	[09-S2]
Royal Cassino	Anglo-Am.	52	2–4	4/4	$\Sigma\Sigma$, J11 Q12 K13 A1/14	yes	—	opt.	11 pts	21	[09-S3] [09-S76]
Spade Cassino	USA	52	2–4	4/4	as Casino	yes	—	1	every $\heartsuit$ 1, $\heartsuit$ J +1 = 24	61 (cribbage)	[09-S76]
Draw Casino	USA/SE/FI	52	2	4/4 then draw 1	as Casino/Royal	yes/no	—	—	as base	as base	[09-S77] [09-S62] [09-S63]
Diamond Casino	USA	40	2–4	3/4	Scopa-like	—	—	1	cards, $\spadesuit$ maj., $\spadesuit$ 7 1; four 7s/6s/As 2	11	[09-S70] [09-S40]
Dominican Casino	DR	52	2–4	4/4	$\Sigma\Sigma$, A1/14, compulsory if equal loose card	yes	—	1, cancel	11 pts	21 + endgame restrictions	[09-S3]
Hungarian Kaszinó	HU/AT	52	2	3/4	multi-card from hand	no	—	1 (2 if first play)	11 pts	11	[09-S3]
Swedish Kasino	SE	52	2–4	4/4	$\Sigma\Sigma$, Royal, optional	no	—	<i>tabbe</i> 1	spades 2, cards 1, A, $\spadesuit$ 10 2, $\heartsuit$ 2 1, <i>sistan</i> 1	16	[09-S4]
Finnish Kasino	FI	52	2–4	4/4	$\Sigma\Sigma$; hand A14 $\heartsuit$ 2=15 $\spadesuit$ 10=16	var.	—	<i>mökki</i> 1, cancel	10 pts, rollovers	16	[09-S4] [09-S63]
Danish Cassino	DK	52	2–4	4/4	$\Sigma\Sigma$, dual values; opt. $\pm \times \div$	yes	$\heartsuit$ 5 clears	<i>svupper</i> 1	+ <i>sidsten</i> 1	21	[09-S65]
Mulle	SE	104	2–4	5/5 or 4/8	as Kasino	—	—	1	mulle 5 or capture value	—	[09-S4]
Krypkasino	SE	104	2–6	varies	as Kasino; avoid points	—	—	+5/–5	42 penalty pts	low wins	[09-S6]
Swazi Cassino	Eswatini	52	2–4	all dealt (12/12 for 2)	$\Sigma\Sigma$; steal top of opp. pile into builds	yes	—	none	cards 2, spades 2, $\heartsuit$ 2 1, $\spadesuit$ 10 2, A	—	[09-S5]
Zwicker	Schleswig-H.	52+3–6 jokers	4 (2–6)	4/3; 4s	$\Sigma\Sigma$; courts dual (A1/11... K4/14)	add or subtract	jokers 15–30	Zwick 1	jokers 5–7, $\spadesuit$ 10 3, $\heartsuit$ 10, $\heartsuit$ 2, A, cards 3	series	[09-S7]
Tuxedo	USA	40 Rook	2–6	4/4	Casino	yes	—	10/5	cards 15, “orange” 10, 5s 5	100	[09-S3]
Stealing Bundles	Anglo/Arg./It	52/40	2–4	4/4	P only	no	—	—	steal whole bundle	most cards	[09-S8]
Wippen	BE/NL	52 (104)	2–6	4/4	P $\rightarrow$ Σ $\rightarrow$ B (graded)	opt.	—	<i>wip</i> 1	cards 2, spades 2, $\spadesuit$ 10 2, $\heartsuit$ 2 1, A	agreed	[09-S61] [09-S2]
Scopa	Italy	40	2(–6)	3/4; 3s	1-of; single>set; compulsory	(cascina var.)	(Ace in var.)	scopa 1	cards, coins, settebello, primiera	11	[09-S9] [09-S54]
Scopone	Italy	40	4	9/4 or 10/0	1-of	no	—	1	4 + scope	11 (21)	[09-S10]

Game	Region	Deck	Pl.	Deal (hand/table; re-deal)	Capture	B	Special-power cards	Sweep	Main scoring items	Target	Src
Cirulla	Liguria	40 Fr	4 (2–3)	3/4	match, Σ , +15, Ace all	no	♥7 wild for bonuses	1	grande 5, piccola ≤ 6 , bonuses 3/10	51	[09-S11]
Cicera	Brescia	52 It	4	12/4	1-of, optional	no	—	scù 1, picada 1	cards 2, swords, mata, etc.	—	[09-S12]
Escoba	Spain/S.Am.	40 Sp	2–4	3/4	+15	no	—	1 (deal 15/30)	cartas, oros, 7 de velo, setenta	21	[09-S13]
Escopa/Escova	Brazil/Portugal	40	2–4	3/4	+15	no	—	1	+ all 7s; end-sum check-sum	21/31	[09-S82] [09-S66] [09-S49]
Chorizo/Bá-ciga	Uruguay	40 Sp	2–4	3/4	+15	no	—	1	hand declarations (Chorizo 20)	21	[09-S14]
Chkobba	Tunisia/Fr	40 Fr	2/4	3/4	1-of, compulsory	no	—	1	kārta, dīnāri, barmīla, ♦7	21	[09-S9] [09-S68]
Cuarenta	Ecuador	40	2/4	5/0	P, Σ (numerals), Seq	no	—	limpia 2	caída 2, ronda 4, card count	40	[09-S15]
Ronda	Morocco	40 Sp	2–4	3/4	P + Seq	no	—	missa 1	caída 1, ronda/tringa, cards >20	41	[09-S25]
Tablić	Balkans	52	2/4	6/4	$\Sigma\Sigma$, K14 Q13 J12 A1/11	no	—	tabla 1	A K Q J 10 1, ♦10 2, ♣2 1, cards 3	101	[09-S16]
Basra	Middle East	52	2/4	4/4	P, Σ (numerals)	no	J all, ♦7 all	10	cards 30, J/A 1, ♣2 2, ♦10 3	101	[09-S18]
Pâsur	Iran	52	2–4	4/4	+11; J all	no	J	Sur 5, cancel	7 clubs 7, A/J 1, ♣2 2, ♦10 3	62	[09-S19]
Kontsina	Greece	52	2	4/4	1-of	no	—	—	cards 2, clubs 1, good 2, good 10	rounds	[09-S20]
Diloti	Greece	52	2/4	6/4	$\Sigma\Sigma$ + declarations	yes	—	xeri 10	cards 4, A, good 10 2, good 2	61	[09-S21]
Xeri	Greece	52	2/4	6/4 pile	Pile ; J takes	no	J	xeri 10/20	A K Q J 10 1 etc.	rounds/151	[09-S22]
Piști	Turkey	52	4 (2)	4/4 pile	Pile; J takes	no	J	piști 10/20	J, A, ♣2 2, ♦10 3, cards 3	151	[09-S23]
Seep	N. India/Pak.	52	4	bid, then all	$\Sigma\Sigma$, houses ≥ 9	houses	—	50	spades by value, ♦10 6 (=100)	100 lead	[09-S24]
Laugh & Lie Down	England	52	5	8/12	pairs only	no	—	—	cards vs 8	chips	[09-S42] [09-S69]
Culbas	France	52/32	3–8	5/8	pairs only	no	—	—	shedding	pool	[09-S43]
Papillon	France	52	3–4	3/7 (3p)	P, Σ (courts/10s P)	no	—	sauterelle 1	aces, feats, <i>papillon</i> takes pool	rounds	[09-S41] [09-S79]

Game	Region	Deck	Pl.	Deal (hand/table; re-deal)	Capture	B	Special-power cards	Sweep	Main scoring items	Target	Src
Snitch'ems	Yorkshire	52	2	3/4	P/prials, +8 / +10	no	—	—	majority of cards	1 deal	[09-S27] [09-S73]
Hachi-Hachi	Japan	48 hanafuda	3 active	—	Flip, month match	no	—	—	264 total, par 88, yaku	money	[09-S37]
Koi-Koi	Japan	48	2	8/8	Flip	no	—	—	yaku; koi-koi push-your-luck	12 months	[09-S52]
Go-Stop	Korea	48(+bonus)	2–3	10/8 (2p)	Flip	no	bonus cards	sseul steal	go/stop multipliers	3 or 7 to stop	[09-S36] [09-S53]
Chinese Ten	China/Thai/Indo	52	2–4	24/n; 4 table	+10, one card; Flip	no	—	—	red cards	—	[09-S35]

4.3 Mechanics library: candidate optional game modes (from note 09)

Each item below is a rule found in a real variant, so a mode can be named after its source game.

1. **Royal values** (J 11, Q 12, K 13, A 1/14) [09-S3][09-S76].
2. **Nordic dual-value hand cards** (A, ♠2, ♦10 worth more from hand than on the table) [09-S4][09-S63][09-S74]. This is historically the 1810 German rule.
3. **Target-sum capture**: Escoba +15 [09-S13], Pasur +11 [09-S19], Chinese Ten +10 [09-S35], Snitch'ems +8/+10 [09-S27].
4. **Single-capture discipline** (Scopa 1-of; single beats set) vs **multi-set capture** (Casino/Tablic) [09-S9][09-S2][09-S16].
5. **Building variants**:
 - None (Nordic) [09-S4].
 - Classic single/multiple builds [09-S2].
 - Swazi stealing into builds [09-S5].
 - Zwicker subtraction [09-S7].
 - Seep minimum-9 houses and one house per value [09-S24].
 - Diloti plain/group declarations [09-S21].
 - Danish $\pm \times \div$ combinations [09-S65].
6. **Calling** (American 1860s): lock a rank to pairing only [09-S75].
7. **Sequence capture + “caída” bonus for taking the previous player’s card**: Cuarenta, Ronda, Porrazo; Cicera’s “picada” [09-S15][09-S25][09-S26][09-S12].
8. **Wild sweepers**: Jack (Basra/Pasur/Piști), Ace (Asso pigliatutto/Cirulla), ♠5 (Danish), ♦7 (Basra), Jok-ers (Eléwénjewé) [09-S18][09-S19][09-S23][09-S9][09-S11][09-S65][09-S34].
9. **Sweep economics**:
 - Off / 1 point [09-S2].
 - Big sweeps: Basra 10, Pasur 5, Seep 50 [09-S18][09-S19][09-S24].
 - Cancelling sweeps: Dominican, Finnish, Pasur [09-S3][09-S4][09-S19].
 - Escalating streak “whirlwind” tactics [09-S10].

- Hungarian double turn after a sweep (anti-snowball) [09-S3].
 - Krypkasino +5/−5 [09-S6].
10. **Steal-the-pile:** Stealing Bundles (whole bundle) [09-S8]; Ghârat/Shlla'at (top cards) [09-S32][09-S33].
11. **Single-pile mode** (Pişti/Xeri), with an optional **bluff pişti** [09-S23][09-S22].
12. **Hand declarations/bonuses at the deal:**
- Ronda/tringa, with legal bluffing [09-S25].
 - Cirulla barsega/barsegon with a wild ♥7 [09-S11].
 - Chorizo Flor/Escalera [09-S14].
 - Scopa Bazzica [09-S9].
 - Cuarenta ronda [09-S15].
13. **Dealer table-sum bonus:** initial layout totals 15/30 (Escoba/Cirulla/Escopa) [09-S13][09-S11][09-S49].
14. **Endgame tension rules:**
- Dominican 18/19/20 “can only win by...” [09-S3].
 - Claim-out (“chiamarsi fuori”, “per shodam”, “Ausz!”, 21-point Cassino claims, with a penalty for false claims) [09-S9][09-S19][09-S3][09-S76].
 - Cuarenta 38-point limpia ban [09-S15].
15. **Misère modes:** Krypkasino, Laistokasino, Smyg, Give-away Casino [09-S6][09-S63][09-S64][09-S70].
16. **Draw-to-four** (Draw Cassino / dragkasino / pakkakasino) [09-S77][09-S62][09-S63].
17. **Double-deck modes** (Mulle “mulle” for identical cards; Krypkasino) [09-S4][09-S6].
18. **Flip-from-stock and push-your-luck “Koi-Koi / Go-Stop”** after scoring [09-S52][09-S53].
19. **Partnership aids:**
- “Build for partner” (with proof rules) [09-S2][09-S3][09-S7].
 - Asking a partner (Zwicker *Magger*) [09-S7].
 - Drifting as a signal (Swazi) [09-S5].
20. **Learning ladder** (Wippen): pairing → summing → building → raising → double-building [09-S61][09-S60].
21. **Rollover ties** (Finnish “pakkaan”; Basra’s 30 for cards rolls over) [09-S63][09-S18].
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5. Terminology

5.1 Key terms and where they come from

- **Cassino / Casino:**

- Both spellings date from 1792–93 [11 §V1].
- Italian *casino* meant a small house where “small Coteries meet, play at cards, generally sup together” (Lady Miller, Venice 1771) [04-S37].
- Etymonline: “The card game (also cassino) is attested by that name from 1792. Specifically as ‘building for aristocratic gambling’ by 1820” [04-S8].
- Italian *cassino* means a “box-cart” [02-S30]. Treccani gives *casino* no card-game sense [10-S47], and Pratesi found no game called Casino in Florentine club archives [09-S70].

- **Great / Big Cassino (♦10) and Little Cassino (♠2):**

- “Great” and “Little” from 1792 [11-V-S1]. “Big” in American speech by 1875 [04-S138].
- Regional nicknames:
 - “Good Ten” / “Good Two” (Pagat) [02-S1]
 - “big ten” / “spy two” (southern Africa) [02-S4]
 - Swedish *storan* / *lillan* and the colloquial *storkajsa* / *lillkajsa* / *lillstina*, which turn the cards into women’s names [10-S17]
 - Hester Piozzi’s “Decemvir” for the ten (1819) [04-S23]

- **Sweep:**

- In 1792–96 the word meant taking the leftover cards after the last trick [11 §V2][03-S5]. Clearing the board mid-game was described as “clears the Board” [11-V-S1].
- The mid-game sense of “sweep” appears by 1800 [03-S6].
- Translations have kept the broom image:
 - German *Kehraus* (1797) [11-V-S6]
 - Polish *wymiatacz* (“sweeper”) [10-S46]
 - French translators’ “coups de balai” (“broom strokes”) [10-S62]

- **Lurch:** a doubled loss when the loser scored under 6 (Long) [11-V-S1] or under 5 (1793 poem) [11-V-S2]. The 1797 German glosses it as “Bredouille” [11-V-S6].

- **Build, building up, call:** American, from 1866–67 [11 §V4][03-S15]. **Raise** is printed from 1894 (“raise the Build”) [03-S22]. **Trailing** appears from Foster 1897: “because he is simply following along waiting for opportunities” [03-S31][03-S23].

- **Cards and spades:** the two majority points gave American English the idiom “to give someone cards and spades”, meaning a big head start. Green’s earliest citation is from 1861 [04-S13].

5.2 English glossary (from note 05)

Format: term | definition (quoted where possible) | source(s) | earliest attestation found in fetched texts.

Note on “earliest attestation”: this is the earliest date among the sources fetched for this review (rulebooks, note 04’s newspaper searches and the primary-source checks in note 11). It is not a dictionary-grade first citation.

5.2a Game names, spellings, cards, and scoring objects

Term	Definition / usage	Source(s)	Earliest attestation found
Cassino	The game; double-s spelling. Wikipedia: “Cassino, sometimes spelt Casino, is an English card game for two to four players”	[05-S2]	1792, title of Long’s <i>Short rules for playing the game of cassino</i> [05-S3]; 1797 “caffino” [05-S4, 05-S5]
Casino	Single-s spelling; Pagat’s preferred headword. German sources “invariably use the spelling ‘Casino’” [05-S2]. A 2012 BGG user: searching “Casino” in the App Store “just yields a list of gambling apps!”; another notes “‘Cassino’ (note the doubled ‘s’)” finds the card game [05-S74-BGG826479]	[05-S1, 05-S2, 05-S74]	Etymonline: “The card game (also cassino) is attested by that name from 1792” [05-S79]
“Cersina” (folk pronunciation)	“One of my grandma’s favorite card games is called ‘Cassino’ Pronounced ‘Cersina’”	[05-S90 Reddit AskReddit 2023] [UGC]	—
cásino (Haiti)	In Haiti “pronounced with the stress on the first syllable: <i>cásino</i> ”	[05-S12]	—
Great Cassino	The ten of diamonds, 2 points. “Great Caffino, is the ten of diamonds, and reckons for two points” (1797)	[05-S4, 05-S7, 05-S8, 05-S9, 05-S10]	1792 (Long, p. 5, “Great Caffino”, confirmed from the page image) [11-V-S1]; 1797 [05-S4]
Big Cassino / Big Casino	Later name for the 10♦. “The Ten of diamonds, Big Cassino. 2”	[05-S11, 05-S1]	in rulebooks: Townsend 1891 (“Big Cassino”) [03-S20]; in speech: “big cassino” in an 1875 sermon and “little and big cassino” in 1878 [04-S138][04-S102][11 §V6]
Good Ten	Alternative name for 10♦ (“called Big Casino or the Good Ten”)	[05-S1]	— (cf. Greek «το 10 το καλό» [05-S24], Turkish “güzel onlu” [05-S68])
Big ten	South African name for 10♦ (“Ten of diamonds (‘big ten’)”)	[05-S13]	—
Little Cassino / Little Casino	The two of spades, 1 point. “Little Caffino, is the two of spades, and reckons for one point”	[05-S4, 05-S7, 05-S8, 05-S11, 05-S1]	1792 (Long, OCR “Little Caffino”) [05-S3]; 1797 [05-S4]
Good Two	Alternative name for 2♠	[05-S1]	—
Spy two	South African name for 2♠ (“Two of spades (‘spy two’)”)	[05-S13]	—
the Cassinos	Collective for both scoring cards: “every spade, every Ace, the Cassinos and the sweeps”	[05-S11]	1914 [05-S11]
Cards (the cards)	The 3-point majority of cards. Foster’s glossary: “Cards ... The majority of cards at Cassino”	[05-S4, 05-S8, 05-S11]	1797 “The Cards, is having a greater share of the pack than your adversary” [05-S4]
Spades (the spades)	1 point for majority of spades	[05-S4, 05-S8, 05-S11]	1797 [05-S4]
Aces	1 point each	[05-S4, 05-S8, 05-S11]	1797 [05-S4]
Natural points	Foster’s glossary: “those which must be made every deal, such as big and little cassino”	[05-S11]	1914 [05-S11]
Cash	“capturing an ace with another ace is called ‘cash’ by some players”	[05-S1]	—
Spade Cassino	Variant: every spade scores; game to 61, “scored on a cribbage board, every point being pegged immediately”	[05-S11, 05-S1]	1897 per Wikipedia [05-S2]; text seen in Foster 1914 [05-S11]
Royal Cassino / Royal Casino	Variant where J/Q/K = 11/12/13, A = 1 or 14	[05-S11, 05-S12]	Foster 1897 per [05-S2]; 1894 mention per [05-S2]
Draw Cassino	Each player “keeps his hand filled to four cards by drawing”	[05-S11]	Foster [05-S11]
Twenty-one Point Cassino	Played to 21; points “count out in the following order:—Cards first, then Spades, Big Cassino, Little Cassino, Aces, and Sweeps”	[05-S11, 05-S2]	1880 per [05-S2]; Foster 1914 text [05-S11]

Term	Definition / usage	Source(s)	Earliest attestation found
Set-back / Rounce Cassino	1867 name for the “European” 11-point subtraction game: “known as Set-back or Rounce Cassino”	[05-S8][11-V-S3] (\$12, V5)	1867 [05-S8]
Diamond Cassino	Modern 40-card variant (“cross between Cassino and Scopa”)	[05-S2]	Parlett 2008 per [05-S2]
Tuxedo	US Casino variant with Rook cards; players call “orange”	[05-S12]	—

5.2b Actions and play terms

Term	Definition / usage	Source(s)	Earliest attestation found
pair / pairing	Capturing equal-rank cards: “he can match or pair a card or cards on the table”	[05-S11, 05-S8]	1867 “When a player cannot, or does not choose to pair, combine, or build up” [05-S8]
combine / combining	Taking cards whose pips sum to the played card. 1867 term list: “To play a card which will take two or more cards of a different denomination...”	[05-S8, 05-S9, 05-S11]	1867 [05-S8]
take in / taking in	Capturing; Foster’s heading “Taking In”; “cards ... taken in or won”	[05-S11]	1914 [05-S11]; Swedish “ta in” parallel [05-S33]
capture	Modern rules-speak (“A build can be captured by playing a numeral card of the rank which was announced”)	[05-S1]	modern [05-S1]
build	“A card already built up” (1867); modern: cards combined “into builds, which can only be captured as a unit”	[05-S8, 05-S1]	1867 [05-S8]; Wikipedia claims “building up” first in Dick 1864 [05-S2], but Cassino was absent from the 1864 first edition; earliest building is 1866 [11 §V4]
building up	1867: playing a card on a table card and calling the total — “This is called building up”	[05-S8, 05-S9]	1867 [05-S8]
build from the table	“Employing cards on the table to continue a build” (Cassell’s term list)	[05-S9]	Cassell’s (3rd ed., n.d.) [05-S9]
single build	Build whose cards sum to the capture value, e.g. “a 5-build made of a 2 and a 3”	[05-S1]	modern [05-S1]
multiple build / double build / compound build	Two or more sets each equal to the value. Foster calls these “Double Builds”: “announcing the build as ‘Two Sevens.’ This cannot be increased”	[05-S11, 05-S1]	Foster [05-S11]; “compound build” [UNVERIFIED — not found as a phrase in fetched English sources; Swedish “sammansatt bygge” = compound build [05-S34]]
increase / raise a build	Foster: “Increasing Builds ... announcing the total value, ‘Ten.’” Pagat: “Adding to a build ... increasing the capturing number”	[05-S11, 05-S1]	Foster [05-S11]; 1867 example of A→“Seven”, 2→“Nine”, A→“Ten” [05-S8]
protected build	BGG user: building on another’s build “is allowed unless the build is ‘protected’ by either having multiple builds in the pile ... or it is topped with a card of the same rank”	[05-S74-BG-G597527] [UGC]	2010 [05-S74]
lock / locks	BGG user: “The second set within the build ‘locks’ it”	[05-S74-BG-G1893693] [UGC]	2017
“reserved”	A card in hand that is earmarked to capture an existing build: “you may not build or call with a card in your hand that is already reserved in another build or call”	[05-S78]	modern YouTube rules [05-S78]
calling / call	Locking pairs by playing a matching card and naming the rank in the plural: “he may play one of them on the table, at the same time calling the denomination ... the plural is always used. Thus: ‘Fours,’ not ‘Four.’ This is termed calling”	[05-S8, 05-S9]	1867 [05-S8]; Wikipedia credits Dick 1867 with first “calling” rules [05-S2]
build and call	Playing a duplicate on your own build and repeating the value — “the card so played is equivalent to a ‘call’”	[05-S8, 05-S2]	1867 [05-S8]
build for partner / “for partner”	Building toward a value partner is known to hold; must announce “for partner”	[05-S1, 05-S12]	Foster: partner may build “and ‘two Eights,’ called, although the player has no 8” [05-S11]
steal (a build)	Capturing someone else’s build: “It is thus possible to ‘steal’ a build created by another player”	[05-S1]	modern; Swedish “stjäla” ett bygge [05-S34]
trail / trailing	Playing a card without capture/build. Foster: “This is called trailing, because he is simply following along waiting for opportunities”	[05-S11, 05-S1]	1897 Foster, 1st ed. [05-S11b] (no “trail” in the 1792–1892 texts fetched)

Term	Definition / usage	Source(s)	Earliest attestation found
drifting	South African term: “In South Africa, playing a card without capturing is called drifting”; also playing a capturing card into a build instead	[05-S13]	—
chow	South African term for capture (“The capture or ‘chow’”)	[05-S13]	—
sweep	Clearing the table; 1 point. “The Sweep.—Matching all the cards on the board” (1867); “If at any time a player is able to win everything on the table with one card, it is a sweep” (Foster)	[05-S7, 05-S8, 05-S11]	“clears the Board” 1792 [11-V-S1]; “The Sweep” (= last cards) 1793/1796 [11-V-S2] [03-S5]; mid-game sense “a sweep before the end of the game ... reckons 1” 1800 [03-S6]
clear / clear board / clearing the board	Synonym for sweep: “Some players call this a clear” [05-S1]; “A clear board reckons 1” [05-S9]; “if he clears the board” [05-S7]; BGG “Clears” [05-S74]	[05-S1, 05-S7, 05-S9, 05-S74]	“he clears the Board” 1792 [11-V-S1]
sweeping the board	“scoring one point for thus ‘sweeping the board,’ as it is termed”	[05-S10]	1891 [05-S10]
final sweep	Taking the last cards at the end: “endeavouring likewise to win the last cards or final sweep”	[05-S7]	“final sweep” 1800 [03-S6]
the last / last cards / last trick	Remaining table cards go to the last capturer. “Last Cards.—Those cards remaining on the board after the last trick is taken”	[05-S8, 05-S9, 05-S11]	“Try to win the last Trick” 1792 [03-S1]; “Last Cards” glossary 1867 [03-S15]
“last” (dealer’s call)	“The dealer must announce ‘last’ when dealing the last cards”	[05-S1]	modern [05-S1]
residue	Cards left at the end, “sometimes known as the residue”	[05-S1]	modern [05-S1]
the board	The table layout: “matching all the cards on the board”	[05-S7, 05-S8, 05-S9]	“the Board” 1792 [11-V-S1]
the table	Same; modern dominant term	[05-S1, 05-S11]	—
layout / floor	“layout” (Pagat); “floor” is used in Basra/Seep descriptions (“known as the ‘floor’”)	[05-S1, 05-S20, 05-S31]	—
pile / capture pile	Captured cards “stores them all face down in a pile”	[05-S1]	modern
bundle	A player’s face-up capture pile in Stealing Bundles (“to start your ‘bundle’”)	[05-S16]	—
Stealing Bundles / Steal the Old Man’s Bundle / Steal Pile	Children’s fishing game where you capture an opponent’s whole bundle by matching its top card	[05-S16, 05-S74-BGG90163]	— (BGG: “It was called, appropriately enough, Steal Pile” [05-S74])
tricks	Old usage for captured cards: “The number of tricks are not to be examined or counted before all the cards are played”	[05-S7, 05-S8]	“face them like Tricks before you” 1792 [03-S1]
eldest hand	“The player sitting at the left hand of the dealer, so called because he is the first to play”	[05-S8, 05-S9]	1867 [05-S8]
pone	Player on dealer’s right (Foster)	[05-S11]	1914 [05-S11]
false build	“A build made without any card in hand to redeem it”	[05-S9]	Cassell’s [05-S9]
redeem (a build)	To capture one’s own build/call with the matching card (“holds no card ... with which to redeem or take the cards”)	[05-S8]	1867 [05-S8]
lurch	Loser under 6 when game is 11: “the points consist of eleven, and the lurch is six”	[05-S7, 05-S11, 05-S2]	“Six Points gained save the Lurch” 1792 [11-V-S1]; “The Lurch is Five” 1793 [11-V-S2]
count out / claim out	Foster: “agree to count out ... The moment he reaches 21 he should claim the game ... If he is mistaken, and cannot show out, he loses the game”	[05-S11]	1914 [05-S11]
showing	End-of-hand count: “each player counts his cards face downward, and announces the number”	[05-S11]	1914 [05-S11]
skunk / skunking	Family rule: “you can also win by ‘skunking’ someone during a round wherein you take all of the round’s points”	[05-S91 Reddit 2018] [UGC]	2018
World Series	Family custom of best-of-7 matches: “they regularly play ‘World Series’ best-of-7’s”	[05-S74-BG-G597527] [UGC]	2010
Cabin (mökki)	Finnish sweep term rendered in English on BGG: “Cabin variant (mökki)”	[05-S74-BG-G433043] [UGC]	2009

Term	Definition / usage	Source(s)	Earliest attestation found
Lazy Casino (Laisto Casino)	BGG rendering of Finnish <i>laistokasino</i> (misère)	[05-S74-BG-G433043]	2009

5.2c Required and illegal announcements (rules digest)

- **Must announce, audibly** — 1867 Law 11: “the player must declare the denomination of the proposed ‘build’ or ‘call,’ audibly and distinctly, so that no doubt of his intentions may exist, and failing to comply with this requirement, his opponent may separate the cards, and employ them in any lawful way” [05-S8, p. 220–221]. Example given: playing a Five on a Deuce is not a build “unless the player of the Five says ... audibly and distinctly, ‘Seven’”; for a call “he must announce his intention by saying, clearly and audibly, ‘Fives’” [05-S8].
- **Number of the noun is mandatory (19th c.)** — build = singular (“‘Nine’ or ‘Ten’—not ‘Nines’ or ‘Tens’”); call = plural (“‘Fours,’ not ‘Four’”); “calling out (not Five, but) ‘Fives’”; “call (not Four, but) ‘Fours’” [05-S8 pp. 218–220; 05-S9].
- **False builds** — 1867 Law 10: building or calling without a card “with which to redeem ... he forfeits two points, and the cards ... must be separated” [05-S8]. Foster: “the combination must be broken up, and the adversaries may take back the cards they have played” [05-S11].
- **Ambiguous announcements** — Pagat: playing a 5 on a 5 requires “announcing ‘building 10’ ... or ‘building 5’”; the announcement fixes what may capture it [05-S1]. Danish (unsourced wiki): if someone lays a 4 on a 4 “og glemmer at fortælle, om det er 8 eller mere 4, er det modstanderens pligt at spørge, hvad det er, man bygger” [*and forgets to say whether it is 8 or “more 4”, it is the opponent’s duty to ask what is being built*] [05-S43]. Finnish: “Jos esimerkiksi niputtaa kaksi kolmosta yhteen, pitää sanoa selvästi rakentaako kolmoselle vai kuutoselle” [*If you bundle two threes together you must say clearly whether you are building for three or for six*] [05-S40].
- **Can’t trail while you own a build** — “you are not allowed simply to trail a card ... You must either make a capture of some kind, create another build, or add to a build” [05-S1]; 1867 Law 8 [05-S8].
- **Can’t re-examine captured cards** — “nor may any trick but that last won be looked at, as every mistake must be challenged immediately” [05-S7, 05-S8]; Foster: errors “must be challenged and proved before the next trick is taken in” [05-S11].
- **Claiming the win** — Foster: a correct claim of 21 wins “even if his adversary has 21 or more”; a mistaken claim “loses the game” [05-S11]. Same structure in Tablić (“a player who claims to have won but turns out to have fewer than 101 points automatically loses”) [05-S26] and Pasur (“per shodam” [*I’m full*]; a false claim means “you have made a fool of yourself”) [05-S21].
- **Called-but-false bonus** — Tuxedo: “A false call of ‘orange’ incurs a 10 point penalty”; if you forget, “another player can score 10 points by calling ‘orange’” [05-S12].
- **Pointing out missed captures** — Dominican Royal Casino: cards left that could have been taken are “dejado” (left behind) or “pisado” (stepped on); “It is customary for the opponents to point out such cards” [05-S12].
- **Historical “table talk” cap** — Austen’s cassino table (1813): “Their table was superlatively stupid. Scarcely a syllable was uttered that did not relate to the game” [05-S6, ch. XXIX] — a period description of cassino as quiet, game-focused talk.

5.3 Per-language glossaries (from note 05)

Format: original | literal/English gloss | usage note | source.

5.4a Swedish (Kasino, Byggkasino, Krypkasino, Mulle)

Original	English	Notes	Source
kasino / <i>cassino</i> (older)	Cassino	SAOB: older spelling “cassino 1817—1883”; first Swedish card-game citation Düben, <i>Talisman</i> (1817): “Två .. kort, som characterisera Spelet, och hvilka bära namnet Cassino, nemligen Spader Tvåan och Ruter Tian” [<i>Two cards which characterise the game and bear the name Cassino, namely the two of spades and the ten of diamonds</i>]	[05-S36]
storan , also storstina , stora kasino	“the big one” = 10 ♦	“ruter tio som kallas för storan (även storstina eller stora kasino)” [<i>the ten of diamonds, called “the big one” (also “big Stina” or “big casino”)</i>]	[05-S33, 05-S34, 05-S35, 05-S14]
lillan , also lillstina , lilla kasino	“the little one” = 2 ♠	“spader två som kallas för lillan (lillstina eller lilla kasino)” [<i>the two of spades, called “the little one” (“little Stina” or “little casino”)</i>]	[05-S33, 05-S34, 05-S35]
lill-kajsa / lill-kasina / lill-stina	colloquial “little Kajsa/Stina” = Little Cassino	SAOB: “-KAJSA, äv. -KASINA. [av KASINO; i formen -KAJSA med anslutning till kvinnonamnet KAJSA] (vard.) spelt. ‘lilla kasino’” [-KAJSA, also -KASINA (from KASINO; in the form -KAJSA associated with the woman’s name Kajsa) (colloq.) card games: “little casino”]; “-STINA. [ombildning av -KASINA] (vard.) ... Östergren (1931)” [-STINA (reshaping of -KASINA) (colloq.) ... Östergren (1931)] — i.e., the cards were punningly turned into women’s names	[05-S38]
tabbe , tabberas	sweep	“säger man att hen har gjort en tabbe eller tabberas (ytterst av latinska ‘tabula rasa’, rent bord)” [<i>one says they have made a tabbe or tabberas (ultimately from Latin tabula rasa, clean table)</i>]	[05-S33, 05-S34]
tabbe (etymology/date)	—	SAOB tabbe sbst. ² : “[efter TABELRAS l. TABLE RASE] kortsp. i kortspelet kasino: förhållandet att ta hem alla kort på bordet. Werner o. Sandgren Kortox. 53 (1949)” [(after TABELRAS or TABLE RASE) card games: in the card game kasino, the act of taking home all the cards on the table. Werner and Sandgren, Kortox. 53 (1949)]. Note the homonym tabbe sbst. ¹ = “blunder, gaffe” — an easy pun for VO (“en tabbe!”)	[05-S37]
tabbar	sweeps (plural)	“För att hålla koll på alla tabbar” [<i>To keep track of all the sweeps</i>]	[05-S32, 05-S14]
tvångstabbe	forced sweep (Krypkasino)		[05-S15, 05-S33]
“tabbe på knekt” / “tabbe på 9”	“sweep for a jack / for a nine”	Krypkasino courtesy announcement when you leave a capturable table: “En spelare som till exempel spelar ♣4 när det bara ligger ♠7 på bordet bör säga ‘tabbe på knekt’” [<i>A player who, for example, plays ♣4 when there is only ♠7 on the table should say “sweep for a jack”</i>]	[05-S33, 05-S15]
sistan	“the last one” — last capture point and dealer’s warning	“När given delar ut de sista korten ska denne informera alla ... genom att helt enkelt säga ‘sistan’ eller ‘båt’” [<i>When the dealer deals out the last cards, they must inform everyone ... by simply saying “the last one” or “boat”</i>]	[05-S32, 05-S14]
båt / båten / “båten går”	“boat” / “the boat’s leaving”	Synonyms of sistan; dealer may say “‘sistan’, ‘båten går’ eller ‘sista given’” [<i>“the last one”, “the boat’s leaving” or “last deal”</i>]	[05-S34, 05-S33, 05-S14]
ta in	take in (capture)		[05-S33]
lägga ut	lay out (trail)	“Man säger att spelaren lägger ut” [<i>One says that the player lays out</i>]	[05-S33, 05-S34]
krypa	to creep/crawl = trail without capturing (Krypkasino)	“Att lägga ut ett kort på bordet kallas för att krypa” [<i>Laying a card out on the table is called creeping</i>]	[05-S15, 05-S35-Kryp-kasino]
havet , fiska	“the sea”, “to fish”	“På svenska säger man att korten på bordet utgör havet och att spelarna fiskar upp kort därifrån” [<i>In Swedish one says the table cards are “the sea” and players “fish” cards from it</i>]	[05-S32]
bygga nytt / bygga på	build new / build on (increase)		[05-S34]
enkelt bygge / sammansatt bygge	single build / compound (multiple) build		[05-S34]
fria kort	loose cards		[05-S34]
“bygger till elva” / “bygger till knekt”	“building to eleven / to jack”	Required announcement of a single build	[05-S34]
“två åttor” / “tre tior”	“two eights” / “three tens”	Announcing a compound build by value and number of parts	[05-S34]

Original	English	Notes	Source
“ligger” / “åttan ligger” / “femman ligger” / “knekten ligger”	“lies” / “the eight lies [stays]”	Said when laying a same-rank card to make a locked build instead of capturing (“brukar spelaren förtydliga att hen inte tänker ta in korten genom att annonsera bygget med ‘ligger’” [<i>the player usually makes clear that they do not intend to take in the cards by announcing the build with “lies”</i>])	[05-S34]
“storan privat”	“big casino, private”	Build to 16 that only the 10♦ can take: “Vissa spelare understryker att bygget bara kan tas in av detta enda kort genom att annonsera det med ‘storan privat’” [<i>Some players stress that the build can only be taken in by this one card by announcing it with “big one private”</i>]	[05-S34]
“bygga åt sin partner”	build for one’s partner		[05-S34]
“stjåla” ett bygge	“steal” a build		[05-S34]
överspader	“over-spades” scoring variant	1 point per spade beyond six	[05-S14, 05-S32]
dragkasino	draw-cassino		[05-S33, 05-S35]
kasino misär / omvänd kasino / avig kasino	misère / reversed / “wrong-side-out” cassino		[05-S33, 05-S35-Kryp-kasino]
kasino kryp	reverse Cassino (family name)	Reddit: “In swedish we call it ‘kasino kryp’”; poster’s family says “Sweep 9” when setting up a forced sweep	[05-S92] [UGC]
mulle	capture of an identical card (same rank & suit) in the two-deck game Mulle	Mulle “verkar ha en särskild status på svenska fångvårdsanstalter. Glimne kallar spelet för ‘kåkfarrarvarianten av kasino’” [<i>seems to have special status in Swedish prisons; Glimne calls it “the jailbird variant of kasino”</i>]	[05-S14, 05-S33-index]

5.4b Norwegian

Original	English	Notes	Source
lillekasino / storekasino	little/big cassino	“spar 2 (lillekasino), og to poeng for ruter 10 (storekasino)” [<i>two of spades (little casino), and two points for the ten of diamonds (big casino)</i>]	[05-S42]
stikk / ta stikk / stikke	trick / take a trick (capture)		[05-S41, 05-S42]
bygge / bygg / doble et bygg	build / to “double” a build		[05-S41] [wiki, tagged unsourced]
tabbe	sweep (one extra point)		[05-S41]
“døgga”	local name for the last round	“siste runde kalles ‘døgga’” [<i>the last round is called “døgga”</i>]	[05-S41] [wiki, unsourced – treat as UNVERIFIED]
smyg / krypkasino	misère variant		[05-S41]
byggekasino	building variant		[05-S42]

5.4c Danish

Original	English	Notes	Source
store kasino / lille kasino	big / little cassino		[05-S43, 05-S44]
svupper	sweep (clearing the table)	Lex.dk: “Udtrykket ‘at rydde bordet’ kendes blandt andet fra kasino, hvor det betyder, at man hjemtager samtlige kort på bordet og får en ‘svupper’, dvs. et ekstra point” [<i>The expression “to clear the table” is known from kasino, meaning taking all the cards and getting a “svupper”, i.e., an extra point</i>]	[05-S44, 05-S43]
at rydde bordet	to clear the table	idiom traced to kasino	[05-S44]
sidsten	“the last”	dealer marks last round “ved at udmelde ‘sidsten’” [<i>by announcing “sidsten”</i>]	[05-S43] [wiki, unsourced]
udsmidning / matching / kombinere / bygning	discard (trail) / matching / combining / building		[05-S43]
“bygger 9”	“building 9”		[05-S43]
“mere syv”	“more seven” = locked same-rank build	“lægge en 7'er oven på en 7'er og melde ‘mere syv’” [<i>lay a 7 on top of a 7 and announce “more seven”</i>]	[05-S43]

Original	English	Notes	Source
bygge dobbelt / trip-pelt	build double / triple		[05-S43]
spar 5 rydder bordet	five of spades clears the table (house rule in Danish wiki)		[05-S43] [un-sourced]

5.4d Finnish (Kasino)

Original	English	Notes	Source
mökki (pl. mökit)	“hut/cabin” = sweep	Pagat: “an extra point for each sweep, known in Finnish as a mökki (hut)”; fi-wiki: “Jos pelaaja nostaa omalla vuorollaan kaikki kortit pöydästä, hän saa mökin” [<i>If a player lifts all cards from the table on their turn, they get a mökki</i>]	[05-S14, 05-S39, 05-S40]
mökki kaatuu / kaataa mökin	the hut “falls” / to knock down a hut	Sweep cancellation: “mökkiä ei oteta itselle vaan sen sijaan kaadetaan yksi vastapuolen mökeistä” [<i>you don’t take a hut for yourself; instead one of the opponent’s huts is knocked down</i>]	[05-S40, 05-S39]
patakakkonen = pieni kasino	two of spades = little casino (“Pikku-Kasino” in a commenter’s usage)	“Patakakkonen eli pieni kasino on kädessä 15 ja pöydässä tavallinen kakkonen” [<i>The two of spades, or “little casino”, is 15 in the hand and an ordinary two on the table</i>]	[05-S40, 05-S39]
ruutukymppi = iso kasino	ten of diamonds = big casino	“ruutukymppi eli iso kasino on kädessä 16 ja pöydässä 10” [<i>the ten of diamonds, or “big casino”, is 16 in the hand and 10 on the table</i>]	[05-S40, 05-S39]
pata / padat	spade(s)	from French <i>pique</i> via Swedish <i>spader</i> (fi-wiki); Kasino aim: “kerätä ... patoja” [<i>collect ... spades</i>]	[05-S39, 05-S93]
risti	clubs (♣); risti = “cross”	general Finnish suit name (“nimi on vaihtunut ulkomuodon perusteella ristiksi” [<i>the name changed to “cross” on the basis of its appearance</i>]), not Kasino-specific	[05-S93]
ruutu	diamonds (♦)	“Suomenkielinen nimi johdettiin ruotsinkielisestä nimestä” [<i>The Finnish name was derived from the Swedish name</i>] (ruter)	[05-S93]
ässä	ace (14 in hand, 1 on table)		[05-S39, 05-S40]
sotilas / jätkä, rouva / kuningatar, kuningas	jack, queen, king	“jätkällä jätkän, rouvalla rouvan” [<i>a jack with a jack, a queen with a queen</i>]	[05-S40]
korttivoitto / patavoitto	“card win” / “spade win” (majorities)		[05-S39, 05-S40]
“pakkaan”	“into the deck” — tied majority points carry over to next deal		[05-S39, 05-S40]
nostaa / napata / ottaa	lift / snatch / take (capture)		[05-S39, 05-S40]
pöytäminen	“tabling” = trailing		[05-S39]
etukäsi	eldest hand		[05-S40]
rakennuskasino / rakentaa / rakennus	building-kasino / to build / a build		[05-S39, 05-S40]
“rakennan ässälle”	“I’m building for the ace”	Example announcement: “kympin päälle voisi pelata nelosen ja sanoa ‘rakennan ässälle’” [<i>on a ten one could play a four and say “I’m building for the ace”</i>]	[05-S40]
“rakennan yhdeksikölle”, “rakennan kuutoselle”	“I’m building for the nine / for the six”		[05-S40]
korottaa	to raise (a build)		[05-S39, 05-S40]
kaksoisrakennus	double build (cannot be raised)		[05-S39, 05-S40]
laistokasino	“shirking” (misère) kasino		[05-S39, 05-S40]
pakkakasino	draw kasino		[05-S39, 05-S40]
pimeä kasino	“dark kasino” — flip top card blindly (a children’s luck game)	commenter Olli, 2014	[05-S40] [UGC]

Original	English	Notes	Source
“kiroilla onneaan”	“to curse one’s luck” (after an opponent’s double mökki)	commenter Lauri, 2023	[05-S40] [UGC]

5.4e German / Austrian / Hungarian / Flemish

Original	English	Notes	Source
Großes Casino / Kleines Casino	Big / Little Casino		[05-S45]
ablegen / paaren / kombinieren / bauen	trail / pair / combine / build		[05-S45]
geräumter Tisch	cleared table (sweep)		[05-S45]
“eine Karte für den Tisch bringen”	“bring a card for the table” (forced trail after a sweep)		[05-S45]
Zwick (Zwicker)	sweep bonus (“equivalent to the English ‘tweak’”)		[05-S28]
das Bild	“the picture” = table cards (Zwicker)		[05-S28]
“13 for partner”	Zwicker build announcement for partner		[05-S28]
Kaszinó (Hungarian)	Hungarian Casino		[05-S12]
tábla	sweep (Hungarian)		[05-S12]
csere	last capture		[05-S12]
“Ausz!”, “Ausz vagyok!”, “Kint vagyok!”	“Out!”, “I’m out!”	Said to stop the game on reaching 11	[05-S12]
pikkje van	“has the spades” (majority of spades)		[05-S12]
Wippen / Wip (Flemish)	Belgian name; “A sweep is known as a Wip”		[05-S1]

5.4f Italian (Scopa, Scopone, Cirulla, relatives)

Original	English	Notes	Source
scopa (pl. scope)	broom → sweep	“capturing all the cards on the table leaving it empty, which is known as a scopa (sweep)”	[05-S17, 05-S46, 05-S47]
fare scopa	to make a sweep	“realizza una scopa, che vale un punto” [<i>makes a scopa, which is worth one point</i>]	[05-S46]
“Scopa!”	shouted at the sweep	see §6.4c	[05-S48, 05-S49]
settebello / sette bello, also “Piricchio”	“beautiful seven” = 7 of coins/diamonds	it-wiki: “Settebello (o ‘Piricchio’)” [<i>Settebello (or “Piricchio”)</i>]	[05-S46, 05-S27]
primiera / settanta	prime (best four-suit set)	“Primiera o Settanta” [<i>Primiera or Settanta (“seventy”)</i>]	[05-S46, 05-S17]
re bello / rebello	king of coins bonus		[05-S46, 05-S17]
napola / napoletana, napoleone	coins sequence bonus		[05-S46, 05-S17]
punti di mazzo	“deck’s points” (the four standard points)		[05-S47]
la matta	the King of Coins used to pick dealer	“fino all’uscita della ‘matta’ (Re di Denari)” [<i>until the “matta” (King of Coins) comes out</i>]	[05-S46]
“burning an ace” (bruciare un asso)	playing an ace when one is already on the table (Scopa d’assi) — “every player will try to avoid”		[05-S47]
accusare / accuse	to declare hand combinations (Bazzica scopa)		[05-S46]

Original	English	Notes	Source
bussare	to knock on the table to claim a hand bonus (Cirulla)	“claims a hand bonus ... by knocking on the table (bussare)”	[05-S27, 05-S47]
cappotto	capturing the whole coin suit (instant win, Cirulla)		[05-S27]
scopa a cascina	Scopa variant with building (“cascina” = farmhouse/stack)	“giocare una carta sopra a una di quelle in tavola, se si possiede una carta che permette di catturarle entrambe al giro successivo” [play a card on top of one of those on the table, if one holds a card that can capture both on the next turn]	[05-S46]
scopa a fidasse (“a fidarsi”)	“trust-me scopa” — bluff sweep	Claimant asks “ vi fidate? ” / “ ti fidi? ” [do you (pl./sg.) trust me?]; a false scopa caught loses a point, a doubter of a true one loses a point	[05-S46]
maresciallo / marescial-lone / saponificatrice / argentina	K♠ penalty card (“marshal”), K♠-on-K♠ scopa, Q♠ penalty (“soap-maker”), Q♦ bonus	regional Maresciallo variant	[05-S46]
rosmarino	J♠ bonus (“rosemary”)		[05-S46]
rubamazzo / rubamazzet-to	“steal the deck” (= Stealing Bundles)		[05-S16, 05-S46]
“A chi tocca?” / “Tocca a me” / “Tocca a te”	“Whose turn?” / “My turn” / “Your turn”	listed as “Fun words to say while you play”	[05-S50] [blog]
Ligurian suit names dinë, coppe, scioi, spoæ/spâ	money, cups, flowers, swords	used for French suits in Cirulla	[05-S27]

5.4g Spanish — Escoba (Spain, Argentina, Uruguay, Chile)

Original	English	Notes	Source
escoba	broom → sweep	“The name of the game means ‘broom’”	[05-S18]
escoba de quince / escoba del 15	broom-of-15	captures sum to 15	[05-S18]
“cada escoba cantada vale 1 punto”	“each escoba sung/called out is worth 1 point”	<i>cantar</i> = to call aloud; implies the sweep is announced	[05-S51]
cartas / oros / siete de velo / guindis / la setenta	cards / coins / 7 of coins (“velo” or “guindis”) / the prime (“seventy”)		[05-S18]
“¡Soplo!” / “asoplo”	“blow!” — calling out an opponent’s missed 15 to take it	forum, 2005: “claro ke puedes sumar tu esas 15, pero tienes que gritarle un ASOPLO!!!, para que quede constancia” [of course you can take those 15 yourself, but you have to shout “asoplo!!!” at her so it’s on record]	[05-S52] [UGC]
Chorizo / Béciga / Flor / Escalera / Tres de nueve / Dos de miseria	Uruguayan declarable hand combos	declared aloud “immediately before playing the first of their three cards”	[05-S83]
Casita robada	“stolen little house” (= Stealing Bundles)		[05-S16]

5.4h Spanish — Cuarenta (Ecuador)

Original	English	Notes	Source
caída	“a fall” — capturing by matching the card just played by the previous player (2 pts)		[05-S19, 05-S53, 05-S56]
limpia	“a cleansing” — clearing the table (2 pts)		[05-S19, 05-S53]
caída y limpia	both at once	40caidaylimpia: “Se otorgan 2 puntos más el permiso de burlarse de los contrincantes ” [2 points plus permission to mock the opponents]	[05-S59, 05-S53]
ronda / doble ronda	three / four of a rank dealt	announced immediately after the deal	[05-S19, 05-S53]
“dos por guapo”	“two for being handsome”	phrase used to claim the ronda bonus	[05-S57, 05-S59, 05-S55]
“dos por shunsho”, “¡Toma, dos por shunsho!”	“two for [shunsho]” / “Take that, two for shunsho!”	said at the moment of a caída; <i>shunsho</i> gloss not found [UNVERIFIED meaning]	[05-S56, 05-S57, 05-S58, 05-S54]

Original	English	Notes	Source
“dos señor juez” / “dos por favor, señor juez” / “dos juecito”	“two, Mr. Judge” / “two please, Mr. Judge” / “two, little judge”	claiming caída points from the scorer-judge	[05-S56, 05-S59, 05-S55]
“con esta te caigo”	“with this one I’ll fall on you”	said while holding the card to your forehead	[05-S57, 05-S54]
“as que no me caerás”	“ace that you won’t fall on me”		[05-S57]
“Capariche”	(unglossed)	said “cuando se realiza una caída o limpia que levante muchas cartas de la mesa” [<i>when a caída or limpia is made that lifts many cards from the table</i>]	[05-S57]
“Cuatrero has de ser”	“You must be a rustler” (<i>cuatrero</i> = cattle-thief; wordplay on <i>cuatro</i>)	said “cuando lanzan la baraja con el número 4” [<i>when the card with the number 4 is thrown</i>]	[05-S57, 05-S58]
“marido tiene”, “José me llamo”, “la foto”, “dolido va”	“she has a husband”, “my name is José”, “the photo”, “he goes off hurt”	listed vocabulary/distractors (meanings not explained in sources)	[05-S56, 05-S58, 05-S54]
“treinta y ocho que no juega” / “38 que no juega”	“38 doesn’t play” — at 38 you can only win by a caída		[05-S56, 05-S59, 05-S53, 05-S54]
zapatero / zapatería / “zapateros se quedaron”	“shoemaker” — losing a chica with < 10 points; “they stayed shoemakers”	El Telégrafo: losers “deben lustrar los zapatos a los rivales” [<i>must shine the rivals’ shoes</i>]; tournament “rincón de la zapatería” [<i>the shoe-shop corner</i>]	[05-S53, 05-S55, 05-S58, 05-S59]
perro / tanto	“dog” (10 pts) / “tally” (2 pts) score cards		[05-S53, 05-S56, 05-S59]
viejas	“old ladies” = J, Q, K		[05-S56, 05-S59]
chica / mesa / data / cartón	40-point game / match / a deal / one’s captured cards		[05-S53, 05-S54]
“pasa la mano con diez”	“the deal passes, with ten” — misdeal penalty		[05-S59, 05-S53]
“dos por darlas” / “dos por dar”	“two for dealing them”	tie-break points	[05-S53, 05-S59]
“dos por falla”	“two for failure” — “es una gran vergüenza” [<i>it is a great shame</i>]		[05-S59]
“veo y juego”	“I see and I play” — formal challenge of a capture		[05-S59]
Juez de Aguas	“Water Judge” — referee/scorer		[05-S59]
“cuarenta señores, gracias”	“Forty, gentlemen, thank you” — winner’s sign-off		[05-S57]
“todo dos” / “a todo rigor”	Quito “everything is two” vs “strict” scoring		[05-S53, 05-S58]

5.4i Portuguese (Brazil / Portugal)

Original	English	Notes	Source
Escova / jogo de escovas	“brush” — Portuguese/Brazilian Escoba	“faz uma ‘escova’ e deverá colocar uma delas desvirada na sua pilha” [<i>makes an “escova” and must place one of them face up in their pile</i>]	[05-S73]
carteador	dealer		[05-S73]
Primeira	prime		[05-S73]
“grande cassino” / “pequeno cassino”	big/little cassino	[UNVERIFIED — appears only in a search-engine summary of a login-walled Brazilian forum; page returned 403]	—
“varrer” (to sweep)	—	[UNVERIFIED — not found in any fetched Portuguese source]	—

5.4j Arabic — Chkobba (Tunisia) and Basra/Bastra (Egypt, Levant, Gulf)

Original	English	Notes	Source
chkobba / škubba (شكوبة)	sweep (from Italian <i>scopa</i>)	“Capturing all the cards from the layout leaving it empty is called a chkobba”; verb “chkobber”	[05-S17, 05-S66]

Original	English	Notes	Source
'akala (أكَل) “manger”	“to eat” = capture	“faire le pli (أكَل 'akala ou « manger » en arabe)” [<i>to take the trick</i> (أكَل 'akala, or “to eat” in Arabic)]	[05-S66]
kārṭa (كارطة)	the cards (majority)		[05-S17, 05-S66]
dīnārī (ديناري)	diamonds (from Italian <i>denari</i>)		[05-S17, 05-S66]
barmīla (برميلة)	prime (from <i>primiera</i>)		[05-S17, 05-S66]
sab'a l-ḥayya (سبعة الحية) / al-ḥayya	“the living seven” = 7 ♦		[05-S17, 05-S66]
bājī (باجي)	a tied point (“Lorsqu’il y a égalité ... il est déclaré bājī” [<i>When there is a tie ... it is declared bājī</i>])		[05-S66]
card names laṣ, dū, trīs, kwātrū, šīnkū, sis, sab'a, mu-jira, kawwāl, rayy	A,2,3,4,5,6,7,Q,J,K (Sicilian/Spanish/French loans)		[05-S66]
“CHKOBAAAA!”, “Sab3a l-7ayya!”, “Barmīla!”, “Wesh hadi?!”, “Yaser ya 3ammi!” [<i>That’s a lot, uncle! (?)</i>], “Rak tel3ab bel 7adh ken!” [<i>You’re only playing on luck!</i>], “Khallini narba7 marra!”, “Yallah Nel3bou!”	sweep shout; 7 ♦ shout; prime shout; “What’s this?!”; hype; trash-talk; “let me win once!”; “let’s play!”	promotional site — use as flavour, verify with a native speaker	[05-S67] [promo]
Racham (رشام), El Ghaffas (الغفاس), Tannbir (التنبير)	café scorekeeper; the sore loser; spectators’ sneaky commentary		[05-S67] [promo]
basra	sweep worth 10 (Egypt); in Lebanon, specifically capturing a lone card		[05-S20, 05-S61, 05-S62]
double basra	jack takes lone jack (20)		[05-S20, 05-S61]
“the floor”	the table area (“maybe the game was originally played on the floor”)		[05-S20]
ashush / imam	the jack; “it is an imam that ‘eats’ everything else on the floor”; “In Bahrain, I have heard people referring to the knave as imam” (Khuri 1990, quoted)		[05-S20]
komai	7 ♦ (Ethiopian basra)		[05-S61]
Assaba-al'-Komi	alternative (Yemeni) name of Basra		[05-S20]

5.4k Persian — Pâsur

Original	English	Notes	Source
pâsur (پاسور)	the game; also “playing cards” in general	“can also mean playing cards more generally in everyday Persian”; name from Russian per Wikipedia (citing Marashi 1994)	[05-S65, 05-S64, 05-S21]
sur / soor (سور)	sweep (5 pts)		[05-S21, 05-S64, 05-S65]
haft khâj (هفت خاج)	“seven clubs” — 7+ clubs bonus		[05-S21, 05-S65]
chahâr barg	“four cards” (alt. name)		[05-S21, 05-S64]
yâzdahtâyi	“eleveny” (alt. name)		[05-S21]
haft va chahâr, yâzdah	“seven and four, eleven” (alt. name)		[05-S21]
“per shodam”	“I’m full / I’m done” — stopping the game on reaching 62		[05-S21]
pasur ru baaz (پاسور رو باز)	“open pasur” variant		[05-S64]

5.4l Greek — Xeri, Kontsina, Diloti

Original	English	Notes	Source
ξηρή (xeri)	“dry, plain” — capturing a lone card (Xeri) / clearing the table (Diloti)	Pagat: “from the Greek adjective ‘ξηρή’ meaning dry or plain”	[05-S22, 05-S23]

Original	English	Notes	Source
κάνει ξερή / κάνεις ξερή	“makes a xeri”	“Πότε κάνεις ξερή; Ξερή κάνει ο παίχτης όταν κάτω υπάρχει μόνο ένα φύλο” [When do you make a xeri? When there’s only one card down...]	[05-S70, 05-S71]
ξερή με βαλέ	xeri with a jack (20)		[05-S71]
το καλό 10 / το καλό δύο	“the good 10” (10♦) / “the good two” (2♣)	«το 2 το καλό» and «το 10 το καλό»; “one could alternatively call them the ‘lucky 2’ and the ‘lucky 10’”	[05-S24, 05-S70]
Δηλωτή (Diloti)	“declared” — from «δηλώνω» “to declare”		[05-S23]
δηλώνω / δήλωση	to declare / a declaration (= build)	“Usually the player will verbally declare the value of the pile ... though this is not obligatory”	[05-S23, 05-S72]
«οκτάρια»	“eights” — group declaration of eights	“δεν πρέπει ... να τα βάλουμε όλα μαζί δηλώνοντας «οκτάρια»” [we must not ... put them all together declaring “eights”]	[05-S72]
«σόι» (soi)	“kin/family” — a pair-of-equal-cards declaration	“δηλώνουμε «σόι» βάζοντας ένα 3 πάνω σε κάποιο 3” [we declare “kin” by putting a 3 on top of a 3]	[05-S72, 05-S23]
“two 9’s” / “group of 9’s” / “family of 9’s”	Pagat’s English for group declarations		[05-S23]
χαρτωσιά	a round/deal of cards		[05-S72]
Κοντσίνια / Κολτσίνια / Κολιτσίνια	Kontsina (children’s game)		[05-S24]
καφενεία	coffeehouses — Diloti “το πιο παραδοσιακό παιχνίδι τράπουλας στα καφενεία” [the most traditional card game in the coffeehouses]		[05-S72]

5.4m Turkish — Pişti / Pişpirik

Original	English	Notes	Source
pişti	“cooked” — capturing a lone card (10 pts)	Pagat: “The word ‘pişti’, which means ‘cooked’”; first in Ahmed Vefik Paşa’s <i>Lugat-ı Osmani</i> (1876) as “kâğıt oyunu” [card game]	[05-S25, 05-S68]
pişpirik	alt. name		[05-S25, 05-S68]
kesmek	“to cut” — to capture (matching or with a jack)		[05-S68]
güzel onlu / karo onlu	“beautiful ten” (10♦, 3 pts)		[05-S68]
güzel ikili / sinek ikili	“beautiful two” (2♣, 2 pts)		[05-S68]
vale (bacak)	jack (“leg”)		[05-S68]
kart fazlası	card majority		[05-S68]
“İlk elin günahı olmaz”	“The first hand has no sin” — saying used when the first capture leaves the next player exposed to a pişti		[05-S68]
pişti olmak	idiom: two people unintentionally doing the same thing at once		[05-S94]

5.4n Other relatives (brief)

Language/game	Term	Gloss	Source
Catalan, <i>Cau Robot</i>	“cau”, “recau”, “contracau”	said aloud when matching the previous player’s non-capturing card, then re-matching	[05-S29]
French-Canadian, <i>Mitaines</i>	“mitten” / “glove” / “sock” (mitaine, gant, chausson); “clearing for 10”	called when starting a pair/three/four	[05-S30]
Hindi/Punjabi, <i>Seep</i>	Seep/Sip/Sweep, house, “bid for a house”, baazi, satthi		[05-S31]
Serbian/Balkan, <i>Tablic</i>	tabla (sweep); Macedonian “peeshee”		[05-S26]
Southern Africa	chow (capture), drifting (trail), spy two, big ten, crazy casino; Namibia: Omulongo Womadi; “Khasino” (South African association KASA, “40 on Deck”)		[05-S13, 05-S80, 05-S81]

Language/game	Term	Gloss	Source
Dominican Republic (Spanish)	Captura / Cojer, Forma (build), Virados (sweeps), diez de casino, dos de casino, espadas, dejado / pisado	Royal Casino is described by a Reddit user as “the national card game of the dominican republic”	[05-S12, 05-S95]
Haiti	cásino (stress on first syllable)		[05-S12, 05-S80]
English 18th c., <i>Snitch’ems</i>	name “may derive from the dialect word ‘snitch’ in the sense of to steal/pilfer”		[05-S82]

6. Table talk: what people say during the game

6.1 The announcement is part of the rules (a timeline)

The single most important finding for voice-over and UI is that, from 1867 on, **what a player said changed what the move legally was**.

- **1792:** Long's forerunner of the call is silent. You lay one card of a pair "and wait your Turn", and the cards are not protected [03-S1].
- **1866:** Dick's building example has the players speak the totals: "the dealer puts an ace upon it and says 'seven,' ... the non-dealer throws a deuce upon them and says 'nine,' ... the dealer again puts upon the heap his other ace, and cries 'ten'" [03-S14].
- **1867:** the *American Hoyle* makes speech binding. "the player must declare the denomination of the proposed 'build' or 'call,' audibly and distinctly, ... and failing to comply with this requirement, his opponent may separate the cards." "No announcement ... possesses any value whatever, unless the above condition be strictly observed" [11-V-S3][03-S15].
 - Grammar encodes the move type. A build is singular ("Nine"), a call is plural ("Fives") [03-S15].
 - A false build or call "forfeits two points" [03-S15].
- **1877–1880:** letters to the *New York Dispatch* answers column record real disputes word for word. They show singular "seven" and plural "sevens" in use [04-S155]:
 - "A plays a four spot, C puts a three on it, calling 'seven;' ... D ... plays ace on B's six, and putting it on his partner (C's) seven, calls 'sevens'" [04-S155].
 - A player locks a combination by calling it "fives all" [04-S155].
 - "Can B put an ace on top of the nine and call it ten? He cannot, as the call is nin[es]" [04-S155].
- **1891:** Townsend adds explicit verbs, "I build seven" (not sevens) and "I call sixes". His reason: "to avoid the disputes caused by misunderstanding whether singular or plural number was called" [03-S20].
- **1894:** in Dick's rewritten *American Hoyle*, saying the number can end your turn. "if A had said 'nine' when he played his Ace, this would have completed his play" [03-S22].
- **1897–1914:** Foster's forms are "Nine", "Ten", "Two Sevens", "Two Nines", and "'two Eights,' called" for a partner [03-S31].
- **1904:** the penalty for silence is still in the *Standard Hoyle*: "If in building the player fail to call the build, his adversaries have the right to disperse the cards" [03-S25].
- **1945–1952:** "Building eight" / "Building sevens" [03-S35]; "building six" / "building fours" [03-S36].
- **Today:** Pagat requires "building 5", "building 9 for partner" [02-S1].
 - Equivalents in other languages:
 - Danish "bygger ni" [*building nine*] and, for a same-rank lock, "mere syv" ("more seven") [10-S37]
 - Swedish "bygger till knekt" [*building to jack*], "två åttor" [*two eights*], "åttan ligger" [*the eight lies*], "storan privat" [*big one private*] [10-S25]
 - Finnish "rakennan ässälle" ("I'm building for the ace") [10-S1]
 - Norwegian "bygger 9" [*building 9*] [10-S32]
 - German Wippen "Für 9" [*For 9*] / "Nochmal für 5" [*Again for 5*] [01-S60]

- Russian “Строю 7” [*I build 7*] / “Строю восьмерки” [*I build eights*] [10-S57]
- Italian “costruisco un sei” [*I build a six*] [01-S23]
- Brazilian Portuguese “construindo seis” [*building six*] [10-S49]
- The duty to ask is also attested. In Danish, if a player forgets to say whether a 4 on a 4 is “8 eller mere 4” [8 or “more 4”], “er det modstanderens pligt at spørge” (it is the opponent’s duty to ask) [01-S11].

6.2 The dealer’s “last”

- English: “The dealer must announce”last” when dealing the last cards” [02-S1]. An older Wikipedia text gives “cards” [01-S5].
- The rule is old. “When the last cards are being dealt, the dealer must announce that fact” (1949) [03-S35]. “Before dealing the final round, dealer must announce the fact that it is the last” (1952) [03-S36].
- Other languages:
 - Swedish “sistan” [*the last one*], “båt” [*boat*], “båten går” [*the boat’s leaving*], “sista given” [*last deal*] [10-S24]
 - Norwegian “sisten” [*the last*] [10-S32], with a local “døgga” [01-S26]
 - Danish “sidsten” [*the last one*] [10-S37]
 - Brazilian “últimas cartas” [*last cards*] [10-S49]
 - German “Letzte Runde” [*last round*] [02-S29]
- In Norway the call may have scoring consequences. A 2022 Norwegian Wikipedia talk-page comment says that if the dealer fails to announce the last deal “før forhånda legger sitt første kort” (*before forehand lays down his first card*), the last-trick point counts only if forehand takes it [01-S27] [UGC].
- Players notice when software drops the cue. “Why has it stopped calling cards? It’s no longer notifying it being the last hand. please fix” (13 upvotes) [06-S20]. SpiteNET plays a sound instead [06-S34].

6.3 Counting, claiming and challenging aloud

- **Showing:** “each player counts his cards face downward, and announces the number” [03-S31].
- **The count read aloud as a chant:**
 - The English translation of a Feydeau farce stages “Cards... Spades... Ten of diamonds...” / “Deuce... Aces...” and ends “Clean sweep! You owe me a hundred francs” [04-S159].
 - Hungarian novelist Tandori writes the chant “Laptöbbség! pikktöbbség! nagy k., kis k., a négy ász” (Card majority! Spade majority! big c., little c., the four aces!) [10-S56].
 - In a snowbound Norwegian cabin “guttungen fører regnskapet og teller sammen og leser opp stillingen” (the little boy keeps the accounts, adds up and reads out the score) [10-S29].
- **Claiming out:**
 - “I have three points, and am out” (*New York Dispatch*, 1881) [04-S130].
 - “In playing cassino the one claiming game first wins” (*Police Gazette*) [04-S133].
 - Hungarian “Ausz!” / “Ausz vagyok!” / “Kint vagyok!” (“Out!” / “I’m out!”) [01-S20][02-S3]. A player who fails to declare and is beaten to it loses [01-S20].
 - Pasur “per shodam” (“I’m full”) [02-S14].

• Challenging:

- Hungarian “Fals!” [*False!*] [01-S20].
- English rules say “every mistake must be challenged immediately” [03-S15].
- Dominican players customarily point out *dejado* / *pisado* (“left behind” / “stepped on”) cards their opponent missed [02-S3].
- A 2005 Spanish-language forum post says players shout “¡Asoplo!” [*Blow!*] to claim an opponent’s missed 15 [05-S52] [UGC].

• Agreeing house rules before the deal, as Jack London scripts it in 1912 [04-S28]:

- “Do you count sweeps?” / “Certainly not ... That’s a sissy game.”
- “Cards and spades go out first, of course, and then big and little casino, and the aces in the bridge order of value. Is that right?”
- “Low deals.”

• Generosity on a tie (*Harper’s Bazaar*, 1883) [04-S135]:

- “The cards are a tie, Katy, so neither of us takes that point.”
- “let’s count it. You may have it.”

• Superstition (*Birmingham Age-Herald*, 1912): a winning player “slapped his cards down and said: ‘Boys, I’m going to die’” [04-S137].

• Austen’s verdict on Cassino table talk: “Scarcely a syllable was uttered that did not relate to the game” [04-S16].

6.4 Barks by tradition (from note 05)

Legend for **Status**: **R** = required/regulated by the rules (silence or misstatement has a consequence); **C** = customary (documented as habitually said, not required); **T** = taunt/banter; **D** = documented only in a single user-generated or promotional source (treat as flavour, verify with native speakers before shipping).

6.4a Anglo-American Cassino (English)

Moment	Line(s)	Status	Notes	Source
Making a single build	“Seven.” / “Nine.” / “Ten.” (19th c.); “Building eight.” / “Building seven.” / “Building 5.” (modern)	R	1867: build announced in the singular — “‘Nine’ or ‘Ten’—not ‘Nines’ or ‘Tens’”; Pagat: “must announce the capturing number (saying, for example, ‘building 5’)”	[05-S8, 05-S9, 05-S1, 05-S76, 05-S77]
Raising (increasing) a build	“Nine.” → “Ten.”; “Building nine.”	R	1867 dialogue: dealer says “Seven,” opponent throws a Deuce and says “Nine,” dealer adds Ace and “cries ‘Ten’”; Foster: “announcing the total value, ‘Ten.’”	[05-S8, 05-S9, 05-S11, 05-S1]
Making a multiple (locked) build	“Two Sevens.” / “Two Nines.” (Foster); “Building eights.” / “Building fives.” / “Building xes” (modern)	R	Foster: “announcing the build as ‘Two Sevens.’ This cannot be increased”; BGG reviewer: “announcing ‘building xes’”; Denexa: “a 5 was played on another 5 with a declaration of ‘Building fives’, the build could not be captured with a 10”	[05-S11, 05-S74-BGG85266, 05-S76]
Calling (locking) a pair	“Fives.” / “Treys.” / “Fours.” (19th c.); “Calling 5.” / “Calling 8.” (modern)	R	1867: “calling out (not Five, but) ‘Fives’”; “In calling the denomination, the plural is always used”; modern YouTube/website rules say “calling 5”, “calling 8”	[05-S8, 05-S9, 05-S78, 05-S77]
Build-and-call (adding a duplicate to own build)	“Fours.” (repeated)	R	1867 Law 9: “repeating his announcement ... call (not Four, but) ‘Fours’”	[05-S8]
Building for partner	“...for partner”; “two Eights” (built on partner’s 8); “building 9 for partner”	R	Pagat; Dominican variant “must always announce ‘for partner’”; Foster “‘two Eights,’ called, although the player has no 8”	[05-S1, 05-S12, 05-S11]

Moment	Line(s)	Status	Notes	Source
Combining (no build)	(calling attention)	C	Foster: player “may combine these three cards, calling attention to the fact that their collective value is 9”	[05-S11]
Opponent’s unclear build	“What are you building?” (implied)	C	1867: unclear build → opponent “may separate the cards”; Danish: opponent’s “pligt at spørge, hvad det er, man bygger” [<i>duty to ask what is being built</i>]	[05-S8, 05-S43]
Dealer deals the final round	“Last.”	R/C	Pagat: “The dealer must announce ‘last’ when dealing the last cards”; BGG user calls the end “how EPIC the ‘last’ round is”	[05-S1, 05-S74-BGG1156351]
Taking the last cards	(no fixed line)	—	Foster: “The last trick is usually made by the dealer, who always keeps back a court card”	[05-S11]
Sweep / clear	no traditional English sweep shout found	—	Sources describe <i>marking</i> a sweep (capturing card turned face up “at the bottom of the tricks”) rather than a call. Family-variant evidence: Swedish-heritage family playing reverse Cassino says “ Sweep 9 ” to warn of a forced sweep	[05-S11, 05-S1, 05-S92] [UGC]
Counting at hand end	announce card count; claim spades, Cassinos, aces	R	Foster: “each player counts his cards face downward, and announces the number ... then turned face up, and the spades counted and claimed”	[05-S11]
Reaching 21 mid-hand	claim the game (“count out”)	R	Foster: “The moment he reaches 21 he should claim the game ... If he is mistaken ... he loses”	[05-S11]
Challenging an error	challenge “immediately”	R	“every mistake must be challenged immediately”; Foster: before “the next trick is taken in”	[05-S7, 05-S8, 05-S11]
Tuxedo (Cassino variant)	“Orange!”	R	must call to score; others can steal it; false call –10	[05-S12]
Whole-round shutout	“skunking”	D	family usage	[05-S91] [UGC]
Period flavour (public domain)	“I do long for a game of cassino — that is, in the family way — just for a trifle; — I never lose much, you know.”	—	Mrs. Scatter in Reynolds, <i>Cheap Living</i> (1797)	[05-S5]
Period flavour	“Their table was superlatively stupid. Scarcely a syllable was uttered that did not relate to the game”	—	Austen 1813 on Miss De Bourgh’s cassino table	[05-S6]

6.4b Nordic Kasino

Moment	Line(s)	Translation	Status	Source
Dealer deals last cards (SE)	“Sistan!”, “Båt!”, “Båten går!”, “Sista given!”	“The last one!”, “Boat!”, “The boat’s leaving!”, “Last deal!”	R (should warn)	[05-S14, 05-S32, 05-S34]
Dealer marks last round (DK)	“Sidsten!”	“The last!”	C	[05-S43] [unsourced wiki]
Single build (SE)	“Bygger till elva.” / “Bygger till knekt.” / “Bygger till tretton / kung.”	“Building to eleven / to jack / to thirteen / king”	R (“Spelaren annonserar sedan byggets värde” [<i>The player then announces the value of the build</i>])	[05-S34]
Compound build (SE)	“Två åttor.” / “Tre tior.”	“Two eights.” / “Three tens.”	C	[05-S34]
Locking same rank (SE)	“Ligger.” / “Åttan ligger.” / “Knekten ligger.”	“It lies.” / “The eight lies.”	C	[05-S34]
Build only the 10♦ can take (SE)	“Storan privat.”	“Big one, private.”	C (“Vissa spelare...” [<i>Some players...</i>])	[05-S34]
Single build (DK)	“Bygger 9.” / locked: “Mere syv.”	“Building 9.” / “More seven.”	R/C	[05-S43]
Single build (FI)	“Rakennan ässälle.” / “Rakennan yhdeksikölle.” / “Rakennan kuutoselle.”	“I’m building for the ace / the nine / the six.”	R (must “sanoa selvästi” [<i>say clearly</i>])	[05-S40]
Sweep (SE/FI/DK)	“Tabbe!” / “Mökki!” / “Svupper!”	the sweep nouns	Not documented as shouted ; documented as the name of the event (e.g., “gjort en tabbe” [<i>made a tabbe</i>], “saa mökin” [<i>gets a mökki</i>], “får en ‘svupper’” [<i>gets a ‘svupper’</i>])	[05-S33, 05-S39, 05-S44]

Moment	Line(s)	Translation	Status	Source
Cancelling opponent's sweep (FI)	"Mökki kaatuu." / "kaadetaan mökki" [<i>a hut is knocked down</i>]	"The hut falls."	C (descriptive verb)	[05-S40, 05-S39]
Setting up a forced sweep (Krypkasino)	"Tabbe på knekt." / "Tabbe på 9." / "sweep for an ace" / "sweep for a six or a queen"	"Sweep for a jack / for a nine"	C ("It is customary for a player who sets up a sweep to announce it"; "bör säga" [<i>should say</i>])	[05-S15, 05-S33]
Claiming 16 mid-deal (SE)	(announce reaching target)	—	R (variant: "kan spelaren annonsera detta" [<i>the player may announce this</i>])	[05-S33]

6.4c Italian (Scopa family)

Moment	Line(s)	Translation	Status	Source
Sweep	"Scopa!"	"Broom!/Sweep!"	C — "usually announced by the player saying 'Scopa!' at the time of the sweep"; Canadian-Italian family: "slap my winning card down and not only shout 'Scopa!'..."	[05-S49, 05-S48]
Sweep (gesture)	slam card; "forceful Italian grunts and gestures that loosely mean 'So there!' 'Take that!' or 'Now, who's laughing?!'"		T	[05-S48]
Losing reply	(in-laws' expressions translating as) "Go shoot yourself!" , "Go become a nun!"	Italian originals not given in source [UNVERIFIED originals]	T	[05-S48]
Bluff sweep (Scopa a fiddasse)	"Vi fiddate?" / "Ti fidi?"	"Do you (all) trust me?" / "Do you trust me?"	R in that variant	[05-S46]
Claiming hand bonus (Cirulla)	knock on table (bussare), reveal cards; name the 7's wild value		R	[05-S27, 05-S47]
Turn-taking	"A chi tocca?" , "Tocca a me." , "Tocca a te."	"Whose turn?", "My turn.", "Your turn."	C	[05-S50] [blog]
Partner signalling	(no words) — "segnalare il possesso di una determinata carta al proprio compagno" [<i>signal possession of a particular card to one's partner</i>] by card choice; "questi segnali sono comprensibili anche dagli avversari" [<i>these signals can also be read by the opponents</i>]		C	[05-S46]
Wit/etiquette	"Scopa FRAC: Definita scherzosamente 'la scopa più elegante che c'è'"	"jokingly called 'the most elegant scopa there is'"	—	[05-S46]

6.4d Spanish — Escoba

Moment	Line(s)	Translation	Status	Source
Sweep	"¡Escoba!"	"Broom!"	C — rules text calls it an "escoba cantada" (a called escoba)	[05-S51]
Claiming opponent's missed 15	"¡Soplo!" / "¡Asoplo!"	"Blow!" (cf. huffing in draughts)	D	[05-S52] [UGC]
Uruguayan Chorizo declarations	"¡Flor!" , "¡Escalera!" , "¡Chorizo!" , "¡Báciga!"	combo names	R (declared "immediately before playing the first of their three cards")	[05-S83]

6.4e Spanish — Cuarenta (Ecuador) — the richest documented bark set

General: "The play is supposed to be full of bravado, loud, exciting, even silly" [05-S19]; "para jugar cuarenta 'hay que ponerse charlatán'" [*to play cuarenta 'you have to turn into a chatterbox'*]; "La idea es desconcentrar al rival para que se olvide las cartas lanzadas" [*the idea is to distract the rival so they forget the cards played*]; "el que más dichos repite debilita a su opositor" [*whoever repeats the most sayings weakens his opponent*] [05-S57].

Moment	Line(s)	Translation	Status	Source
Ronda dealt (3 of a kind)	“¡Ronda!” / “¡Dos por guapo!”	“Round!” / “Two for being handsome!”	R (must claim before first card; “bajo cualquier frase como ... ‘dos por guapo’” [using any phrase such as ... “two for being handsome”])	[05-S19, 05-S59, 05-S57]
Caída (matching previous card)	“¡Toma, dos por shunsho!” / “Dos por shunsho” / “Toma por shunsho”	“Take that, two for shunsho!”	C	[05-S57, 05-S56, 05-S59, 05-S58]
Caída (to the scorer)	“Dos, señor juez.” / “Dos por favor, señor juez.” / “Dos, juecito.”	“Two, Mr. Judge.” / “Two please, Mr. Judge.” / “Two, little judge.”	C	[05-S56, 05-S59, 05-S55]
Big caída / limpia	“¡Capariche!”	(unglossed exclamation)	C	[05-S57]
Caída + limpia	“¡Caída y limpia!”	“Fall and clean!”	C — earns “el permiso de burlarse de los contrincantes” [permission to mock the opponents]	[05-S55, 05-S59]
Threat (card on forehead)	“Con esta te caigo.”	“With this one I’ll fall on you.”	T	[05-S57, 05-S54]
Defiance	“As que no me caerás.”	“Ace, you won’t fall on me.”	T	[05-S57]
When a 4 is played	“Cuatrero has de ser.”	“You must be a cattle-thief.”	T	[05-S57, 05-S58]
Assorted distractors	“Marido tiene.”, “José me llamo.”, “La foto.”, “Dolido va.”	“She’s got a husband.”, “My name is José.”, “The photo.”, “Off he goes, hurt.”	T	[05-S56, 05-S58, 05-S54]
At 38 points	“Treinta y ocho que no juega.”	“Thirty-eight doesn’t play.”	C (rule state)	[05-S56, 05-S59, 05-S54]
Shutout (<10 pts)	“¡Zapatero!” / “Zapateros se quedaron.”	“Shoemaker!” / “They stayed shoemakers.”	T (losers “deben lustrar los zapatos a los rivales” [must shine the rivals’ shoes])	[05-S55, 05-S58, 05-S53]
Misdeal	“Pasa la mano con diez.”	“The deal passes, with ten.”	R	[05-S59, 05-S53]
Challenge	“¡Veo y juego!”	“I see and I play!”	R	[05-S59]
Winning	“Cuarenta, señores, gracias.”	“Forty, gentlemen, thank you.”	C	[05-S57]
Gesture: caída	card “snapped” down “with great vigor and from well above the surface” — “a purely friendly, but nonetheless rib-poking, gesture”; card raised and thrown “con fuerza” [forcefully]		T	[05-S19, 05-S57]
Gesture: prediction	hold the expected card face down near the table, or “on your forehead (facing you, of course)”		T	[05-S19, 05-S57]

6.4f Arabic (Chkobba, Basra)

Moment	Line(s)	Status	Source
Chkobba sweep	“CHKOBAAAA!”	D [pro-mo]	[05-S67]
Capturing 7♦	“Sab3a l-7ayya!” (sab’a l-ḥayya, “the living seven”)	D [pro-mo]	[05-S67]
Prime	“Barmīla!”	D [pro-mo]	[05-S67]
Surprise / hype / trash talk / bad luck	“Wesh hadi?!” [What’s this?!], “Yaser ya 3ammi!” [That’s a lot, uncle! (?)], “Rak tel3ab bel 7adh ken!” [You’re only playing on luck!], “Khallini narba7 marra!” [Let me win once!]	D [pro-mo]	[05-S67]
Gesture	comic gestures “surtout lorsqu’ils font une chkobba ou qu’ils « mangent » le 7 de carreau” [especially when they make a chkobba or “eat” the 7 of diamonds]; snapping cards (“faire claquer les cartes, geste technique tunisien par excellence” [snapping the cards, the Tunisian technical gesture par excellence])	C	[05-S66]

Moment	Line(s)	Status	Source
Etiquette	play fast: “il n’est pas question ... de provoquer des temps morts” [<i>there is no question ... of causing dead time</i>]; speed disrupts card counting	C	[05-S66]
Tie on a point	“ bāji ”	C (term)	[05-S66]
Basra capture	“the player announces his capture”	C (generic)	[05-S62]
Basra slang	jack as “ imam ” that “eats” the floor	C	[05-S20]

6.4g Persian (Pâsur)

Moment	Line	Translation	Status	Source
Stopping the game at ≥62	“ Per shodam. ”	“I’m full / done.”	R (false claim = “made a fool of yourself”)	[05-S21]
Sweep	“ Sur! ”	the sweep noun	name of event; shout not documented	[05-S21, 05-S64, 05-S65]

6.4h Greek (Xeri / Diloti)

Moment	Line	Translation	Status	Source
Lone-card capture / table-clear	“ Ξερή! ” (<i>Xerí!</i>)	“Dry!”	name of the event (“ <i>κάνει ξερή</i> ” [<i>makes a xerí</i>]); explicit shout not documented in fetched sources	[05-S22, 05-S23, 05-S70]
Declaring a pile (Diloti)	“ eight ” (Pagat’s English rendering of a plain declaration; the Greek wording is not quoted in the source); group: « οκτάρια » (“eights”); « σόλ » (“kin”)		C (Pagat: “Usually the player will verbally declare the value ... though this is not obligatory”; must clarify if ambiguous)	[05-S23, 05-S72]

6.4i Turkish (Pişti)

Moment	Line	Translation	Status	Source
Lone-card capture	“ Pişti! ”	“Cooked!”	C — “ <i>pişti diyerek yerde bulunan kağıtları alır</i> ” [<i>takes the cards on the table (lit. “on the ground”) saying “pişti”</i>]	[05-S69]
After first capture	“ İlk elin günahı olmaz. ”	“The first hand has no sin.”	C (proverbial)	[05-S68]

6.4j Other relatives

Game	Line	When	Source
Hungarian Kaszinó	“ Ausz! ”, “ Ausz vagyok! ”, “ Kint vagyok! ”	stopping at 11	[05-S12]
Catalan Cau Robot	“ Cau! ” → “ Recau! ” → “ Contracau! ”	matching the previous player’s non-capturing card, escalating	[05-S29]
French-Canadian Mitaines	“ Mitten! ”, “ Glove! ”, “ Sock! ”	starting a pair/three/four	[05-S30]
Zwicker (N. Germany)	“ 13 for partner ”; “13” / “3” for a queen	build declarations	[05-S28]
Dominican Royal Casino	point out “ dejado ”/“ pisado ” cards	after a missed capture	[05-S12]

6.5 How real players talk about the game (from note 05)

These are quotations from forums/social media, useful for writing natural-sounding character dialogue and for understanding player expectations. All are [UGC].

Nostalgia & family transmission

- “I used to play Cassino with my grandpa growing up.” [05-S96]
- “Before she passed, I *did* play Cassino with my grandma (it was a classic for her)” [05-S97]

- “My mom taught me this game almost 60 years ago, when I was learning arithmetic.” [05-S74-BG-G85266]
- “When I was a child my mom taught me to play Cassino, and it’s always been a nostalgic favorite of mine.” [05-S74-BGG2988271]
- “Big Casino 10d little casino 2s (from casino, a game I remember playing with my father)” [05-S98]
- “This is a very popular game in my parents’ house; they regularly play ‘World Series’ best-of-7’s.” [05-S74-BGG597527]
- “I’ve played for more than 60 years with dozens of other players” [05-S74-BGG3574955]
- Polish-American lineage: “Some of my dad’s grandparents came from Poland, and my dad grew up playing Casino” [05-S99]

Prison/“jail” transmission (US)

- “I was taught by someone who played in jail a lot” (scoring 10♦ = 3, 2♠ = 2) [05-S100]; reply: “two of them spend a little time in jail. In my Hoyle book, the spelling is casino. Copyright 1947” [05-S100]
- Advice threads about incarceration list “spades, casino, pea knuckle. Domino’s” and “Learn to play dominoes, spades, casino, and chess” [05-S101]
- Swedish Mulle is “kåkfarrarvarianten av kasino” (“the jailbird variant”) per Glimne, quoted by [05-S33-index].

Opinions & arguments (good for rival-AI personality)

- On sweeps: “Sweeps are not part of the regular rules. They are a variant and we play with them every single time. Why wouldn’t you??” vs. “there is virtually no skill in getting a sweep, it’s just the luck of the deal” [05-S74-BGG1893693]
- On face cards: “Never part of a build. Ever.” [05-S74-BGG1893693]; “you cannot play one on the existing King, call a ‘Kings’ build” [05-S74-BGG122955]
- On rule-reading: “I would rather it say ‘take the cards’ than ‘snake the flobble’” (about jargon on Pagat) [05-S74-BGG1221271]
- On building rights: “absolutely your move is legal (from no authority, other than the way my in-laws taught me 😊)” [05-S74-BGG3574955]
- On Cassino vs Scopa: “Casino offer more options during play, as Scopa doesn’t have builds” [05-S74-BGG952175]
- “Casino is close to my favorite game ever. It is short but strategic” [05-S74-BGG1893693]
- Spelling confusion: “Typing ‘Casino’ into the App store search function just yields a list of gambling apps!” [05-S74-BGG826479]
- Pronunciation: grandma’s “Cassino” “Pronounced ‘Cersina’” [05-S90]

Regional identity

- US Northeast: Pagat has “two reports of a version played by some in Connecticut and New York state in which 3 points are scored for the 10 of diamonds, 2 points for the 2 of spades and just 1 point for taking most cards” [05-S1]. A 2025 Reddit poster taught “by someone who played in jail a lot” reports the same values (“10 of spades [sic] (big Cassino) 3 pts, 2 of spades (little Cassino) 2 pts ... most cards 1 pt”); a reply: “We play 10 Diamonds is 3 points” [05-S100] — two independent sightings of the same house rule.
- Dominican Republic: “Royal Cassino ... the national card game of the dominican republic” [05-S95]

- Ecuador: Cuarenta's World Championship organised by the Asociación de Periodistas Deportivos de Pichincha since 1968, with oath ("juramento de rigor" [*the customary oath*]) taken by the Reina de Quito [05-S55, 05-S58]
- South Africa: an association (KASA) runs Khasino leagues/tournaments [05-S81]; YouTube "Khasino Game Play ... 40 on Deck" [05-S80]
- Haiti: "Haitian Card Game 'Casino'" taught by a parks programmer (CreekTV) [05-S80]

6.6 Voice-over implications (synthesis)

- **Attested and rule-bearing:**
 - Build calls in singular and plural form [03-S15][03-S20].
 - "Last" [02-S1].
 - Count-out claims [03-S31].
 - These have the strongest historical warrant for mandatory lines.
- **No traditional English sweep shout was found.** English sources describe *marking* a sweep, not shouting one [05 §3a]. The noun "clear" [02-S1], the 1878 phrase "clean sweep" [04-S102] and Fey-deau's "Clean sweep!" [04-S159] are the closest attested English words.
 - Shouted sweeps are documented for "Scopa!" [05-S49], "¡Escoba!" ("cantada", i.e. called out) [05-S51] and "Pişti!" [05-S69].
 - The Nordic nouns (*tabbe*, *mökki*, *svupper*) are documented as names, not exclamations [05 §3b].
- **Chatter systems.** Ecuadorian Cuarenta treats noise as strategy: "La idea es desconcentrar al rival para que se olvide las cartas lanzadas" (the idea is to distract your rival so they forget which cards have been played) [05-S57]. A player who makes a *caída y limpia* earns "el permiso de burlarse de los contrincantes" (permission to mock the opponents) [05-S59].
- **Flavour lines that fire on suit** are available in Finnish card-table puns, e.g. "Pata putos, muttei särkynyt" ("the pot [= spade] fell but didn't break") [10-S2].
- **Accessibility.** Spoken move announcements are the digital equivalent of the old calls. They are already used for TalkBack/VoiceOver in Scopa apps [06-S40][06-S41]. ## 7. Scorekeepers, tools and digital implementations

7.1 Two centuries of physical scoring aids

- **Counters (1790s–1800s):**
 - The 1793 poem's three-handed game needs "Six Counters ... to score with" [11-V-S2].
 - The German 1797 rules print a counter layout ("Man marquirt auf folgende Art", one marks as follows) [10-S41]. So does the 1810 *Spielalmanach* [01-S83].
 - The Polish 1821 almanac opens with a "Tablica do Oznaczenia Gry", a chart of counter patterns for marking 1–9 points [10-S46].
 - In 1804 Martha Wilmot in Russia bought "a little box of Cassino Markers of tortoiseshell" as a gift [04-S36].
- **Paper, counters or a cribbage board (1897):** "the score may be kept with counters, on a sheet of paper, or on a cribbage board" [03-S31].
 - Spade Cassino is built around pegging: "every point being pegged immediately ... Sixty-one points is game, once round the board and into the game hole" [03-S23].

- Porrazo, a Mexican-American relative, is also played to 61 on a cribbage board [09-S26].
- **The face-up sweep card**, found throughout the family:
 - “Sweeps are usually marked by leaving the cards with which they are made face upward at the bottom of the tricks” [03-S31].
 - Opposing sweeps “are sometimes turned down to cancel one another” [03-S31]. The earliest rule found is in Dick (1894): “the players turn the canceled Sweep cards down” [03-S22].
 - The USPCC (1952) explains why: “so the cards representing sweeps will be facing the other way and may be picked out easily” [03-S36].
 - Finnish players lay the card crosswise and prefer a non-scoring card “pistelaskun selkeyttämiseksi” (to keep the scoring clear) [01-S17].
 - Swedish players slide each *tabbe* card under the pile at a right angle, “något förskjutet” (slightly offset) from the last one, which makes a visible tally [10-S24].
 - Mulle, where capture piles are face up, inverts this: a *tabbe* is a face-down card [01-S37].
 - Hungarian players instead draw lines on a slate [02-S3].
- **Spare cards as score markers:** Ecuadorian Cuarenta uses the removed 8s, 9s and 10s. Face up counts 2 points; face down counts 10, a *perro* (“dog”) [02-S13].
- **Commercial products:**
 - Winning Moves’ boxed *Scopa* (2011) contains “2 scoring cards (for your reference), pad of score sheets”, with an “s” for each *scopa* [06-S11].
 - **No Cassino-specific score pad, peg board or patented counter was found** [06 §1.7–1.8].
 - The patents that do exist reskin Cassino’s scoring:
 - Clarke’s 1898 “casino domino”, which kept “Big casino (ten of diamonds) shall count two points” [06-S12].
 - Adams’s 1911 word-building deck, “played as in the game of casino... a player may build, as in casino” [06-S13].
- **Audit affordances:**
 - “only the last trick gathered can be seen” [03-S31].
 - Hungarian players move captured cards toward themselves “hogya az ellenfél összevethesse azokat” (so the opponent can check them) and keep piles in order so the last capture can be audited. This supports the “Fals!” challenge [01-S20].
 - In Escopa, the leftover table cards must total 10, 25, 40 or 55, “não havendo um destes valores significa que houve erro” (any other total means there was an error) [09-S66].
 - Foster’s 11-point total plays the same role [03-S31].
- **Live clinch thresholds:**
 - Players “count the points as they are earned ... spades or cards as soon as one player has captured 7 or 27 of them respectively” [02-S1].
 - A Reddit user asks, “Is it allowed to stack or track your spades separately so you can see if you have yet won seven?” This is an unmet need a digital game can meet [02-S63].

7.2 Digital landscape (2026)

- **Small market:** the leading Cassino app has about 166,000 Android installs, far behind the leading Scopa app (see the scale comparison below) [06 §2.1].
- **Board Game Arena:** “Available since Apr 7th 2025”, with 2,653 games played [06-S31].

- **No Cassino on Steam** [06-S37].
- **Not in the big compilations:** no Cassino in *Hoyle Card Games* or *Clubhouse Games* [06-S38].
- **Open-source projects:** come largely from Finnish university courses and South African developers [06-S53][06-S56][06-S57].
- **Roguelike trend:** *Scopa Sweep* is a “Traditional Italian Scopa card game turned roguelike” [06-S37]. The Finnish *Kasino* app has a dungeon-style “Trials” mode [06-S24].

Mobile catalogue (from note 06)

App (developer)	Installs (exact)	Rating (n)	Released	Rules / modes noted	Source
Cassino Card Game (Zol's Apps)	165,691	3.99 (1,121)	Apr 2014	2 players; match to 21; sweeps; “Daily-5” same-deal competition; PvP	[06-S19]
Casino Card Game (Paris Pinkney)	139,313	3.74 (997)	May 2013	first hand deals 6 cards, then 4; “build, stack and capture”	[06-S20]
G4A: Cassino (Games4All)	37,779	3.71 (386)	Jun 2013	3-handed (you vs 2 AIs: “Cary”, “Laura”)	[06-S21]
Cassino Card Game SA (DZ Code)	27,545	3.71 (ZA store)	Feb 2025	South African 40-card, 10-card hands, two rounds; online ELO; 4-player pairs; “shiya” button	[06-S22]
Kasino – Cassino Card Game (O-P Card House, Finland)	16,073	—	May 2026	Nordic rules; “dungeon-style” Trials with bosses and relics; no ads	[06-S24]
Cassino Card Game Classic (DZ Code)	2,292	2.71 (17)	Nov 2020	52-card classic, vs computer	[06-S23]
Pocket Cassino (Pocket of Games)	652	iOS 3.75 (4)	Jun 2024	customizable rules; spectator mode; subscription \$2.99/mo	[06-S25]
Cassino! (Michael Dokken), Android	276	—	Jun 2026	1–3 AIs; Easy/Medium/Hard/Insane; variation builder; replay mode	[06-S27]
Cassino Pro (Sizo Develops II)	59	—	Jun 2026	SA 40-card; room codes; LAN	[06-S48]

iOS:

- **Cassino! (Michael Dokken):** 3.76 stars from 302 ratings, released 2012-09-13, v2.5. Supports “2 player, 3 player, and 4 player... Local multiplayer games can be played over bluetooth or wifi. Online... through game center... Turn-Based”; “Four difficulty levels”; variations “Royal, Draw, Sweep, Other Variations”; tutorial; statistics. [06-S26]
- **Cassino Royale (PikeSquare, 2026):** “Training mode suggests your best move — and explains why • It even explains the computer’s moves”; “A new Daily Challenge every day — the same deal for everyone”; “Pass & Play: two players, one device”; “Large, readable cards designed for comfortable play at any age”; “No ads. No data collection.” [06-S28]
- **Casino Card Game (Paris Pinkney):** 4.33 stars from 6 ratings on iOS. [06-S30]

Scale comparison with relatives. On the same day, the leading Scopa app had about 75 times the installs of the top Cassino app (Zol’s, 165,691 [06-S19]). The leading Basra and Chkobba apps had about 3–5 times as many, and the leading Pasur app had fewer:

- Scopa: *Scopa: la Sfida* (WhatWapp) 12,339,804 installs and 4.36 stars (229,507 ratings); *Scopa originale Dal Negro* 3,560,675; *Scopa (Broom)* (Lisitso) 1,888,672; *Scopa!* (Escogitare) 1,637,117; *Scopa Più* 1,221,038; *Scopa 15* (Escoba) 865,798. [06-S40]
- Others: *Egyptian Basra* v2 831,177; *Egyptian Basra* – كوتشينه 532,117; *Chkobba Tn* 531,113; the Iranian Pasur app 11 چهاربرگ آنلاين 142,848; *Xeri+* 68,376. [06-S42]
- iOS: *Scopa!* (Marcarelli) 4.73 stars from 3,743 ratings; *La Scopa* (OutOfTheBit) 4.72 from 3,322; *Pasur11* 4.63 from 1,239; compared with Cassino!’s 302 ratings. [06-S30][06-S43]

7.3 How builds are shown on screen

- **Numeric labels:**
 - Psellos labels each build pile with its value [06-S33].
 - SpiteNET treated missing labels as a bug worth a version fix: “If you have version 1 and the numbers on your Build piles don’t show... please update” [06-S34].
- **Ownership and value pickers:**
 - Southern African rules: “Each build has an owner” [06-S4].
 - One open-source implementation draws an owner style for each build and opens a modal to choose its value [06-S57].
- **The worst failure is inferring intent.**
 - Paris Pinkney’s app made players start “from the middle” [06-S20].
 - Users complained: “Controls are so horrible you cannot know whether the app will build or take!” [06-S20].
- **Rule asymmetry between human and AI** produced the most specific complaints, for example “Can’t build on what the bot builds, but the bot can build on what you build” [06-S19].

7.4 Captures, sweeps, pace and score screens

- **Explicit selection plus legal-play buttons.** In Psellos, “As you select and deselect cards, the blue buttons at the bottom change to show the legal plays for the selected cards” [06-S33].
 - **Staging and refereeing.** SpiteNET holds the played card “slightly above the table until the End Turn button has been clicked”. It refuses illegal moves “and display[s] an appropriate message explaining why” [06-S34].
 - **Pace.** Players complain both ways:
 - “The app/computer moves WAY to fast. I can’t determine what card the app used sometimes” [06-S20].
 - “The gameplay is incredibly slow with no option to speed it up at all” [06-S21].
- Shipped fixes are speed sliders, move logs, and an AI that “turns over the card it plans to play and selects the cards from the table” before playing [06-S27][06-S60][06-S33].
- **Score breakdowns** are the most requested missing feature. “At the end of each game, I want to see a point breakdown summary” [06-S20]. Psellos shows live counts of cards and spades during play [06-S33].

7.5 Fairness and AI opponents

- **“The computer cheats”** is the dominant negative review theme across Cassino, Scopa, Basra and Pasur apps [06 §8]:
 - “The cpu gets the Big Cassino 95% of the time” [06-S19].
 - “La sequenza di carte... sembra leggermente ‘truccata’” (the run of cards... seems slightly “rigged”) [06-S40].
- **Remedies in shipped games:**
 - Replay “with every player’s hand revealed” [06-S27].
 - Same-deal daily challenges [06-S19][06-S28].
 - Difficulty defined only by “how many cards it remembers” [06-S42].

- Fair-information AI. Di Palma & Lanzi describe plain MCTS as “a cheating player” and ISMCTS as “a fair player” [06-S49].

• **Personalities and chatter:**

- Thorium’s Kasino has “AI personalities... *Reno the Risk-taker, Cautious Cara*” and “AI table-talk (chat)” [06-S60].
- A South African project has “Sipho (Aggressive)... Thandi (Patient)... Naledi (Calculating)... They only see what a human sees” [06-S56].

7.6 Design lessons with evidence (from note 06)

1. Every build gets a visible value label, an owner marker, and a “locked/raisable” state.

- Shipped games put the number on the pile (Psellos, SpiteNET), and SpiteNET treated missing numbers as a bug worth a version fix. [06-S33][06-S34]
- The physical rules distinguish raisable single builds from fixed multiple builds (“Two Sevens... cannot be increased”). [06-S1, p. 444][06-S62][06-S34]
- Southern African rules make ownership a formal concept. [06-S4][06-S56]
- Players still say “can’t change a stack into a number”. [06-S19]
- Suggestion: show the label “8”, a coloured owner rim, and a lock glyph on compound builds.

2. Never infer intent between capture, build and trail. Let the player state it, and show only legal options.

- Implicit inference produced the most bitter control complaints (“you cannot know whether the app will build or take”, “the game automatically TAKES”). [06-S20]
- Psellos’s context-sensitive buttons, SpiteNET’s staged card with End Turn, and Malungisa’s legal-value picker solve this. [06-S33][06-S34][06-S57]
- When several captures are possible, list them, as Lisitso does. [06-S40]

3. Give the human exactly the move generator the AI uses, and say *why* a move is illegal.

- “The AI can do X but I can’t” is the most specific recurring complaint across Zol’s, Pinkney, G4A and Cassino!. [06-S19][06-S20][06-S21][06-S26]
- SpiteNET’s referee explains each rejected move. [06-S34] The Cassino! developer had to explain the rule in reply to a review. [06-S26]
- An in-game “why not?” tooltip would answer these complaints before they become 1★ reviews.

4. Build fairness transparency in from day one.

- Rigging accusations dominate negative reviews for Cassino, Scopa, Basra and Pasur apps. [06-S19][06-S21][06-S26][06-S40][06-S42]
- Proven counter-measures: post-game replay with all hands revealed [06-S27]; a “same deal for everyone” daily mode [06-S19][06-S28]; an in-app explainer on streakiness [06-S36]; difficulty defined by card memory, not information or luck [06-S42]; an explicit “no rubber-banding” promise. [06-S48]
- Use a fair-information AI (ISMCTS-style) rather than one that peeks. [06-S49]
- Consider showing the shuffle seed on the replay screen. (Suggestion, not evidenced.)

5. Show score categories live, with clinch thresholds, and keep the 11-point checksum.

- Physical players run mental tallies and claim at 7 spades and 27 cards. [06-S1][06-S2] Psellos shows live card and spade counts. [06-S33]

- The 11-point invariant would have caught Pinkney's ">11 per round" bug. [06-S1][06-S20]
- End every hand with a category-by-category breakdown, the most requested missing feature. [06-S20][06-S34][06-S44]
- Never let ads cover it. [06-S40]

6. Make “count-out” and claiming a feature, not a hidden rule.

- Twenty-one-point Cassino historically ends on a correct claim, and a wrong claim loses. [06-S1][06-S7] Finnish Kasino ends mid-hand when aces and Kasinos are captured. [06-S3]
- An optional “Claim!” button (or auto-claim) with the traditional count-out order gives these endings their drama. [06-S1][06-S10]

7. Use the face-up sweep card as the sweep icon.

- Across Cassino, Kasino, Scopa and Escoba, players mark a sweep by leaving one card face up or crosswise in the capture pile. [06-S1][06-S2][06-S3][06-S5][06-S8][06-S36]
- A rotated card in the player's pile (cf. cardgames.io's glowing trick) reads instantly to veterans. [06-S36]
- Keep the celebration short; a long “Scopa” banner was criticised for freezing play. [06-S40]

8. Let players control pace, and always make the opponent's last move reviewable.

- “Too fast to see what the computer took” and “too slow, no way to speed up” are both common. [06-S19][06-S20][06-S21]
- Fixes: speed slider [06-S27][06-S40][06-S43]; per-seat play log [06-S60]; a “Last Turn” panel [06-S54]; the AI pre-selecting its capture before taking it [06-S33]; the “picture-in-picture of what the computer picked up” a user asked for. [06-S20]

9. Treat the rules as a configurable family, with named presets.

- Players hold strong and divergent household rules on target score, point values, sweeps, Royal values, deal size, identical-card builds and multiple builds. [06-S19][06-S20][06-S26][06-S22]
- Successful apps expose a variation builder or presets (Dokken; Pocket Cassino “tailored to your region”; Psellos). [06-S27][06-S25][06-S33]
- Ship “Classic (Hoyle/Foster)”, “Royal”, “Spade (61 on a cribbage board)”, “Nordic/Finnish to 16”, and “South African 40-card” presets. Rules sources: [06-S1][06-S3][06-S4][06-S7][06-S8]

10. Turn the traditional announcements into UI and audio cues.

- Announce build values (“Building nine”, “Two Sevens”) and the dealer's “Last”. [06-S1][06-S2][06-S10]
- SpiteNET used a sound for “last” [06-S34], and players noticed when an app stopped “calling” the last hand. [06-S20]
- Spoken move announcements also serve accessibility (TalkBack/VoiceOver in Scopa apps). [06-S40][06-S41]

11. Design for phones and for older eyes.

- Big indices, a large-pip deck option, grid layout on phones, generous touch targets and a landscape option. [06-S60][06-S34][06-S28][06-S19][06-S20]
- Older players are a core audience. [06-S19][06-S26]

12. Support the social modes people actually want.

- 1v1, 3-handed and 4-handed partnerships [06-S21][06-S19][06-S26]; pass-and-play [06-S28][06-S54]; remote friends and family [06-S19][06-S26][06-S45]; asynchronous turns with reminders [06-S45].
- Online ranked play needs abandonment handling that does not punish the partner left behind. [06-S22]
- Format changes such as forced one-hand random matches can alienate a core base. [06-S40]
- Offer canned table-talk richer than a few phrases, plus blocking. [06-S22][06-S40]

13. Survive interruptions.

- Saving and resuming is expected: “if you leave the screen for anything a text or phone call the game is lost?” [06-S20]; “I switched out of the app... and it gave my capture to the computer”. [06-S19]
- Pasur11 advertises “Resume ability”. [06-S43]

14. Monetise without touching the table.

- Short ads only between games were praised (“very, very minimal adds... 1 every 3 or 4 games”). [06-S19]
- Ads that pop up mid-turn, auto-play your move, or hide results were condemned. [06-S40][06-S42]
- Several new entrants lead with “No ads”. [06-S24][06-S28]

15. Solve the name problem.

- Store searches for “cassino” and “casino card game” return mostly slot machines. [06-S30][06-S52]
- Dokken’s newest listing opens with “Despite the name, it has nothing to do with gambling or real-money casinos”. [06-S27]
- Use “Cassino” with the card-game qualifier everywhere, and consider regional names (Kasino, “Kasi Cassino”) in store metadata. [06-S22][06-S24]

16. Teach building explicitly, and coach in context.

- Building is the most confusing part (“doesnt tell you how to build or stack”). [06-S20]
- Good patterns: Suggest with highlighted alternatives [06-S33]; a coach that explains both your move and the AI’s [06-S28]; a hand-scripted tutorial [06-S27]; practice mode with undo [06-S37]. Undo is a common request. [06-S19][06-S20]

17. There is room for roguelike and progression wrappers around the classic core.

- Kasino’s Trials/dungeon mode and the Scopa Sweep roguelike suggest a current trend toward rules-mutating runs on top of fishing games. [06-S24][06-S37]
- The 1911 word-casino patent and a 2020 organic-chemistry “Cassino” teaching game show how far the build/capture core can be re-skinned. [06-S13][06-S65]

18. Respect the cultures that keep the game alive.

- The largest Cassino audience growth found is South African (“Great online Mzansi card game that is played ekasi”; “the most beloved card game from South African townships”). [06-S22][06-S58]
- Finnish and Nordic players are the other core group, with university course projects and a dedicated Kasino app. [06-S53][06-S24]

- Americans' attachment is mostly nostalgic and family-based. [06-S19][06-S26][06-S50]
 - Local vocabulary (shiya, drift, mökki) belongs in the UI. [06-S22][06-S56][06-S8]
-

8. Statistics

8.1 What exists in print, and what doesn't

- **No published quantitative study of Anglo-American Cassino exists.** There is no AI paper, no complexity estimate and no dealer-advantage figure in arXiv, OpenAlex, CrossRef or the thesis repositories searched [07-S1][07-S30][07-S31][07-S32][07-S34].
- **Ludii has no fishing game at all.** Its library has no card-game category [07-S33][02-S65].
- **The closest academic work is on Scopone** (Di Palma & Lanzi, *IEEE Transactions on Games* 10(3): 317–332, 2018) [07-S2]:
 - The dealer's ("deck") team wins 45.7% of matches against 41.7% for the other side, with 12.6% ties, under random play (not significant at the 95% level, $p = 0.071$).
 - The hand team's win rate falls as skill rises: "38.0% of the random strategy, 38.1% of CS, 34.7% of ISMCTS, and 29.5% of MCTS" [07-S2].
 - In the final tournament ISMCTS won 55.8%, against 41.7% for the expert-rule bot [07-S2].
 - Humans won 47.6% against a greedy bot but only 23.8% against ISMCTS-4000 [07-S2].
 - Human partners "were puzzled by their teammate's behavior" when partnered with search bots [07-S2].
- **Scopone game size** (lower bounds) [07-S3]:
 - State space 2.02×10^{47} , information-set space 2.23×10^{58} .
 - Effective branching factor 4.33 with perfect information, 8.8 with information sets.
- **Pasur** was solved with GPU counterfactual regret minimisation, but only "both players have full knowledge of each other's hands" [07-S5].
 - In that setting, the first player's win probability ranges from 0.06 with no jacks to 0.85 with four jacks and five or more clubs [07-S5].
- **Scopa represents the fishing family in the 2026 Valet benchmark of 21 traditional card games.** The benchmark has no Cassino encoding [07-S8][07-S10].
- **Scopone opening sweep:** Favero (2003) puts the chance at about 54.05% under the orthodox lead. His conditional probabilities, 146/203, 49/87 and 1/3, were reproduced exactly [07-S19][07-S42].
- **Educational and therapeutic uses:**
 - A 2020 "Organic Chemistry I Cassino" teaching game [07-S12].
 - Ecuadorian research on Cuarenta for mathematics teaching [07-S15].
 - A card-recognition system for blind Cuarenta players, at 94.7% accuracy with artificial light [07-S16].
 - Scopa as a cognitive game in the EU MoveCare elder-care platform [07-S17].

8.2 Popularity indicators

- **Pagat.com:** Casino is the **8th most-visited rules page** in July–September 2026 [07-S24].
- **YouGov:** its 2023 US survey of 30 card games does not list Casino at all. The only fishing game it lists is Zwickern, which 4% have played [07-S25].
- **Google Books Ngram:** lower-case "cassino" peaks at 6.50×10^{-8} in **1821** and falls about 46-fold by 2019 [07-S26]. "Big Casino" (single s) peaks in 1912, which tracks the American revival [07-S26].

- **Wikipedia:** see §2.6 for Nordic July seasonality [01-S63]. The table below shows annual pageviews.

8.2.1 Wikipedia pageviews (Wikimedia REST API, user agents, calendar-year totals) [07-S27]

Article	2016	2020	2025	2025 per month
en: Cassino (card game)	48,760	39,443	41,170	~3,431
en: Scopa	90,010	115,238	116,672	~9,723
en: Pasur (card game)	8,383	15,115	11,844	~987
en: Bastra (Basra)	8,772	25,297	11,394	~950
en: Escoba	6,685	9,796	9,576	~798
en: Tablanette	—	255	8,409	~701
en: Cuarenta	7,315	8,907	6,455	~538
en: Tseri (Xeri)	1,434	1,180	1,343	~112
en: Cribbage (comparator)	299,647	336,912	255,600	~21,300
en: Gin rummy (comparator)	500,396	680,108	316,013	~26,334
it: Scopa (gioco)	202,514	231,846	146,971	~12,248
it: Scopone	42,307	58,079	27,018	~2,252
fi: Kasino (korttipeli)	8,311	31,380	22,659	~1,888
sv: Kasino (kortspel)	12,385	10,531	13,047	~1,087
no: Kasino (kortspill)	29,111	16,297	23,240	~1,937

Notes:

- 2020 shows a pandemic bump for several games (Gin rummy, Bastra, Pasur).
- Finnish Kasino roughly tripled between 2018 and 2020 and stayed high.
- The Tablanette article only became a real article around 2020–21, which explains its jump.
- The figures exclude redirects. For example, “Basra (card game)” redirects to “Bastra” and “Xeri” redirects to “Tseri” [07-S27].

8.3 Exact combinatorics (original computation)

Quantity	Value
Distinct Cassino deals per hand	$10^{49.964}$
Opponent hands possible at first decision	$C(44,4) = 135,751$
P(4 Cassino table cards all of different rank)	67.6%
Pasur: P(Jack among initial 4 pool cards → replace)	28.1%
Scopa/Scopone: P(≥ 3 kings among 4 table cards)	$29/18,278 = 0.159\%$
Escoba: P(table sums to 15) / P(sums to 30)	3.41% / 2.73%
Escoba: deck total mod 15	10, so the residue always sums to 10, 25, 40 ...
Scopone-10: P(next player holds the led rank) for group size 1 / 2 / 3 / 4	146/203 / 49/87 / 1/3 / 0 (matches Favero [07-S19])

- **Built-in arithmetic checks for the scoreboard and engine** [03-S31][07-S42][09-S66]:
 - Anglo-American Cassino has 11 non-sweep points per hand.
 - The only possible tie on cards is 26–26, which leaves 8 points.
 - Escoba’s remaining table cards must sum to 10, 25, 40, ...

8.4 Monte Carlo study of two-player Cassino (original computation, research note 07)

These are **policy-conditional** results from four policies (random, greedy, one-ply heuristic with card counting, PIMC), in self-play and mixed matches,, not equilibrium values [07 §6.12]. The engine imple-

ments Pagat's standard rules with sweeps scored [07-S40]. Invariants were checked: 52 cards, 13 spades, 4 aces, 11 or 8 non-sweep points [07-S43].

8.4.1 Points per hand by policy (self-play; one "hand" = one full pass of the deck)

Self-play policy (N hands)	Dealer pts/hand	Non-dealer pts/hand	Dealer – non-dealer [95% CI]	P(dealer wins hand)	P(hand tied)
random (40,000)	5.632	5.278	+0.354 [+0.293, +0.415]	52.5%	1.4%
greedy (40,000)	5.254	6.400	–1.146 [–1.205, –1.088]	40.7%	3.7%
heuristic (20,000)	5.305	6.177	–0.872 [–0.952, –0.792]	43.1%	3.8%

- The standard deviation of points per player per hand is about 2.9–3.1. The standard deviation of the dealer – non-dealer difference is about 5.8–6.2 points.
- Excluding sweeps, the dealer – non-dealer difference is +0.354 (random), –1.236 (greedy) and –0.922 (heuristic) [07-S40].
- A 26–26 “cards” tie, which awards nobody the 3 points for cards, occurs in 4.5% (random), 6.9% (greedy) and 7.1% (heuristic) of hands. The scoreboard has to handle it often [07-S40][07 \$6.6].

8.4.2 Sweeps

Self-play policy	Sweeps per hand (both players)	P(≥ 1 sweep)	Distribution 0 / 1 / 2 / 3 / 4+
random	0.045	4.1%	95.9 / 3.8 / 0.3 / 0.03 / 0 %
greedy	0.859	51.2%	48.8 / 28.8 / 14.2 / 5.4 / 2.9 %
heuristic	0.693	45.5%	54.5 / 29.1 / 11.1 / 3.7 / 1.6 %
PIMC (600 hands, [07-S43])	0.158	13.0%	—

- The non-dealer can sweep on the very first play of a hand in only ~1.45% of deals: 1.43% (random), 1.47% (greedy), 1.46% (heuristic). This depends almost entirely on the deal [07-S40].
- Where sweeps happen (heuristic) [07-S41]:
 - Most come mid-deal: 0.147 per hand on the dealer's 2nd play and 0.121 on the non-dealer's 2nd play.
 - Only 0.065 (dealer) + 0.070 (non-dealer) sweeps per hand happen in the first deal; the other 0.55 happen in deals 2–6.
- Sweeps add at most about 0.7–0.9 points per hand (heuristic or greedy), and only about 0.16 under the sweep-averse PIMC style, but they swing games. Without sweep scoring a game lasts 3.63 hands instead of 3.48 (§8.4.3).

8.4.3 Game length to 21 points (deal alternates, first dealer randomised)

Matchup (N games)	Mean hands [95% CI]	Hands 2 / 3 / 4 / 5 / 6+	Winner / loser mean final score
heuristic vs heuristic, sweeps count (5,000)	3.48 [3.47, 3.50]	2.3 / 49.7 / 45.4 / 2.5 / 0.1 %	24.6 / 15.3
heuristic vs heuristic, no sweep points (3,000)	3.63 [3.61, 3.65]	0.6 / 40.0 / 54.9 / 4.4 / 0.1 %	24.3 / 14.8
greedy vs greedy, sweeps (20,000)	3.40 [3.39, 3.41]	4.0 / 54.3 / 39.3 / 2.3 / 0.1 %	24.7 / 15.0
greedy vs greedy, no sweeps (20,000)	3.63 [3.62, 3.64]	0.8 / 40.0 / 54.5 / 4.7 / 0.1 %	24.4 / 14.8
random vs random (20,000)	3.56 [3.55, 3.57]	1.5 / 45.1 / 49.6 / 3.8 / 0.1 %	24.6 / 14.3

- Only 0.6–4.0% of self-play games end after two hands, because each hand gives at most 11 points plus sweeps.
- **For session design:** at 52 plays per hand, a typical game is about 180 plays.
- No game ran past 7 hands [07-S40].

8.4.4 Policy comparison (duplicate format: each deck played twice with seats swapped)

A vs B	A – B points/hand [95% CI]	P(A wins hand)	P(A wins game to 21)
greedy vs random	+5.57 [5.51, 5.63]	86.9%	98.3% (10,000 games)
heuristic vs random	+7.34 [7.28, 7.40]	96.0%	99.9% (2,000 games)
heuristic vs greedy	+3.79 [3.72, 3.86]	75.9%	91.4% (4,000 games)

8.4.5 Dealer vs non-dealer: an open question

- The per-hand seat effect is small, and its sign depends on the policy [07-S40][07-S43]:
 - random +0.35, PIMC +0.65, heuristic –0.87, greedy –1.15 points per hand (dealer minus non-dealer).
- Over a whole game it mostly washes out. The first dealer wins 48.4% (greedy) and 48.8% (heuristic) of games to 21 [07-S40].
- The robust positional fact is that **the dealer takes the end-of-hand residue in 60–77% of hands** under every policy [07-S40][07-S43]. This bears out the advice of 1792 (“In the last Deal, a Court-Card or some other ought to be kept to secure the Advantage of the Cards on the Board” [03-S1]) and of 1897 (“The last trick is usually made by the dealer, who always keeps back a court card” [03-S31]).
- Scopone research finds a dealer-side advantage that grows with skill [07-S2]. The Cassino simulations do not settle the direction for strong play, so a stronger agent is needed [07 §6.10].

8.4.6 Skill vs luck

- Under duplicate scoring, a one-ply card-counting heuristic beats greedy play by **+3.79 points per hand** and wins **91.4%** of games to 21 [07-S40].
- In Scopone, by contrast, expert rules beat Greedy by only about 4 percentage points [07-S2].
- In Cassino, look-ahead, card counting and building matter far more than the game’s reputation as “a child’s game” suggests [07 §6.8][04-S28][04-S7].
- This supports the 1945 assessment that the game “provides wide scope for scientific play and sharp contest of wits” [03-S35]. ## 9. Strategy

9.1 Where the advice comes from

- **Long (1792)** gives nine numbered maxims [03-S1]. The first five:
 - “I. Take up the Card played by your Adversary in Preference to any other.”
 - “II. Take up Spades in Preference to the other Suits.”
 - “III. When you hold a Pair, play one of them.”
 - “IV. Aim at clearing the Board always, but forego an Advantage rather than give your Enemy that Chance.”
 - “V. Never play a Ten while Great Cassino is in, nor a Deuce while Little Cassino is unplayed.”
- **The 1793 poem** has eleven “General Rules and Directions for Playing the Game of Casino”. These are the source of most later classical advice [11 §V9]:
 - The *Sporting Magazine* (Nov–Dec 1793) merged them with Long’s laws [11-V-S7].
 - A condensed version became Hoyle’s “principal objects” paragraph, reprinted with small edits from 1796 to 1929 [08 §0][03-S5][03-S33].
- **R. F. Foster (1897)** wrote the other classic set, “Suggestions for Good Play” [03-S31].
- **20th-century “pointers”** come from Morehead & Mott-Smith (1946–52), Scarne, Silberstang and Hervey [08-S12][08-S13][08-S14][08-S15][08-S16][08-S17].

- **Modern sources** add numerical reasoning: Psellos’s “9% rule” and expected-value test for builds [08-S36].

9.2 The core strategic ideas

- **Memory first.** “The principal thing in Cassino is to remember what has been played especially in the counting and high cards, such as Aces, Eights, Nines, and Tens” [08-S9]. “In the last deal, you should know the rank of every card held by your opponent” [08-S12].
- **Priorities: cards > spades > cash points.**
 - Foster: “Go for ‘cards’ in preference to everything else” [08-S9].
 - The 1793 rule warns that “the Desire of taking Spades should never bias your Play” [11-V-S2].
 - Nordic scoring reverses the order. Most spades is worth 2 there, so “taking the ♠Q from the table may be better than capturing three cards” [08-S20].
- **Take the trailed card.** Taking the card your opponent just trailed is unanimous advice from 1792 to 1929 [08 §1.5]. No source gives a reason [08 §1.5].
- **Don’t feed the Cassinos.**
 - “Never play a Ten while Great Cassino is in” [03-S1].
 - Foster generalises this to any trail that “will make a Ten with those on the table” [08-S9].
- **Trailing (contested):**
 - Classical sources say to trail court cards, then small cards, keeping aces [08 §3.1–3.2].
 - Psellos says to trail middle and high cards early and low cards later, to deny combinations [08-S36].
 - Note 08 suggests the two fit together: Foster’s advice is offensive and Psellos’s is defensive [08 §3.2].
- **Building.**
 - Build only if the expected gain beats capturing now: “build only if you get more than 1 extra point” early on [08-S36].
 - Take the adversary’s builds and “build on his build at every opportunity” [08-S9].
 - Multiple builds protect; single builds invite raising [08 §4.3].
- **Negative inference.** “If he had a ten he would have done this, if he had a nine he would have done that” [08-S13]. A build that survives your opponent’s turn suggests they lack that rank [08-S40].
- **Unpaired-rank counting.**
 - In Culbertson: “all unpaired cards not paired by the table or by your own hand will be in the opponent’s hand” [08-S13].
 - Scopone has the same technique, “contare il Quarantotto” [08-S30].
- **Seat.**
 - The dealer keeps back a court card for the last capture [08 §7–8].
 - The non-dealer saves cash cards for his last play of a deal, “since you will have first chance at it next deal” [08-S14].
- **Sweep defence.** “not to leave on the Board one Card only, or such Cards as, by Combination, may be taken with one Card”, with four listed exceptions (early game, a point available, close race for cards, comfortable score) [11-V-S2].
 - Nordic players avoid leaving table totals of 14, 15 or 16 [08-S34][08-S35].

9.3 Agreement and disagreement summary (from note 08)

Topic	Consensus	Dissent
Remember cards	Universal [08-S1–08-S17, 08-S30]	—
Cards > spades > tie-breaks	Standard Cassino [08-S1, 08-S2, 08-S9, 08-S13, 08-S14, 08-S16]	Nordic reverses it (spades 2 pts) [08-S20, 08-S35]
Prefer spades in ties	Universal	1793: don't let it bias play [08-S2]
Trail courts first (standard)	[08-S1, 08-S2, 08-S3–08-S6, 08-S16]	Psellos (Royal): trail 7–J early [08-S36]
Trail small cards (except aces)	Hoyle line, Foster [08-S4, 08-S9]	Psellos, Pasur: trail high to deny combos [08-S36, 08-S25]
Never trail 10/2 while the Cassinos are out	Universal [08-S1, 08-S2, 08-S4, 08-S9, 08-S12]	—
Pair trick with the 4th card out	Long, Hoyle [08-S1, 08-S4]	1793 reverses the condition [08-S2]
Build with cash cards early	Morehead [08-S12, 08-S14] (dealer)	Silberstang: only when safe by count [08-S16]; Danon decoy first [08-S37]
Cash Big Cassino ASAP	Silberstang [08-S16]; Seres (when safe) [08-S35]	saannot.com: save it for a big capture [08-S46b]; Danon: leave it on the table if the opponent has shown no Ten [08-S37]
Track face cards	Psellos (Royal) [08-S36]	Silberstang (standard): unnecessary [08-S16]
Royal Cassino skill	Morehead: “superior” per some authorities [08-S14]; Parlett: experts prefer the advanced variants [08-S53]	Scarne: “less strategic” [08-S15]; Seres: “lacks the charm” [08-S35]
Avoid leaving one capturable card	Universal [08-S1, 08-S2, 08-S38, 08-S39]	1793 lists exceptions (early game, points, close cards race, comfortable score) [08-S2]
Take 3 court cards?	Foster: bad (kills sweeps) [08-S9]	BGG: playing the 4th king deliberately to kill sweeps [08-S39]

9.4 Testing the maxims in simulation (original computation)

No published source tests any Cassino maxim [07 §1]. For this review, each maxim was coded as a small change to the simulator's greedy player and played against an unchanged copy of it [SIM-ST].

Set-up [SIM-ST][07-S40]:

- **Rules:** standard two-player Pagat rules, with sweeps worth 1 point. A hand has about 11.7 points at stake (11.65 in greedy self-play [07-S40]): up to 11 for cards, spades and cash points (cards score nothing on a 26–26 tie), plus about 0.87 for sweeps.
- **Baseline (“greedy”):** makes the capture with the highest immediate value and never builds. When it cannot capture, it trails its least valuable card. In practice that is a random plain card, since every non-spade card from 2 to K except Big Cassino carries the same weight.
- **Duplicate deals:** each shuffled deck is played twice, with the two players swapping seats, so the luck of the deal cancels out. Each variant played 32,000 decks (64,000 hands).
- **Measure:** the variant's average points per hand minus the baseline's, with a 95% confidence interval. A game to 21 lasts about 3.5 hands [07-S40], so +0.3 points per hand is roughly one point per game.
- **Control:** an unchanged copy of the baseline scored +0.005 [−0.023, +0.032], confirming that the harness is unbiased.
- **Second opponent:** the main variants were also played against the one-ply card-counting player, which builds. These runs used 8,000 decks each, with the same decks for every variant, so each variant can be compared directly with plain greedy [SIM-ST].

Results

Maxim (source)	How it was coded	vs greedy (pts/hand)	Gain over greedy vs card-counter
Trail court cards first , then small cards; keep aces and Cassinos (Long VIII; 1793 rule 10) [08-S1][08-S2]	trail order: courts → low numerals → aces/Cassinos; spades last within each group	+0.32 [+0.29, +0.35]	+0.17 [+0.11, +0.24]
Trail small cards , except aces and Little Cassino; avoid spades (Foster) [08-S9]	trail order: low → high (courts last), then spades, then aces/Cassinos	+0.16 [+0.13, +0.19]	+0.02 [−0.04, +0.08]
Trail middle/high cards early, low cards late (Psellos, written for Royal Cassino) [08-S36]	deals 1–3 high-first, deals 4–6 low-first	+0.06 [+0.03, +0.09]	0.00 [−0.06, +0.06]
<i>Control</i> : trail courts, then the highest numerals	trail order: courts → 10 → 9 → ...; suit ignored	−0.57 [−0.60, −0.54]	−0.36 [−0.43, −0.30]
Keep a court card back for the end of the last deal (Long; 1793 rule 16; Foster) [08-S1][08-S2][08-S9]	final deal: don't spend a court card while other cards remain	+0.21 [+0.18, +0.24]	+0.21 [+0.19, +0.23]
— dealer only		+0.11 [+0.08, +0.14]	+0.16 [+0.14, +0.18]
— non-dealer only		+0.11 [+0.08, +0.13]	not run
Take the opponent's trailed card “in Preference to any other” (Long I) [08-S1]	always capture the trailed card when possible	−0.11 [−0.14, −0.09]	−0.14 [−0.18, −0.11]
— as a tie-break only (“if you have a choice”, Foster) [08-S9]	prefer it only among captures worth within 0.25 points of the best	+0.01 [−0.02, +0.04]	+0.04 [+0.02, +0.06]
“Go for ‘cards’ in preference to everything else” (Foster) [08-S9]	value of each card captured doubled (0.2 → 0.4)	−0.01 [−0.04, +0.01]	0.00 [−0.01, +0.01]
— stronger (0.8) / weaker (0.05)		−0.06 / −0.07 (both significant)	not run
<i>Control</i> : overweight spades (bonus 0.15 → 0.5)		−0.07 [−0.10, −0.04]	not run
Never trail a card that makes ten while Big Cassino is unseen (Foster's form of Long V) [08-S1][08-S9]	trail filter	+0.01 [−0.02, +0.03]	not run
Don't leave a table one card can sweep (Long IV; 1793) [08-S1][11-V-S2]	trail filter, no exceptions	0.00 [−0.03, +0.03]	+0.01 [−0.01, +0.04]
Long 1792 bundle : courts first + sweep defence + keep a court + take trailed card	combined	+0.47 [+0.44, +0.50]	+0.25 [+0.18, +0.32]
— same bundle without take-trailed-card	combined	+0.61 [+0.58, +0.64]	+0.44 [+0.38, +0.51]
— same bundle, take-trailed as a tie-break	combined	+0.62 [+0.59, +0.65]	+0.44 [+0.38, +0.51]
Foster 1897 bundle : small cards first + avoid tens + keep a court + cards ×2	combined	+0.30 [+0.27, +0.33]	+0.22 [+0.15, +0.28]

Original computation [SIM-ST]. Middle column: 32,000 duplicate decks per row. Right column: 8,000 duplicate decks per row, paired against plain greedy on the same decks; in absolute terms every variant still loses to the card-counter by 3.2–4.0 points per hand (plain greedy: −3.67; the separate run in §8.4.4, on different decks, gives 3.79 [3.72, 3.86]).

What the tests suggest

- **Trailing court cards first is one of the two most valuable single maxims.**
 - Trailing court cards first is the largest single-rule gain against greedy. Against the card-counter, only keeping a court back gains more. This matches the classical reason: courts “can never be of any other use than to make a pair” [08-S2].
 - Order matters a great deal. The control that trails courts and then *high* numerals loses 0.57 points per hand. The maxim (courts, then *low* numerals) gains 0.32. The gap between them is almost 0.9 points per hand. Most of it probably comes from low versus high numerals, since the only other difference is that the control ignores suit. This is consistent with Foster's reason for trailing small cards: they can “be combined and won with the larger cards kept in the player's hand” [08-S9].

- Psellos's high-cards-early advice adds little here. It was written for Royal Cassino, where courts count 11–13 and can be combined [08-S36], so these standard-rules tests are not a fair test of it.
- **Keeping a court card for the end works, and not only for the dealer.**
 - Foster, Pagat and the 1793 rule address the dealer [08-S2][08-S9][08-S19]. Long states it for either seat: "In the last Deal, a Court-Card or some other ought to be kept to secure the Advantage of the Cards on the Board" [08-S1]. So does Morehead [08-S12]. The simulation supports the seat-neutral reading. Against greedy, the non-dealer gains just as much (+0.11 each way), and the two gains add up to the combined +0.21.
 - The simulation does not show *why* the non-dealer gains. That would need a dedicated experiment.
- **Taking the opponent's trailed card helps only as a tie-break.**
 - Read literally ("in Preference to any other" [08-S1]), it costs 0.11–0.14 points per hand. It also shrinks the Long bundle's gain, from +0.61 to +0.47 against greedy and from +0.44 to +0.25 against the card-counter.
 - As a tie-break among roughly equal captures, it is neutral against greedy and slightly positive against the card-counter. This is Foster's reading ("if you have a choice" [08-S9]). No source gives a reason for the maxim [08 §1.5], and these tests do not supply one.
- **Re-weighting priorities did not help.**
 - The greedy player already values each card at 0.2 points, so doubling that changed nothing measurable. Larger or smaller weights hurt.
 - Overweighting spades also hurt (−0.07), which agrees with the 1793 warning that "the Desire of taking Spades should never bias your Play" [11-V-S2].
 - These results depend on the simulator's card weights, which are a modelling choice [07-S40].
- **Sweep defence works but does not pay on its own.** Refusing to leave a sweepable table cut the opponent's sweeps from 0.44 to 0.39 per hand, but the net gain was zero, presumably because applying the rule without exceptions forces worse trails elsewhere. The 1793 author's four exceptions (early game, a point available, a close race for cards, a comfortable score) [11-V-S2] may be an answer to this cost. The Long bundle's +0.61 exceeds the sum of its parts (+0.53), so the rules interact, but no run isolates the sweep defence's share.
- **The "Big Cassino" trail filter** (never make ten while ♦10 is unseen) had no measurable effect, probably because the situation is rare: it needs a trail that makes ten with the table while ♦10 is still unaccounted for.
- **Maxims recover only a small part of the gap to the card-counter.** The best bundle (Long's maxims without the literal take-the-trailed-card rule) recovers 0.44 of greedy's 3.67-point deficit per hand against the card-counter. The card-counter still beats every greedy-based variant by more than 3.2 points per hand. The card-counter differs in several ways at once: look-ahead, card counting, building, the option to trail when a capture is available, and explicit handling of the last capture. The tests cannot split the gap between these. The whole gap is about eight times what the best bundle recovers.

Limits

- Every variant is the greedy player plus one or more rules. The tests show whether a maxim helps a simple capture-first player, not whether it is part of optimal play.

- The maxims that need memory, inference or building were **not tested**:
 - unpaired-rank counting and negative inference;
 - when to build, raise or take builds;
 - the pair trap;
 - seat-dependent cash-card plans;
 - when to cash Big Cassino. Testing these needs a stronger base agent (§13).
- Results are per hand, under one rule set (Pagat, sweeps scored). Nordic scoring (spades worth 2) and Royal values would need their own runs.

Implications for AI tiers (§9.5):

- Tier 2 should use the maxims that hold up: courts first, then low cards; keep a court card for the end in either seat; take the trailed card only as a tie-break.
- Taking the trailed card at any cost, and a fixed bias towards spades, are cheap ways to make a lower tier slightly weaker in a way that looks human.
- The large gap to the card-counter suggests that memory, look-ahead and building, not more maxims, should separate Tier 2 from Tier 3.

9.5 AI difficulty tiers (from note 08)

Design principle: tiers differ in (a) what the AI *remembers*, (b) how far it *looks ahead*, (c) whether it *infers* hidden cards, and (d) how many of the classical heuristics it applies. The Scopone study is the best empirical template. It built a beginner “Greedy” bot and expert rule bots (Chitarrella–Saracino and Cicuti–Guardamagna), plus a fair ISMCTS bot that beat them, and humans won “47.6% against Greedy and 42.9% against CS ... and won only the 23.8% of the matches against the fair ISMCTS player” [08-S48]. Rule-based bots built from traditional maxims therefore make credible mid tiers. Search with hidden-card sampling makes a credible top tier.

Tier 1 — Beginner (“Greedy, no memory”)

Behaviour, each item cited:

- Capture whenever possible; otherwise trail. This is the BGG solo-variant automaton: “If it can capture one or more cards, it will ... If it can’t ... it will trail them ... The AI does not build.” [08-S42]
- Among captures, take the most valuable or most cards: “tries to perform the best capture available or it plays the least valuable card if a capture is not available” [08-S48]. Cassino prizes: cards, spades, cash points [08-S1, 08-S9, 08-S14].
- Trail simple discards: court cards first, then small cards [08-S1, 08-S2, 08-S4]. Never trail a 10/2 while a Cassino is out [08-S1, 08-S4]. This is cheap to implement and makes the bot look sensible.
- Basic sweep defence: avoid leaving a lone card when possible [08-S38]. Di Palma & Lanzi’s Greedy bot also prioritizes “moves that do not leave on the table a combination of cards which could be captured by a card that is still in play” [08-S48].
- No card memory, no inference, no deliberate building (or only “build if I hold the capture card and the pile $\geq N$ ”, like the hobby bot’s lowest level, which disfavours special cards and caps “max amount of table cards to pick” at 2 [08-S50]).
- Expected feel: Psellos notes that a strong-memory bot that “doesn’t try to guess your cards” is beatable “plenty of the time” [08-S36]. A beginner bot should be weaker than that.

Tier 2 — Intermediate (“Hoyle player”)

Adds the classical maxims and partial memory:

- Tracks the cash points and the high spot cards (♦10, ♠2, aces; tens, nines, eights) but not everything: “Most players do not make a great effort to remember all other cards” [08-S13]; see also [08-S2, 08-S9, 08-S16].
- Keeps running totals of cards and spades and switches priorities once a majority is clinched (27 cards / 7 spades) [08-S13, 08-S15, 08-S12, 08-S19].
- Capture preferences: the opponent’s trailed card, as a tie-break (§9.4) [08-S1, 08-S2, 08-S9]; spades in ties [08-S4, 08-S9]; the Ace before Big Cassino [08-S2]; combinations before pairs early [08-S4]; more cards per capture [08-S9].
- Trail heuristics conditioned on counts: play the 4th ace at once when three are out [08-S2, 08-S9]; prefer Little Cassino over an Ace as a forced trail [08-S2]; trail dead ranks [08-S3, 08-S20]; avoid trailing spades [08-S9, 08-S13]; don’t make ten while ♦10 is unseen [08-S9, 08-S12].
- Builds only by a simple EV test: “build only if you get more than 1 extra point” early, more freely later [08-S36]. Uses multiple builds for protection [08-S9, 08-S43]. Raises or steals opponent builds when holding the card [08-S9].
- Endgame: in the final deal, keeps a court card for the last capture in either seat (§9.4) [08-S1, 08-S9, 08-S19]. As non-dealer, saves a cash card for the last trail of a deal [08-S12, 08-S14].
- Score-aware sweep defence per the 1793 rule-21 exceptions [08-S2].
- Hobby precedent for tuning: the MakinenJO bot’s level 3 adds `tactic_next` (“try placing card tactically for good pickup next round”) and higher weights for aces, ♠2 and spades [08-S50].

Tier 3 — Expert (“Morehead/Culbertson player”)

Adds full memory and inference:

- Knows every rank still to come, and in the last deal the opponent’s exact hand [08-S12]. Tracks unpaired ranks to deduce the final hands [08-S13, 08-S30]. Uses the 220/364 pip total as a cross-check [08-S24, 08-S47a; Derived §2.7].
- Systematic negative inference: “If he had a ten he would have done this...” [08-S13]; the opponent passing a Cassino means he lacks its pair [08-S37]; a surviving build means he lacks its rank [08-S40].
- Opening probability model: about 9% per unseen card per opponent card [08-S36]. EV comparison of capture vs build vs trail [08-S36].
- Seat-aware cash-card plans: dealer builds them early, non-dealer saves them [08-S14, 08-S13]. Ace timing by seat [08-S2].
- Advanced tricks:
 - “Saving your Ten” (leave ♦10 when the opponent has shown no Ten) [08-S37]
 - Decoy builds to draw out an opponent’s Ten [08-S37]
 - Trailing builds to rescue Big Cassino [08-S37]
 - Letting the opponent build first, then taking his build [08-S16]
 - Bluff-trailing instead of building to hide intent [08-S39]
 - Pair-trap trailing when the 4th card is out [08-S1, 08-S4]
- Sweep locks: plays or holds the 4th court card depending on whether it wants sweeps [08-S9, 08-S39]. Avoids leaving one-card-capturable tables unless the 1793 exceptions apply [08-S2].

- Score-state play: lurch denial [08-S4, 08-S2]; counting out at 21 [08-S9, 08-S18].
- Partnership mode (4-handed): builds for partner's declared card where the rules allow it [08-S9, 08-S10, 08-S19]; trails a matching card for partner [08-S19]; protects partner's trailed ace [08-S2]; treats a partner's repeated rank as a likely "double" signal (Scopone/African practice) [08-S23, 08-S30, 08-S22].

Tier 4 (optional) — "Search" opponent

- Determinized search (ISMCTS) over hidden hands, seeded by the Tier-3 inference model. In Scopone, ISMCTS beat the best rule-based expert and was the hardest fair opponent for humans [08-S48].
- A cheating perfect-information MCTS was strongest (humans won 4.8%) but was not fair [08-S48]. Avoid it, or label it clearly.
- Equilibrium methods (CFR) have been applied to Pasur, a close relative, though under a simplified "full knowledge of each other's hands" setting [08-S49]. That paper also reports that "the distribution of high-value cards heavily influences match outcomes" [08-S49]. That is a reminder that even perfect play has high variance, which argues for multi-deal matches when testing tiers.

Knobs for tuning between tiers (each tied to a sourced behaviour)

1. Memory scope: none → cash points + high cards [08-S13] → all ranks [08-S12] → unpaired-rank tracking [08-S13, 08-S30].
 2. Inference: off → negative inference from passed captures [08-S13, 08-S37] → probabilistic hand model [08-S36].
 3. Build appetite: never [08-S42] → EV-gated [08-S36] → seat- and score-aware [08-S14, 08-S2].
 4. Trail policy: courts/small [08-S1, 08-S4] → count-aware dead ranks [08-S3, 08-S20] → game-phase aware (high early, low late) [08-S36].
 5. Endgame: none → keep court for last [08-S1, 08-S9] → full last-deal hand reading [08-S12].
 6. Deliberate errors at low tiers (Psellos: "Only really serious Cassino players will track all the cards" [08-S36]). A beginner bot that "forgets" whether ♦10 has been seen behaves like a typical human.
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10. Cassino beyond English: regional traditions

10.1 Highlights

• Finland (Kasino):

- Face cards are 11/12/13. In hand, the ace is 14, *pieni kasino* (♠2) is 15 and *iso kasino* (♦10) is 16; on the table they count 1, 2 and 10 [10-S1].
- Ten points are scored per deal: most cards 1, most spades 2 [10-S1].
- A sweep is a *mökki* (“hut”). If the opponent already has one, a new sweep “kaadetaan” (knocks it down) instead of scoring [10-S1].
- Ties “siirtyvät seuraavaan jakoon” (carry over to the next deal) [10-S1].
- The game goes to 16 and may end mid-deal [10-S1].
- The earliest *mökki* found in print is a 1938 pulp story. It sneers at “amerikkalaisittain, ilman mitään mökkejä, sieppauksia ja muuta maallista turhuutta” (the American way, without any mökkis, snatches or other worldly vanity) [10-S6].

• Sweden (Kasino, Byggkasino, Krypkasino, Mulle):

- Lyckans Talisman documents a hand-value *choice*: “Spelaren som står på tur får välja om storan skall räknas som sexton ögon eller de vanliga tio ögonen” (the player whose turn it is may choose whether the big one counts sixteen or the usual ten) [10-S24].
- It also documents a rich set of calls (“sistan” *last one*, “båten går” *the boat’s leaving*, “ligger” *lies*, “trött” *tired*, “storan privat” *the big one, private*, “tabbe på knekt” *sweep on a jack*) [10-S24][10-S25][10-S26].
- Mulle has margin slang: “hundraklubben” (the hundred club), “senap” (mustard), “ketchup” [10-S26].

• Norway:

- Kasino is listed among “Påskespill” (Easter games), with “Papir og blyant til poengene” (paper and pencil for the points) [10-S32].
- Strategy tip: avoid table sums of 14, 15 or 16, which an opponent can take with an ace, ♠2 or ♦10 [10-S32].

• Denmark:

- “Spar 5 rydder bordet” (the ♠5 clears the table) [10-S37].
- The sweep is a “svupper”; “De fleste spiller med at ‘svuppere’ udligner hinanden” (most play that svuppers cancel each other out) [10-S37].
- An 1829 rulebook follows the Anglo-German text: “dette kalder man Svep eller Kjørud” (this is called a Svep or Kjørud) [10-S36].

• Iceland: a family scores *Stóra-kasína* 5 and *Litla-kasína* 2, with a *svippur* (sweep) worth 1 [10-S40].

• Germany / Poland:

- The 1797 and 1821 texts translate the English rules, with pronunciation notes for “Sweep” and “Lurch” [10-S41][10-S46].
- Modern German dictionaries have no card-game sense for *Kasino* [10-S43].
- Zwicker survives in Schleswig-Holstein [10-S44].

- **Hungary:** Kaszinó has 3-card deals, multi-card captures from the hand, “Ausz!” (*Out!*) and “Fals!” (*False!*) [01-S20]. It appears in Tandori’s novels [10-S56].
- **Russia:** “сказать: «Строю 7»” (say: “I build 7”); “смести подчистую” (to sweep clean) [10-S57]. A separate folk game, *Скона*, scores clubs instead of spades [01-S58].
- **Brazil / Portugal:**
 - Casino is little known in Brazil. “Assim mesmo, com um ‘s’ só (pronuncia-se casinó)” (Just like that, with a single ‘s’, pronounced casinó) [10-S49].
 - The fishing game Brazilians actually play is *Escopa/Escova*, brought by Italian immigrants [10-S49][09-S82].
 - Dictionaries define “Cassino grande, o dez de ouros. Cassino pequeno, o dois de espadas” (Big cassino, the ten of diamonds; little cassino, the two of spades) [10-S50].
- **Argentina:** “El Casino o Cassino es un juego de cartas de origen inglés” (Casino or Cassino is a card game of English origin) [10-S53]. Escoba de 15 has an official seniors’ tournament regulation [10-S54].
- **Ecuador:** the related Cuarenta is a public festival game with a world championship held since 1968/69 [05-S55][10-S55].
- **Japan:** “ゲーム名は「カシノ」ではなく「カシノ」になります” (the game’s name is “kashino”, not “kajino” [casino]) [10-S59].
 - Japanese “ビルド” (“build”) means capture-by-sum, while the English build is “付け札” (*tsukefuda*, “attached card”) [01-S24].
 - This is a localisation trap [01 §2.9].
- **French / Québec:** “gros casino (10 de carreau) 2 points; Le petit casino (2 de pique) 1 point” (*big casino* [10♦] 2 points; *little casino* [2♠] 1 point) (Mainguy 1987) [10-S62].
- **Afrikaans:** “Bly jy maar hier vanaand by my, en speel kasino, man” (Just stay here with me tonight and play kasino, man; Leipoldt) [10-S61].

10.2 Cross-national comparison (from note 10)

Country / form	♦ 10 name	♠ 2 name	Hand values ♦ 10 / ♠ 2 / A	Face cards	Sweep term and score	Last-deal call or last capture	Majority scoring	Game to	Notes
Finland, Kasino [10-S1]	<i>iso kasino, ruu-tukymppi</i>	<i>pieni/pikku kasino, patakakkonen</i>	16 / 15 / 14 (fixed: hand vs table)	11/12/13	<i>mökki</i> , +1; cancels the opponent’s (<i>kaataa</i>); none in the last deal	Leftovers go to the last capturer; no point	cards 1, spades 2; ties carry over (“pakkaan”)	16 (21 with extra-spade rule)	Variants: <i>laisto-</i> , <i>raken-nus-</i> , <i>pakkakasi-no</i>
Sweden, Kasino [10-S24][10-S28]	<i>storan, storstina, stora kasino; storkajsa</i>	<i>lillan, lillstina, lilla kasino; lillkajsa</i>	player’s choice 16 or 10 / 15 or 2 / 14 or 1 (variants: fixed)	11/12/13	<i>tabbe/tabberas</i> (from <i>table rase</i>), +1; offset-card tally	“sistan” / “båten går” / “sista given”; optional <i>sistan</i> +1	cards 1, spades 2	16	Calls: “tabbe på knekt”, “storan privat”
Sweden, Byggkasino [10-S25]	as above	as above	fixed 16/15/14	11/12/13	tabbe +1 (variant: cancel, or none)	as above	cards 3, spades 1	21	“bygger till...”, “ligger”, “två åttor”
Sweden, Mulle (2 decks) [10-S26]	<i>storan</i>	<i>lillan</i>	16/15/14	11/12/13	tabbe +1; <i>mulle</i> = twin capture, scores its pip value	“båten”	1 per spade	Margin play	“trött”, “hundraklubben”, “senap”, “ketchup”

Country / form	♦ 10 name	♠ 2 name	Hand values ♦ 10 / ♠ 2 / A	Face cards	Sweep term and score	Last-deal call or last capture	Majority scoring	Game to	Notes
Norway [10-S32][10-S29]	<i>storekasino</i> (Nynorsk <i>storekasino</i>)	<i>lillekasino</i> (Nynorsk <i>veslekasino</i>)	16/15/14	13/12/11 both ways	<i>tabbe</i> +1, card turned face up	“sisten” +1	cards 1, spades 1	16	“bygger 9”, <i>dobling</i> ; Easter/cabin game
Denmark [10-S37][10-S38][10-S34][10-S35]	<i>store kasino</i>	<i>lille kasino</i>	10 or 16 / 2 or 15 / 1 or 14	number values	<i>svupper</i> +1 (historically <i>svip</i> , <i>svippe</i>); sweeps cancel	“sidsten” +1	spades 2, cards 1	21	♠ 5 clears the table; “mere syv”
Iceland [10-S39][10-S40]	<i>stóra kasína</i> (5 pts)	<i>litla kasína</i> (2 pts)	not stated	11/12/13; A 1/14	<i>svippur</i> (also <i>borðskeiningur</i>) +1	last trick +1	spades 1, aces (majority) 1, cards 1	21	Unusual weights
Germany, 1797 [10-S41]	<i>das große Cassino</i>	<i>das kleine Cassino</i>	none (10 and 2)	pair only	table cleared +1 (“den Tisch räumen”)	“Sweep / Kehraus” (last cards)	cards 3, spades 1; subtractive scoring	11 (Lurch = 5)	3-handed to 15, count-out order
Germany, Zwicker [10-S44]	Karo-Zehn 10 pts	n/a (♦ 7, ♠ 7 1 each)	n/a	K14 Q13 J12 A11	Zwicker 3	n/a	cards 1	agreed	Table = “Bild”; capture = <i>stechen</i>
Poland, 1821 [10-S46]	<i>wielkie Kasino</i>	<i>małe Kasino</i>	none	pair only	“Stół sprząta” +1	“Sweep albo wymiatacz”	as German	11	Counter-marking chart
Hungary [10-S56]	<i>nagy kaszinó</i>	<i>kis kaszinó</i>	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	<i>laptöbbség</i> 3, <i>pikktöbbség</i> 1	n/a	Score chant (Tandori)
Russia [10-S57]	большое казино	малое казино	none	pairs (or 3 of a kind)	“смести подчистую” +1	last capturer	27+ cards 3; spades 7+ 1	21	“Строю 7”
Brazil, Casino [10-S49]	<i>grande casino / cassino grande</i>	<i>pequeno casino</i> (folk: <i>casininho</i>)	none	pair only	n/a in article	“últimas cartas”	cards 3, spades 1	21	“construindo seis”; called unfamiliar in Brazil
Argentina, Casino [10-S53]; Escoba [10-S54]	<i>Gran Casino</i> (casino)	<i>Pequeño Casino</i>	n/a	n/a	Escoba: card face up, 1 per escoba	n/a	Escoba: cartas, oros, setenta, 7 de oro	Escoba 30	Sum-to-15 arithmetic invariant
Ecuador, Cuarenta [10-S55]	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	<i>limpia</i>	n/a	n/a	40	<i>caída</i> ; shouted calls
Italy, Scopa/Scopone [10-S48]	n/a (<i>settebello</i>)	n/a	n/a	8/9/10 (Italian deck)	<i>scopa</i> , card face up	last capture, no scopa	carte, denari, settebello, primiera	11 or 16	Matching card must be taken before sums
France/Québec [10-S62]	<i>gros/grand casino</i>	<i>petit casino</i>	n/a	n/a	“coups de balai” (translation)	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
Japan [10-S59]	ビッグカシノ [UNVERIFIED: search summary only]	リトルカシノ [UNVERIFIED: search summary only]	none (A = 1)	not numbers; pair only	[UNVERIFIED: search summary only]	n/a	[UNVERIFIED: search summary only]	21	付け札 = build; likened to hanafuda
Greece, Xeri [10-S60]	10 καρό = 2	(2♣ = 1)	n/a	n/a	ξερή 10, with jack 20	n/a	n/a	n/a	Jack takes all

(n/a = not stated in the fetched source.)

Patterns visible in the table:

1. Apart from the German 1810 *Spielalmanach* and the German Wikipedia text derived from it [01-S83], only the Nordic family gives ♦ 10, ♠ 2 and aces higher capture values from the hand.

2. Nordic sweeps usually score 1 and may cancel each other.
3. The English-derived continental texts (German 1797, Polish 1821, Danish 1829, Russian, Brazilian) keep “pair-only” face cards and cards = 3 points.
4. The ♦10 survives as a point card even in other fishing games: Greek Xeri and German Zwicker [10-S60][10-S44].

10.3 What each Wikipedia edition says (from note 01)

Key: “h/t” = cards to each hand / to the table. Values are as stated in that edition; “—” = not stated.

Sources: en [01-S1], da [01-S11], de [01-S14], fi [01-S17], hu [01-S20], it [01-S23], ja [01-S24], nb [01-S26], sv [01-S29], ru [01-S58], nl/de Wippen [01-S59, 01-S60].

	en (English 1792 / American 1867)	da	de	fi	hu	it	ja	nb	sv	ru «Скона»	Wippen (nl/de)
Players	2–4 (Amer. 2,3,4,6)	2–4	2 or 4 (3 var.)	2–4, pairs	2 (3–4 var.)	2–4, pairs	2 (to 4)	2–4 (5 var.)	2–4, best 2	2–4, pairs	2+ (to 6 w/ 2 packs)
Deal h/t	4/4	4/4 (in 2s)	2p: 12; 3p: 7; 4p: 4; table 4	4/4 (in 2s)	3/4	4/4 (in 2s)	4/4 (2×2)	4/4; point cards on table re-placed	4/4	4/4	4/4 (in 2s)
J/Q/K value	none (pair only); Royal 11/12/13	implied 11/12/13 (“bygge til 12 (dame)”)	11/12/13	11/12/13	11/12/13	none	none	— (old rev: Q=12 example)	11/12/13	none	none
A / ♠2 / ♦10 special values	— (German 1810: 14/15/16)	1 or 14 / 2 or 15 / 10 or 16	1 or 14 / 2 or 15 / 10 or 16	14/15/16 in hand only	none	none	none	14/15/16 in hand	A 1 or 14	none	none
Other special card	—	♠5 clears table	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Building	Amer. yes; English 1792 no	yes (“bygger 9”, “mere syv”)	yes (bauen)	no (Rakennuskasino var.)	no; but multi-card hand combos ≤13	yes	yes (付け札)	yes (“doble”)	no (Byggkasino is separate)	no	yes (advanced)
Most cards	3	1 or 2	3 (≥27)	1 (ties carry over)	3 (≥27)	3	3	1	1	2 (26–26: 1 each)	2
Most spades	1	1 or 2	1 (≥7)	2 (ties carry over ×2)	2 (≥7)	1	1	1 (talk: most play 2)	2	most clubs 1	2
♦10	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	1	2
♠2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	2♣ 1	1
Each ace	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1
Sweep	1 (“sweep”)	1 (“svupper”; cancel)	1 (“geräumter Tisch”)	1 (“mökki”; cancel; none in last deal)	1, or 2 on first turn (“tábla”); opp. moves twice	1 (“sweep”/scopa)	1 (スイープ)	1 (“tabbe”)	1 (“tabbe”)	—	1 (“wip”, not last deal)
Last capture	0	1 (“sidsten”)	0	0 (var. 1)	0	0	—	1	1 (“sistan”)	0	0
Base pts/ deal (excl. sweeps)	11	10–12	11	10	12	11	11	10	11 (incl. sisten)	5	11

	en (English 1792 / American 1867)	da	de	fi	hu	it	ja	nb	sv	ru «Кона»	Wippen (nl/de)
Target	11 (lurch <6), or each deal a game; 21 (1880)	21; closest to 21 wins if several exceed	21	16 (var. 21; exact-16 var.)	11, claimed by “Auszl!”	11 or 21	21	— (talk: 16)	16	e.g. 21	agreed (e.g. 52)

Notes:

- 1. Spade Cassino (en): every spade 1 and the ♠J +1, 24 points per hand, game 61 [01-S1, 01-S78]; the it edition says 25 [01-S23].
 - 1. Finnish ties “jää pakkaan” [stay in the deck] and accumulate [01-S17].
 - 1. The de deal sizes conflict with every other edition [01-S14].
 - 1. The hu last round is played with open hands [01-S20].
-

11. Cassino in culture: literature, social life, idioms

11.1 Literature and drama

- **Austen:**

- Letter of 1800: “There was a whist and a casino table, and six outsiders” [04-S19].
- *Sense and Sensibility*: “Lady Middleton proposed a rubber of Casino” [04-S17].
- *Pride and Prejudice*, ch. 29: “Their table was superlatively stupid” [04-S16].
- *The Watsons*: “Lady Osborne’s casino table” [04-S18].

- **Reynolds, *Cheap Living* (1797)**: “I do long for a game of cassino — that is, in the family way — just for a trifle” [04-S20][01-S76].

- **Dickens, *David Copperfield* (1850)**: “play casino with Mrs. Micawber” [04-S22].

- **Jack London, “A Goboto Night” (1912)**. The richest literary transcript of a game, covering house-rule negotiation, card memory and claims [04-S28].

- Card memory: “I suppose you can name the four cards I hold” / “The knave of spades, the deuce of spades, the tray of hearts, and the ace of diamonds” [04-S28].
- Claiming: “I go out on little casino and the four aces. ‘Big casino’ and ‘spades’ only bring you to twenty” [04-S28].
- The story was translated into Finnish (1915), Nynorsk (1929), French (1936) and Russian. The translators’ choices document local vocabulary [10-S4][10-S30][10-S62][10-S58].

- **O. Henry** uses “big casino” and “little casino” figuratively several times [04-S24][04-S25][04-S26].

- **Later appearances:**

- Welty’s *Delta Wedding*: children “playing cassino” [04-S82].
- Heyer’s Regency pastiche *The Toll-Gate*: “Play cassino with Ben!” [04-S61].
- Feydeau’s farce in English translation: “Clean sweep! You owe me a hundred francs” [04-S159].

11.2 Social history

- **1790s London**: Cassino was a craze among the fashionable [09-S70]. Whist players disparaged it in verse: “Who cry, ‘Casino! well enough for Chits!’” [04-S21].

- **Stakes were small:**

- “half a crown is an exorbitant Sum to be sure at 3d cassino” (1804) [04-S45].
- “just for a trifle” (1797) [04-S20].

- **The game travelled with the gentry:**

- Berlin (1798): “played Cassino for the first time with Mad: de Haugwitz” [04-S44].
- Jamaica (1801–05) [04-S46].
- Russia (1804–08) [04-S36].

- **America, 1870s–1920s:**

- “Cassino is all the rage in Mineral Point” (1878) [04-S102].
- “Progressive cassino” parties with head and foot prizes [04-S105][04-S106].
- Money matches “for \$25 a side” (1894) [04-S118].
- Disputes that turned violent (1900, 1902) [04-S121][04-S122].

- Courtship: “John proposed to play me a game of cassino to see who should escort Thilda home” [04-S78].
- **Teaching arithmetic:**
 - A 1923 mother reports that her three-year-old “learned to play cassino ... that was the way he learned to add”. She also invented a “color-cassino” [04-S128].
 - The 1952 USPCC: “no happier introduction to arithmetic was ever devised!” [03-S36].
 - Finnish commenters recommend Kasino for “päässäälaskua” (mental arithmetic) [10-S1].
- **Prison transmission** is a recurring thread:
 - Swedish Mulle as “kåkfärrarvarianten” [01-S72].
 - South African prison and tavern play [01-S8].
 - US players: “I was taught by someone who played in jail a lot” [05-S100].
- **Dual reputation:**
 - “In the average home Casino is known as a children’s game, but among gamblers it is known as the finest two-handed game of skill” (Morehead 1944) [02-S30].
 - Parlett suggests the children’s reputation is why “their potential depth has gone unnoticed” [04-S50].
- **No organised tournaments.** Chronicling America searches for “cassino tournament”, “cassino contest” and “cassino champion(ship)” returned **zero** hits. “Progressive” parties were the competitive format [04 §Gaps].

11.3 Idioms that came from the game

- **“Big casino”** (Green’s Dictionary of Slang) means [04-S10]:
 - an important person;
 - the ultimate;
 - a fatal disease, especially cancer: “Look, doc, give it to me straight, is it the Big Casino?” (*Ocean’s Eleven*, 1960). *The Sopranos* uses it the same way [04-S10].
- **“Little casino”** means something insignificant, and also gonorrhoea [04-S12].
- **“To give someone cards and spades”** means to concede a large handicap. Green’s earliest citation is 1861 [04-S13].
 - Extended forms: “could give me cards and spades and big Cassino and then beat me out” (1901) [04-S146].
 - Jack London: “We can give ‘em cards and spades an’ little casino an’ win out on big casino and the aces” [04-S29].
- **Swedish *tabberas*** (“to make a clean sweep”) is used figuratively by Astrid Lindgren: “Nu har vi tagit tabberas på allting” (now we’ve made a clean sweep of everything) [10-S19].
- **Danish “at rydde bordet”** (“to clear the table”) is traced to Kasino by Lex.dk [05-S44].
- **The Billy the Kid “Big Casino / Little Casino” nicknames** appear in the film *Chisum* (1970) and on websites. They are **absent** from Garrett’s own 1882 *Authentic Life* and from Burns (1926) [04-S52] [04-S165][04-S57]. They are probably a 20th-century embellishment, though this is unconfirmed [04 §6]. ## 12. Contradictions in the literature, and how they were resolved Each item was checked against the primary source during this review. The page images are in [research/evidence/](#).

#	Claim in circulation	What the primary source shows	Status
V1	“The earliest sources use the spelling Casino” (Pagat); Long’s title is “...Casino” (Pratesi) [02-S1][09-S70]	Long’s 1792 title page reads “CASSINO”. The rival 1792/93 poem uses “Casino” and calls Long’s spelling an error [11-V-S1][11-V-S2]	Both spellings date from the start; Pagat and Pratesi are wrong about Long
V2	Early rules gave no points for sweeps (Pratesi) [02-S30]	Long (1792): “he clears the Board, and marks one Point in the Game as often as repeated”; the poem (1793): “Whoever clears the Board reckons for each Time one Point absolutely” [11-V-S1][11-V-S2]	Pratesi is right that “sweep” then meant the final take, but wrong about points
V3	Continental Casino derives from Long / “the English rules” (implicit assumption; cf. note 10’s “1797 translation of the English rules”) [10-S41]	The German 1797 laws translate the 1793 poem (lurch = five, Florentine etymology, three-handed play to 15 with a fixed count-out order) [11-V-S6][11-V-S2]	The Continental line descends from the poem
V4	Building first printed in 1864 [01-S1]	The <i>American Hoyle</i> ’s 4th-edition preface lists Cassino as “added to the fourth edition”; building is first printed in 1866 (<i>American Card Player</i>) [11-V-S3][11-V-S4]	The 1864 date is wrong
V5	“Set-back or Bounce Cassino” [05-S8][01-S79]	Page image reads “Set-back or Rounce Cassino” [11-V-S3]	“Bounce” is an OCR error
V6	“Big Cassino” first in Foster 1897 [05-S11b]	“big cassino” appears in an 1875 sermon and an 1878 newspaper [04-S138][04-S102]	Antedated by about 20 years
V7	Spade Cassino = 25 points per hand (it.wiki) [01-S23]	Foster: “24 points are made in every hand” [03-S23]	24
V8	Royal Cassino rules first appear in Foster 1897; Royal Draw in 1911 [01-S1]	Court values 11/12/13 appear in German play by 1810/1846 and in Dick’s American variation of 1894; “Royal Draw” appears in 1898 [01-S83][03-S11][03-S22][03-S24]	Older than claimed
V9	Long and the 1793 <i>Sporting Magazine</i> contradict each other on the pair trap [08 §3.6]	The magazine merges Long’s laws with the poem’s “General Rules” and reverses Long’s condition; Hoyle kept Long’s sense [11-V-S7][03-S6]	Copying slip; the classical maxims trace to the poem
—	“Royal Cassino” means face cards have no value (BarGames101) [02-S44]	Royal means courts are 11/12/13 [02-S3]	Web error
—	Cassino is Italian (nb, hu, cs Wikipedia; Dick 1866; Lindskog 1847) [01-S26][01-S20][01-S62][03-S14][10-S16]	No Italian game called Casino is attested; Scopa and Scopone are documented later [09-S70][09-S71]	Unsupported tradition. Its earliest printed form is the 1792/93 poem’s Florentine etymology [04-S21]
—	Cassino is of Chinese origin (sv Wikipedia) [01-S29]	This misapplies a claim about the fishing <i>mechanism</i> [01 §2.11]	Unsupported for Cassino itself
—	Brazil is a Cassino country (research brief)	Brazil plays Escopa; casino is “radicalmente diferente dos carteados mais populares no Brasil” [10-S49][09-S82]	Not supported
—	Kap Tai Shap is a fishing game (research brief)	It is a rummy-type domino game [09-S39][09-S87]	Not supported
—	The Billy the Kid “Big/Little Casino” nicknames	Absent from Garrett (1882) and Burns (1926); they appear in the 1970 film <i>Chisum</i> [04-S165][04-S57][04-S52]	Probably a 20th-century embellishment
—	Ludii has formalised Cassino	No fishing game exists in Ludii [02-S65][07-S33]	Not supported

13. Open questions and gaps

- **Dealer vs non-dealer edge for strong play.** The simulations disagree in sign, so a stronger agent (ISMCTS, CFR) is needed [07 §6.10].
- **Sources not reached:**
 - *The Conjuror's Magazine* (1793) [03 §4].
 - The Vienna/Prague 1795 *Gesetzbuch* and Ulmann (1890) [09 §11].
 - The OED's first citations [04 §Gaps].
 - Parlett's *History of Card Games* and *Penguin* (2008) text [09 §11].
 - Pratesi's archive work beyond his 1995 article [09-S70].
- **Newspapers not searched:** Trove (Australia), Papers Past (NZ), the British Newspaper Archive and Danish Mediestream [04 §Gaps][10 §Gaps].
- **Regional evidence still thin:** Newfoundland, Maritime Canada, Romania and the Brazilian hemeroteca turned up no evidence [04 §Gaps][10 §Gaps].
- **Unresolved etymologies:**
 - *mökki* before 1938 [10 §Gaps].
 - Cuarenta's "shunsho" and "Capariche" [05 §Gaps].
 - *døgga* and Danish *sidsten*, which rest on unsourced wiki text [05 §Gaps].
- **Spoken table talk:** YouTube caption transcripts and regional Reddit communities could not be mined [05 §Gaps]. The **English sweep shout** remains undocumented [05 §3a].
- **No dedicated Cassino scorekeeping product** (pad, board or patent) has been found [06 §1.7–1.8].
- **No strategy literature** was found for Spade Cassino or Draw Cassino [08 §12].
- **Maxims not yet tested in simulation:** building and raising advice, negative inference, the pair trap, seat-dependent cash-card plans and Big Cassino timing. These need a base agent that builds and remembers (§9.4).

14. Recommendations for the video game (each traced to evidence above)

1. **Ship rule presets and a variation builder.** Players hold strong and conflicting house rules (§3.2–3.3) [06-S19][06-S22][06-S27]. Suggested presets:
 - *Classic (Pagat/Hoyle 1950s)* [02-S1][03-S36]
 - *Foster 1897 (21 points, count-out claims, raise-own-build)* [03-S31]
 - *Regency 1792 (no building, lurch, difference scoring)* [11-V-S1]
 - *Royal* [03-S24]
 - *Spade (61, cribbage-board scoring)* [03-S23]
 - *Nordic Kasino (16, mökki/tabbe with cancellation)* [10-S1][10-S24]
 - *Byggkasino* [10-S25]
 - *Hungarian Kaszinó* [01-S20]
 - *South African 40-card* [02-S4]
 - *Stealing Bundles (kids)* [03-S36]
2. **Make announcements part of the interface.** From 1867 the spoken build/call was binding, singular for builds and plural for locks [03-S15]. Show labels such as *Building 8* vs *Building 8s* / *Two 8s*, voice them, and let opponents “separate” undeclared builds in a *Strict 1867* mode [03-S15][03-S25].
3. **Voice the dealer’s “Last” and use a sound cue.** Players notice when it is missing [06-S20][06-S34]. Localise it as “sistan / båten går”, “sisten”, “sidsten”, “últimas cartas” [10 §18].
4. **Show the sweep as a rotated face-up card in the capture pile.** This is the near-universal physical convention [03-S31][10-S24][02-S10]. Swedish players offset each one to make a tally [10-S24]. Animate cancellation by turning cards face down [03-S22]. Keep celebrations short [06-S40].
5. **Live trackers:** cards (toward 27), spades (toward 7), cash points and sweeps, with an end-of-hand breakdown checked against the 11-point total [03-S31][02-S1][06-S20][06-S33].
6. **A claim / count-out button with a selectable precedence order:**
 - Foster’s (cards first) [03-S31]
 - the 1793 seniority order (Great Casino first) [11-V-S2]
 - no precedence (“Neither cards nor any other point has precedence”, *New York Clipper*, 1883) [04-S131]

Show a penalty for a false claim [03-S31][03-S35].
7. **Never infer intent.** Use explicit capture / build / trail choices that show only legal options [06 §12] [06-S33][06-S34]. Give human and AI identical rules, and explain why a move is refused [06 §12.3].
8. **Make fairness visible:**
 - replay with all hands revealed;
 - same-deal daily challenges;
 - AI difficulty defined by memory and inference rather than peeking [06-S27][06-S19][06-S42][06-S49].
9. **AI tiers** following the Scopone template [07-S2][08 §15]:
 - **Greedy:** the bot humans beat most often in Scopone (47.6% wins) [07-S2].

- **Hoyle 1793/1897 rule bot:** classical maxims, prioritising those the simulations support: courts first, then low cards; keep a court for the end; take the trailed card only as a tie-break (§9.4) [SIM-ST].
- **Card-counting look-ahead:** beats greedy in 91% of games [07-S40].
- **ISMCTS.**

10. **Chatter and personality** drawn from attested speech:

- English build calls, “Last”, count-out claims [03-S15][02-S1][04-S28];
- the Hungarian “Ausz!” and “Fals!” [01-S20];
- Cuarenta-style taunts as an optional “rowdy table” [05-S57];
- Finnish suit puns [10-S2];
- the 1792 poem’s personified “Great Casino” and “Casino’s younger Brother” for card flavour text [04-S21].

11. **Teaching ladder** modelled on Wippen and Stealing Bundles: pairing → summing → building → raising → multiple builds [09-S61][03-S36]. The arithmetic-teaching heritage is a marketing angle [04-S128][10-S1].

12. **Store naming.** Searching “Casino” returns gambling apps. Use “Cassino (card game)” and regional names (Kasino, Kasi Cassino) [02-S62][06-S27][06-S22]. ## Appendix A. Repository map

- `cassino-lit-review.md`: this document (assembled from `drafts/` by `tools/assemble.sh`). `cassino-lit-review.pdf` is built from it by `tools/build_pdf.sh` (pandoc + WeasyPrint, styled by `tools/pdf.css`).
- `research/01-wikipedia.md` ... `research/10-multilingual.md`: the ten research notes. Each contains its full, numbered source list, plus quotations and tables too long for this review.
- `research/11-coordinator-verifications.md`: primary-source checks of contradictions (V1–V9).
- `research/evidence/`: page images of the key primary sources:
 - Long 1792 title and pp. 5–7;
 - *American Hoyle*, 4th ed., p. 221;
 - the 1793 poem, p. 31.
- `research/sim/`: simulation code and outputs.
 - `cassino_sim.py`: rules engine and policies.
 - `run_experiments.py`, `mechanism.py`, `pimc.py`, `combinatorics.py`: note 07’s experiments.
 - `strategy_tests.py`, `strategy_vs_heuristic.py`, `paired_deltas.py`: the maxim tests in §9.4. Outputs are `strategy_*.json` and `strategy_*.log`.
- `tools/`:
 - `rekey.py`: citation re-keying;
 - `build_bibliography.py`: Appendix B;
 - `check_citations.py`: verifies that every cited key resolves to a bibliography entry. ## Appendix B. Bibliography (all sources, keyed by research note)

Citation keys in the review take the form [NN-S#], where NN is the research note (folder `research/`) and S# is the source number within that note’s own source list, reproduced below. [11-V-S#] keys refer to the coordinator’s verification note. A reference like [03 §V2] or [11 §V4] points to a section of a research note rather than a single source. Every source was fetched and read during this research session (2 October 2026), unless the note marks it otherwise.

Note 01: 01 — Wikipedia (all language editions) on Cassino / Casino / Kasino, plus related articles, talk pages, page history, and checks of cited references

(Full note: [research/01-wikipedia.md](#))

All sources were fetched 2026-10-02. Wikipedia raw text came from <https://<lang>.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=<T>&action=raw> (Norwegian Bokmål is served from no.wikipedia.org), and the rendered text from api.php?action=parse. Old revisions came from index.php?oldid=<id>&action=raw, and revision lists from api.php?action=query&prop=revisions.

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(Full note: [research/02-pagat-and-modern-rules.md](#))

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(Full note: [research/03-historical-rulebooks.md](#))

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Note 04: 04 — Cultural & social history of Cassino (non-rulebook sources)

(Full note: research/04-cultural-history.md)

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Note 05: 05 — Glossary & Table-Talk Corpus: Cassino and its relatives

(Full note: [research/05-table-talk-terminology.md](#))

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Note 06: 06 — Scorekeepers, physical aids, and digital implementations of Cassino and its relatives

(Full note: [research/06-tools-scorekeepers-digital.md](#))

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Note 07: 07 — Statistics, mathematics, computation and academic work on Cassino and its fishing-game relatives

(Full note: `research/07-statistics-academic.md`)

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Note 08: 08 — Cassino strategy and tactics: a cited compendium

(Full note: `research/08-strategy.md`)

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Note 09: 09 — Cassino variants and the fishing-game family: catalog, comparison, genealogy, origin debate

(Full note: `research/09-variants-family.md`)

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- [10-S29] *Nationen* (Oslo), 12 March 1985, p. 17, National Library of Norway. <https://www.nb.no/items/532562ef8c5766a76a8f228f4cd7c4d6> (ALTO text via api.nb.no)
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- [10-S60] “Ξερή”, *Παιχνίδια με τράπουλα και άλλα...* (blog), March 2014. <https://cardgames-gr.blogspot.com/2014/03/blog-post.html>
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Tools used: *digi.kansalliskirjasto.fi* REST search and /page-N.txt OCR; *api.nb.no* full-text search and ALTO; the archive.org full-text search (FTS) API (be-api.us.archive.org/fts/v1/search) and djvu text files; the Finna API.

Note 11: 11 — Coordinator verifications: resolving contradictions between the research notes

(Full note: `research/11-coordinator-verifications.md`)

- **[11-V-S1]** Robert Long, *Short Rules for Playing the Game of Cassino* (London, 1792). Page images read from archive.org `bim_eighteenth-century_short-rules-for-playing-_long-robert_1792`, `page/n0_s4.jpg` (title), `n4_s4.jpg` (p. 5), `n5_s4.jpg` (p. 6), `n6_s4.jpg` (p. 7), `n7_s4.jpg` (p. 8). https://archive.org/details/bim_eighteenth-century_short-rules-for-playing-_long-robert_1792
- **[11-V-S2]** *Casino; a mock-heroic poem ... To which is added, an appendix; containing the laws of the game of casino* (London, 2nd ed. 1793). archive.org `bim_eighteenth-century_casino-a-mock-heroic-po_1793`, full-text OCR (`_djvu.txt`), laws I–VII (OCR lines ~360–490) and Notes (OCR lines ~745–843); p. 31 page image `page/n27_s4.jpg`. https://archive.org/details/bim_eighteenth-century_casino-a-mock-heroic-po_1793
- **[11-V-S3]** “Trumps” [W. B. Dick], *The American Hoyle*, 4th ed. (New York: Dick & Fitzgerald; ©1864; preface to 4th ed.), preface (OCR lines 134–166) and p. 221 page image (`page/leaf231_s2.jpg`). archive.org `americanhoyleorg00dick`. <https://archive.org/details/americanhoyleorg00dick>
- **[11-V-S4]** W. B. Dick, *The American Card Player* (New York: Dick & Fitzgerald, entered 1866). archive.org `americancardplay00dick`, OCR lines 402 and 7155–7162. <https://archive.org/details/americancardplay00dick>
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- **[11-V-S6]** *Das neue Königliche l’Hombre ... Casino &c.* (1797), “Das Casino-Spiel” / “Gesetze des Casino-Spiels”, pp. 316–330. archive.org `10431610bsb`, OCR (`_djvu.txt`) lines ~15505–15944. <https://archive.org/details/10431610bsb>
- **[11-V-S7]** *The Sporting Magazine*, vol. III (London, Nov 1793 – Jan 1794), “Rules and Instructions for playing the Game of Cassino” and “Further Rules”. archive.org `sportingmagazine03londuoft`, OCR (`_djvu.txt`) lines ~11060–11140 and 16680–16860. <https://archive.org/details/sporting-magazine03londuoft>
- Cross-references such as “[03 S15]” point to the numbered sources in research notes 01–10 in this folder.

Original computation added in the synthesis pass

- **[SIM-ST]** Strategy-maxim tests: `research/sim/strategy_tests.py` (variants vs. greedy baseline, duplicate decks; outputs `strategy_tests_2026.json`, `strategy_tests_2027.json`) and `research/sim/strategy_vs_heuristic.py` (variants vs. the one-ply card-counting heuristic, same decks for every variant; output `strategy_vs_heuristic_31.json`, with paired differences from plain greedy computed by `research/sim/paired_deltas.py` → `strategy_vs_heuristic_31_paired.json`). Rules engine: `research/sim/cassino_sim.py` (pagat standard two-player rules, sweeps scored) [07-S40].

Key aliases

- [05-S74] = the BoardGameGeek thread group in note 05 (Casino, BGG id 18121), itemised above as [05-S74-BGG...].
- [08-S46a], [08-S46b] = items (a) and (b) of [08-S46]; [08-S47a], [08-S47b], [08-S47c] = items (a)–(c) of [08-S47]; [08-S30b] = second item of [08-S30]; [08-S11b] style suffixes follow the same convention.

- [05-S11b] = Foster 1897 first edition, listed in note 05 as S11b.